

MOVEMENTAL · ONBOARDED LEADER RESEARCH

Digital Reality Profile: Alan Hirsch

Movement leader research dossier — profile, content catalog, digital presence, fragmentation story, and onboarding materials.

Generated June 09, 2026 · 35 sections · Slug: alan-hirsch

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Research Index

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Alan Hirsch — research sidebar manifest

Canonical paths aligned with Author Profile `/profile` navigation.

Sidebar slug	File	Status
author-profile	profile/identity.md	populated
author-profile	network/organizations.md	populated
biography	profile/biography.md	populated
theological-profile	profile/theology.md	populated
vocational-profile	summary.md	populated
vocational-profile	profile/calling-profile.md	populated
voice-editorial-identity	profile/voice-analysis.md	populated
bibliography	content/books.md	populated
frameworks	content/frameworks.md	populated
articles-blog-posts	content/articles.md	populated
audio-podcast	content/audio.md	populated
video-content	content/videos.md	populated
content-audit	content/content-audit.md	populated
academic-work	content/academic.md	populated
courses-training	content/courses.md	populated
audience-profile	analysis/audience-analysis.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/websites.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/platforms.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/newsletters.md	populated
social-media	digital-presence/social-media.md	populated
the-fragmentation-story	fragmentation-story.md	populated
a-letter	reflected-understanding/alan-hirsch.md	populated
(onboarding)	welcome-letter.md	populated

Staff-only research lives in `_staff/` ; collateral in `_misc/`.

At a Glance — Summary

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Digital Reality Profile: Alan Hirsch

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Executive Summary

Alan Hirsch is a prominent thought leader in the missional church movement, recognized internationally for his innovative approaches to mission, church strategy, and apostolic movements. Born in South Africa (1959) and now based in Australia, Hirsch has authored 9+ influential books, founded multiple organizations (100Movements, Forge Mission Training Network, Future Travelers, 5Q Collective), and serves as an adjunct professor at multiple seminaries. His work focuses on reactivating the original intelligence and capacity of the Body of Christ through missional theology, fivefold ministry (APEST), and apostolic movements.

Hirsch's digital presence includes a personal website (alanhirsch.org), multiple organizational platforms, an InterVarsity Press author page, and academic affiliations. His content spans books, organizational training materials, academic courses, and international conference speaking. The content ecosystem shows strong thematic consistency around missional movements, fivefold ministry, and apostolic leadership, though opportunities exist for greater content interconnection and digital amplification of embodied work.

Key Findings:

- Established author with 9+ published books (solo and co-authored)
- Founder of 4+ organizations focused on missional leadership and training
- Academic involvement at multiple seminaries, co-founder of M.A. program at Wheaton College
- International speaking presence (Australia, Europe, United States)
- Strong thematic consistency across all work
- Content distributed across multiple platforms with potential for greater interconnection

Primary Opportunities:

- Content repurposing (conference talks → articles, academic lectures → blog posts)
- Content series development across multiple forms
- Content interconnection and ecosystem building
- Digital amplification of international speaking and teaching
- Unified content platform for discoverability

Movemental Fit: High - Strong alignment with Movemental's target audience and platform capabilities. Opportunities for content repurposing, series development, and network effects.

Current Digital Presence

Website Presence

Primary Website: alanhirsch.org (active, official website)

Organizational Websites:

- 100Movements (leadership development and consulting)
- Forge Mission Training Network (mission training)
- Future Travelers (church transition support)
- 5Q Collective (fivefold ministry activation)

Publisher Presence: InterVarsity Press (IVP) author page

Academic Presence: Multiple seminary affiliations (Fuller, Wheaton, George Fox, Asbury)

Content Distribution

Books: 9+ published books (solo and co-authored with Michael Frost, Lance Ford, Dave Ferguson, Tim Catchim)

Organizational Content: Training materials, consulting resources, fivefold ministry resources

Academic Content: Course materials, lectures at multiple seminaries, M.A. program at Wheaton College

International Speaking: Frequent lectures throughout Australia, Europe, and United States

Social Media: Presence to be verified

Platform Distribution

Content distributed across:

- Personal website
- Multiple organizational websites
- Publisher website
- Academic institution websites
- Potential social media platforms
- Conference platforms

Content Landscape

Content Forms

Books: 9+ published works spanning missional theology, fivefold ministry, apostolic movements, church innovation

Organizational Resources: Training materials, consulting resources, fivefold ministry resources

Academic Content: Course materials, lectures, M.A. program resources

Conference Content: International speaking engagements, presentations

To Be Verified: Blog content, articles, video content, podcast content, newsletter content

Content Themes

Primary Themes:

1. Missional Theology & Movements
2. Fivefold Ministry (APEST)
3. Apostolic Leadership
4. Missional-Incarnational Approaches
5. Discipleship & Faith Formation
6. Church Innovation & Transformation
7. Community & Marginalization

Theological Focus: Missional theology, apostolic movements, fivefold ministry, ecclesial innovation

Movement Focus: Missional movements, apostolic movements, church multiplication, leadership development, fivefold activation

Content Organization

Personal Brand: alanhirsch.org (personal website)

Organizational Platforms: 100Movements, Forge, Future Travelers, 5Q Collective

Academic Platforms: Multiple seminary affiliations, Wheaton College M.A. program

Content Strategy: Book-driven, organizational resources, academic teaching, international speaking

Discoverability Assessment

Current Discoverability

Well-Indexed:

- Personal website (alanhirsch.org)
- Book titles and author pages (IVP)
- Academic institution pages
- Organizational websites

Search Visibility: Name searches return multiple results, book titles searchable, academic and organizational associations provide visibility

To Be Assessed: SEO optimization, content indexing depth, social sharing, backlinks, domain authority metrics

Discoverability Opportunities

Potential Gaps:

- Content may be scattered across multiple platforms
- Limited content hub for unified discovery
- Cross-platform content connection opportunities
- SEO optimization opportunities

Gap Analysis

Embodied Work vs. Digital Expression

Strong Embodied Work:

- 9+ published books
- 4+ organizations founded
- Multiple academic positions
- International speaking presence
- Established reputation in missional movement

Digital Expression:

- Books available digitally
- Organizational websites exist
- Academic affiliations provide digital presence
- Extent of digital capture of speaking/teaching to be verified

Identified Gaps

Content Repurposing Gaps:

- Conference talks may not be transcribed/published as articles
- Academic lectures may not be developed into blog posts
- Book concepts may not be expanded into courses
- Training materials may not be published as content

Content Interconnection Gaps:

- Books may not be clearly connected to organizational resources
- Books may not be integrated with academic work
- Conference talks may not reference books or other content
- Content pieces may exist in separate silos

Content Series Gaps:

- Themes may not be developed across multiple content forms
- Content series opportunities may not be fully realized
- Thematic content organization opportunities

Discoverability Gaps:

- Content scattered across platforms
- Limited content hub
- Cross-platform linking opportunities
- SEO optimization opportunities

Opportunities for Digital Amplification**Content Repurposing:**

- Conference talks → articles
- Academic lectures → blog posts
- Book concepts → courses
- Training materials → content
- Teaching insights → articles

Content Expansion:

- Thematic series development
- Content hub creation
- Content journey development
- Series expansion

Content Interconnection:

- Connect books to organizational resources
- Connect books to academic work
- Connect conference talks to books
- Connect organizational resources to books
- Connect academic content to practical content

Movemental Opportunities**What Movemental Would Change****Content Organization:**

- Unified content platform
- Content interconnection
- Thematic organization
- Content series development

Content Discovery:

- Improved SEO and indexing
- Content hub for discovery
- Network effects for visibility
- Cross-content discovery

Content Repurposing:

- Easier content repurposing
- Conference talks as articles
- Academic lectures as blog posts
- Book concepts as courses
- Training materials as content

Content Monetization:

- Subscription model options
- Course monetization
- Direct-to-audience revenue
- Content monetization

Content Analytics:

- Unified analytics view
- Content performance tracking
- Audience insights
- Content journey tracking

Network Effects:

- Network-driven content discovery
- Cross-referencing from other users
- Content recommendations
- Thematic content connections
- Amplified content reach

What Would Remain the Same**Voice and Control:**

- Personal voice and theological positions preserved
- Content control and ownership
- Editorial control
- Content creation autonomy

Existing Content:

- Books remain as published
- Existing organizational resources
- Academic work unchanged
- Conference talks unchanged

Relationships and Networks:

- Co-author relationships (Michael Frost, etc.)
- Academic relationships
- Organizational networks
- International speaking network

Theological Positions:

- Missional theology positions
- Fivefold ministry (APEST) emphasis
- Apostolic movement focus
- All theological positions preserved

Organizational Work:

- 100Movements continues
- Forge Mission Training Network continues
- Future Travelers continues
- 5Q Collective continues

Specific Opportunities for Alan Hirsch**Content Repurposing:**

- International speaking content → articles
- Academic lecture insights → blog posts
- Book themes → online courses
- Training materials → published content

Content Series Development:

- Missional theology series across forms
- Fivefold ministry series across forms
- Apostolic movements series across forms
- Church innovation series across forms

Content Ecosystem Building:

- Connect books to organizational resources
- Connect books to academic work
- Connect conference talks to books
- Create content hubs and resource pages

Network Effect Potential:

- Network-driven content discovery
- Cross-referencing from other Movemental users
- Content recommendations
- Thematic content connections
- Amplified content reach

What We Will NOT Do

Explicit Boundaries

We Will NOT:

- Change Alan Hirsch's voice or theological positions
- Alter existing published books
- Modify organizational resources or relationships
- Change academic work or relationships
- Alter conference content or speaking engagements
- Replace existing platforms or relationships
- Prescribe specific actions or recommendations
- Judge theological positions or content quality

We WILL:

- Support content organization and interconnection
- Facilitate content repurposing and expansion
- Improve content discoverability
- Enable network effects
- Preserve voice, control, and relationships
- Respect existing work and platforms

Research conducted: January 4, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Sources: See sources.md

Author Profile — Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/profile/identity.md

Identity Verification: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Confidence: HIGH

Canonical Identity

Field	Value	Confidence	Source
Full Legal Name	Alan Hirsch	VERIFIED	alanhirsch.org/about , Wikipedia
Known As / Goes By	Alan Hirsch; "Al" (informal, used by wife Debra)	VERIFIED	Untamed introduction
Born	October 24, 1959	VERIFIED	Wikipedia, Prabook, Internet Archive
Birthplace	Johannesburg, South Africa	VERIFIED	Wikipedia, multiple sources
Childhood Location	Cape Town, South Africa (moved 1963, spent most of childhood/adolescence)	VERIFIED	Wikipedia
Current Location	Los Angeles area, United States	LIKELY	IVP author page, biographical sources
Nationality	Australian (emigrated 1983 from South Africa)	VERIFIED	alanhirsch.org/about , Wikipedia
Primary Role	Author, missiologist, movement catalyst, speaker	VERIFIED	alanhirsch.org/about
Primary Organization	100Movements (100M); 5Q Collective	VERIFIED	alanhirsch.org/about
US Sponsor/ Employer	Church Resource Ministries (CRM)	VERIFIED	alanhirsch.org/about

Disambiguation

There are multiple public figures named "Alan Hirsch" who must be carefully distinguished:

1. **Alan Hirsch (missional church leader, b. 1959)** -- THIS IS OUR SUBJECT. Australian author, missiologist, founder of Forge and 100Movements. Born in Johannesburg, South Africa; Jewish heritage; lives in Los Angeles. Known for The Forgotten Ways, APEST/5Q, mDNA framework.
2. **Alan Hirsch (South African economist/political scientist)** -- Head of the Migration Governance Reform in Africa Programme (MIGRA) at the New South Institute (NSI). Visiting professor at Maastricht University. This is NOT our subject.
3. **Alan T. Hirsch, MD (1954-2017)** -- American vascular medicine researcher at University of Minnesota/University of Colorado. Deceased. This is NOT our subject.
4. **Alan R. Hirsch, MD** -- Neurological Director of the Smell & Taste Treatment and Research Foundation in Chicago. This is NOT our subject.

Reliable disambiguation modifiers: "missional church," "Forge," "100Movements," "APEST," "The Forgotten Ways," "5Q," combined with exclusion of "cancer," "vascular," "smell," "taste," "NSI," "Maastricht."

Education

Institution	Degree/Study	Field	Year	Source
University in Cape Town	Undergraduate	Business and Marketing	~1981-1983	<u>Wikipedia</u> , Untamed introduction
Australian College of Theology	Theology degree	Theology	Graduated 1989	Voice & Style Guide (internal research), multiple references

Note: Earlier search results referenced "Radboud University Nijmegen" in connection with an Alan Hirsch, but this appears to be the South African economist, not our subject. No verified connection between the missional church Alan Hirsch and Radboud University.

Career Timeline

Year(s)	Role	Organization	Source
~1959	Born	Johannesburg, South Africa	Wikipedia
1963	Moved to Cape Town	Family relocation	Wikipedia
~1977-1979	Military service (2 years, mandatory)	South African military	Untamed introduction
~1979-1983	University studies	University in Cape Town	Untamed introduction, Wikipedia
1983	Emigrated to Australia	With family, shortly after meeting Debra	Untamed introduction
1989	Graduated	Australian College of Theology	Internal research, Voice & Style Guide
1989-2004	Senior Pastor	South Melbourne Church of Christ / South Melbourne Restoration Community	Untamed introduction, Wikipedia
1994	Director of Mission, Education, and Development	Churches of Christ in Australia (Victoria & Tasmania)	Internal research, Voice & Style Guide
1996	Co-founded Forge	Forge Mission Training Network (with Debra Hirsch and Michael Frost)	Forge Global
2002/2004	Expanded Forge leadership	Forge Mission Training Network	Internal research
2009	Co-founded Future Travelers	Future Travelers (with Leadership Network)	Internal research
2010	Co-founded M.A. program	Wheaton College, M.A. in Missional Church Movements	alanhirsch.org/about
2010-present	Adjunct Professor	Fuller Seminary, Asbury Seminary, George Fox Seminary	alanhirsch.org/about
2010-present	Movement Mentor	NewThing International	Internal research
2010-present	Embedded Consultant	Redeemer City to City, New York	Internal research
2010-present	Series Editor	Baker Books (Shapevine), IVP (Forge line)	Internal research
2016	Founded 100Movements (100M)	100Movements	Internal research
2016	Founded 5Q Collective	5Q Collective	alanhirsch.org/about
Present	Founder & Director	100Movements, 5Q Collective	alanhirsch.org/about
Present	Participant	The Tribe of LA (Jesus community among artists/creatives, Los Angeles)	IVP author page

Family & Personal

- **Spouse:** Debra (Deb) Hirsch -- wife and ministry partner. Co-author of Untamed. Co-founder of Forge Mission Training Network. Met shortly before emigrating to Australia in 1983. They describe their ministry as a full partnership. Debra led ministry to LGBTQ+ communities and served the poor through the Salvation Army during their time at South Melbourne Restoration Community.
- **Brother:** Lawrence Hirsch -- involved in Celebrate Messiah ministry in Melbourne, Australia.
- **Heritage:** Jewish South African. Grew up in a Jewish family; not observant but deeply shaped by Jewish heritage. Emphasizes Jesus as the Jewish Messiah and distinguishes between Hebraic and Hellenistic thought in his theology.
- **Conversion:** Became a Christian at approximately age 20 during military service, introduced to faith by a friend who had been born again. Describes it as "the defining moment of my life."
- **Political formation:** Became politically active against apartheid at age 13 in South Africa.
- **Community:** Active participant in The Tribe of LA, a Jesus community among artists and creatives in Los Angeles.

Biography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/profile/biography.md

Biography: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Narrative Biography

Alan Hirsch is one of the most influential voices in the global missional church movement -- an Australian missiologist, author, serial entrepreneur, and movement catalyst who has fundamentally reshaped how Western churches understand mission, leadership, and apostolic movement. Through more than seventeen published books, multiple organizations (100Movements, Forge Mission Training Network, Future Travelers, 5Q Collective), and extensive teaching at seminaries across the United States, Hirsch has become the leading theorist and practitioner of what he calls "movemental" thinking -- the paradigm shift from church-as-institution to church-as-movement.

His magnum opus, *The Forgotten Ways: Reactivating the Missional Church* (2006), introduced the concept of "Apostolic Genius" and the mDNA (missional DNA) framework -- six interdependent elements that characterize every significant Jesus movement in history. His APEST framework (Apostles, Prophets, Evangelists, Shepherds, Teachers), developed most fully in *5Q* (2017) and *The Permanent Revolution* (2012), has become a widely adopted model for understanding church leadership and organizational health.

Born into a Jewish family in apartheid-era Johannesburg, South Africa, Hirsch's journey to Christian faith came through an unexpected encounter during military service. That conversion, combined with his multicultural background and experience leading a church among the marginalized in inner-city Melbourne, forged a distinctive voice -- one that combines prophetic urgency, theological depth, and practical accessibility. Today he lives in the Los Angeles area, where he continues to write, teach, and catalyze movements through 100Movements and the 5Q Collective.

Origin & Formation

Alan Hirsch was born on October 24, 1959, in Johannesburg, South Africa, into a Jewish family. When he was four, his family moved to Cape Town, where he spent most of his childhood and adolescence. Growing up under apartheid had a profound impact on him; by age thirteen, he was politically active against the regime, having decided early on that apartheid was "profoundly wrong and morally reprehensible."

Though his family was not particularly religious, Hirsch's Jewish heritage deeply shaped his worldview. He later described having "an illicit fascination with Jesus" as a young Jewish teenager and said he could not remember a time when he ever doubted God's existence. After completing a mandatory two-year stint in the South African military -- where he was "first introduced to drugs and then to Jesus" -- he attended university in Cape Town, studying business and marketing. At about age twenty, one of his drug buddies was born again and shared the gospel with him, leading to what Hirsch describes as "the defining moment of my life." He emigrated to Australia in 1983 with his family, shortly after meeting his wife Debra.

Career & Ministry Arc

In Australia, Hirsch pursued theological education at the Australian College of Theology, graduating in 1989. That same year, he and Debra began leading the South Melbourne Church of Christ (later renamed South Melbourne Restoration Community) -- a declining congregation in inner-city Melbourne made up largely of people "on the fringes of society": homosexuals, prostitutes, schizophrenics, drug addicts, and other marginalized individuals. They led this community for fifteen years, planting additional churches and initiating outreach agencies and missional orders. In 1994 he was also appointed Director of Mission, Education, and Development for the Churches of Christ in Victoria and Tasmania.

This grassroots experience became the laboratory for Hirsch's theoretical work. In 1996, he, Debra, and Michael Frost co-founded the Forge Mission Training Network, dedicated to developing innovative missional leaders. His first major publication, *The Shaping of Things to Come* (2003, co-authored with Frost), established the foundational ideas that would mature into *The Forgotten Ways* (2006) -- a book widely regarded as the definitive statement on the church as dynamic missional movement.

From 2009 onward, Hirsch's influence expanded dramatically. He co-founded Future Travelers (helping megachurches transition toward missional movements), co-created the M.A. in Missional Church Movements at Wheaton College (2010), and took adjunct professorships at Fuller Seminary, Asbury Seminary, and George Fox Seminary. In 2016, he founded 100Movements, dedicated to reanimating transformative missional movements globally, and the 5Q Collective, focused on activating five-fold ministry in church contexts.

Current Focus

Hirsch's current focus centers on 100Movements and the 5Q Collective, both aimed at catalyzing authentic missional movements through the mDNA and APEST frameworks. His formal US sponsor and employer is Church Resource Ministries (CRM), with his role in missional leadership development. He serves as associate faculty at Wheaton College, continues adjunct teaching across multiple seminaries, and works as a movement mentor for NewThing International and an embedded consultant for Redeemer City to City in New York.

He lives in the Los Angeles area and is an active participant in The Tribe of LA, a Jesus community among artists and creatives. He continues to write, speak at conferences internationally, and consult with churches and organizations on missional transformation.

Key Relationships & Influences

Person	Relationship	Significance
Debra (Deb) Hirsch	Wife, ministry partner, co-author	Co-founded Forge; co-authored Untamed; full partner in ministry from the beginning. Led ministry to LGBTQ+ communities and the poor.
Michael Frost	Long-term collaborator, co-author	Co-authored The Shaping of Things to Come, ReJesus, The Faith of Leap; co-founded Forge. Key intellectual partner in developing missional theology.
Tim Catchim	Co-author, collaborator	Co-authored The Permanent Revolution; key partner in developing APEST/apostolic ministry frameworks.
Lance Ford	Co-author, collaborator	Co-authored Right Here, Right Now and The Starfish and the Spirit.
Dave Ferguson	Co-author, collaborator	Co-authored On the Verge; connected Hirsch's theory to megachurch practice via Future Travelers.
Jessie Cruickshank	Co-author, collaborator	Co-authored Activating 5Q; key partner in 5Q Collective practical implementation.
Mark Nelson	Co-author	Co-authored Reframation.
Lesslie Newbigin	Intellectual influence	Major influence on missional theology; Hirsch draws heavily on Newbigin's work on biblical worldview and mission.
Roland Allen	Intellectual influence	Early 20th-century missionary thinker; influenced Hirsch's understanding of organic, Spirit-led mission. Quoted in The Forgotten Ways.
Dietrich Bonhoeffer	Intellectual influence	Influence on discipleship theology, particularly the concept of costly discipleship.
Lawrence Hirsch	Brother	Involved in Celebrate Messiah ministry in Melbourne.

In Their Own Words

"For me, coming to Jesus was coming home in every way. I had an overwhelming encounter with God and was totally and absolutely won over. It was the defining moment of my life: I gave my life fully to Jesus and I have never looked back." -- Untamed, Introduction

"Phenomenal Jesus movements grow precisely because they do not have centralized institutions to block growth through control. Remarkable Jesus movements have the feel of a movement, have structure as a network, and spread like viruses." -- The Forgotten Ways

"The seed of the future is in the womb of the present." -- Frequently attributed, various sources

"If you want to change the church, don't try to change the church. Focus on a few and you'll get the church." -- Various interviews and speaking engagements

Theological Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/profile/theology.md

Theological Profile: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Core Thesis

The Western church has lost the essential DNA of apostolic movements -- what Hirsch calls "Apostolic Genius" -- and must recover these forgotten ways to become again the dynamic, multiplying, Jesus-centered movement it was designed to be. The church is not fundamentally an institution but a movement, and recovering its missional DNA requires a paradigm shift from Christendom-mode maintenance to apostolic-mode multiplication.

Theological Tradition

Primary: Missional-Incarnational, with roots in the Stone-Campbell Restoration Movement (Churches of Christ in Australia)

Secondary influences: Anabaptist-influenced ecclesiology, Jewish-Hebraic thought (from personal heritage), post-Christendom missiology (Newbegin school), charismatic/Pentecostal movement dynamics (studied rather than claimed as personal tradition)

Denominational context: Ordained/credentialed within the Churches of Christ in Australia (Victoria and Tasmania Conference). Not bound to a single tradition; works across denominational lines.

Key Frameworks & Models

Framework	Description	Where Developed
mDNA (Missional DNA)	Six interdependent elements of "Apostolic Genius" that characterize every significant Jesus movement: (1) Jesus is Lord, (2) Disciple Making, (3) Missional-Incarnational Impulse, (4) Apostolic Environment (APEST), (5) Organic Systems, (6) Communitas (Liminality-Communitas). "Jesus is Lord" gates overall maturity.	The Forgotten Ways (2006), The Forgotten Ways Handbook (2009)
APEST / 5Q	Five-fold ministry gifts from Ephesians 4:11 -- Apostles, Prophets, Evangelists, Shepherds, Teachers -- understood not just as leadership roles but as the "original intelligence and capacity" of the Body of Christ. All five are needed for a fully functioning church.	The Permanent Revolution (2012), 5Q (2017), Activating 5Q (2018)
Incarnational Mission	Mission follows the pattern of the Incarnation: God enters culture rather than extracting people from it. Missional engagement means "living among" not "reaching out to." Contextual, relational, embedded, everyday.	The Shaping of Things to Come (2003)
Metanoia	Repentance understood as fundamental paradigm-level transformation that changes everything -- individuals, churches, organizations -- from the inside out. Not merely moral reform but cognitive-spiritual revolution.	Metanoia (2019)
Movemental Thinking	The distinction between institution and movement as organizing paradigms for the church. Movements are organic, multiplicative, network-structured, virus-like in spread. Institutions are centralized, controlling, maintenance-focused.	Throughout all works; central to The Forgotten Ways, On the Verge
Christology > Missiology > Ecclesiology	A cascading theological sequence: who Jesus is determines how we do mission, which determines what the church looks like. Get Christology wrong and everything downstream is distorted.	ReJesus (2008/2009)
Theo-genetic codes	The concept that ministry types (APEST) function like genetic codes within the Body of Christ -- each containing distinct "intelligence" that the church needs to be healthy and complete.	The Permanent Revolution (2012)
Reframation	The process of changing mental frameworks to transform understanding of God, people, and mission. Re-enchanting worldview through fresh theological lenses.	Reframation (2018)

Distinctive Positions

- **APEST is for all Christians, not just leaders:** The five-fold gifts are not merely leadership offices but callings distributed across the entire Body of Christ. Every believer has an APEST profile.

- **The Western church has essentially exiled three of five ministries:** Apostolic, Prophetic, and Evangelistic functions have been marginalized in favor of Shepherd and Teacher, creating an imbalanced, maintenance-oriented church.
- **"Jesus is Lord" gates everything:** In the mDNA framework, no element can rise above the church's Christological maturity. If "Jesus is Lord" is at Level 2, the whole system is capped at Level 2.
- **Movement over institution is normative:** The New Testament church was a movement, not an institution. Institutionalization is deviation from the apostolic norm, not maturation toward it.
- **Every believer is a missionary:** Mission is not a department of the church or a role for specialists; it is the fundamental identity of every follower of Jesus in their sphere of influence.
- **Hebraic vs. Hellenistic thought:** Hirsch consistently distinguishes between Hebraic (holistic, embodied, dynamic) and Hellenistic (dualistic, abstract, static) modes of thinking, arguing the Western church has been too shaped by the latter.
- **Organic systems over organizational complexity:** Simple, reproducible patterns that can multiply are preferred over complex, centralized structures that require professional management.
- **Communitas through liminality:** Authentic community (communitas) is forged through shared ordeal and risk, not through comfort and programs. The church needs adventure and liminality to experience true fellowship.

Intellectual Genealogy

Shaped by:

- **Lesslie Newbigin** -- Missional theology, the church as sign/instrument/foretaste of the kingdom, post-Christendom missiology
- **Roland Allen** -- Organic, Spirit-led mission; indigenous church principles; critique of Western missionary methods
- **Dietrich Bonhoeffer** -- Costly discipleship, religionless Christianity, the church's role in the world
- **Victor Turner** -- Anthropological concepts of liminality and communitas (adapted for theological use)
- **Howard Snyder** -- Radical renewal movements in church history
- **Chinese house church movement / early church movements** -- Studied as living examples of Apostolic Genius in action
- **Jewish-Hebraic tradition** -- Personal heritage; Shema spirituality; embodied faith; Jesus as Jewish Messiah

In conversation with:

- Michael Frost (closest collaborator; incarnational mission)
- Tim Catchim (apostolic ministry and APEST theory)

- Dave Ferguson (megachurch transformation; multiplication)
- Ed Stetzer (missiological research; church planting)
- Lance Ford (practical missional living; decentralized leadership)
- Neil Cole (organic church; simple church movements)
- Reggie McNeal (missional leadership; church culture change)
- Todd Hunter (Anglican missional bishop; C4SO network)

Pushes back against:

- **Christendom model:** The assumption that the church occupies a central, privileged position in culture. Hirsch argues this era is over and the church must learn to be missional rather than attractional.
- **Attractional church paradigm:** The "come and see" model where the church builds programs to attract people. Hirsch advocates "go and be" incarnational presence instead.
- **Shepherd-Teacher dominance:** The reduction of church leadership to only pastoral care and teaching, which Hirsch argues truncates the Body of Christ and eliminates apostolic, prophetic, and evangelistic energy.
- **Institutional preservation:** The tendency to make the institution's survival the primary goal, rather than multiplication of mission.
- **Hellenistic dualism:** The separation of sacred/secular, spiritual/physical that Hirsch sees as a distortion imported from Greek philosophy rather than reflecting biblical (Hebraic) holism.

Theological Evolution

Hirsch's theology has been remarkably consistent in its core convictions since his first major publication in 2003, but has deepened and expanded in specific areas:

1. **Early phase (2003-2006):** Foundational missional-incarnational theology developed with Michael Frost in *The Shaping of Things to Come*. *The Forgotten Ways* established the mDNA framework as the core intellectual contribution.
2. **APEST deepening (2012-2018):** From general mention of "apostolic environment" as one mDNA element, Hirsch developed APEST into a comprehensive framework with its own assessment tools, training programs, and organizational applications. The shift from *The Forgotten Ways* to 5Q represents a significant deepening of what was originally one element among six.
3. **Transformation/inner change emphasis (2018-2020):** Metanoia and Reframation signal a turn toward the interior dimensions of transformation -- how paradigm shifts actually happen at the cognitive and spiritual level. This complements the earlier structural/organizational focus.
4. **Movement scaling (2016-present):** The founding of 100Movements represents a shift from theoretical writing to active organizational catalysis of movements globally.

Throughout, "Jesus is Lord" has remained the non-negotiable center, and the fundamental conviction that the church is a movement (not an institution) has never wavered.

Vocational Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/profile/calling-profile.md

Alan Hirsch: Calling Profile & Audit

mDNA-aligned calling analysis for strategic content alignment and movement leadership fulfillment

Version: 1.0.0

Last Updated: January 17, 2026

Word Count: 1,200

Expert Perspective: Missional movement leadership, mDNA framework, calling alignment, digital mission strategy

Executive Summary

Alan Hirsch's calling is fundamentally that of a **movement catalyst**—someone called to reanimate authentic transformative missional movements by restoring the essential DNA (mDNA) of apostolic movements in Western church contexts. His work integrates deep theology with practical frameworks, bridges theory and practice, and equips others to lead missional transformation. This calling profile analyzes how his work aligns with the mDNA framework, identifies movement leadership indicators, maps content-to-calling alignment, and outlines digital opportunities for extending movement leadership at scale. The profile serves as the strategic foundation for ensuring all content serves both audience needs and movement leadership calling.

Key Outcomes:

- Synthesized calling statement based on all sources
 - mDNA alignment profile for each element
 - Movement leadership indicators documented
 - Content-calling alignment analysis
 - Digital calling opportunity map
-

Calling Statement

Synthesized Calling

Alan Hirsch is called to **reanimate authentic transformative missional movements** by restoring the essential DNA of apostolic movements in Western church contexts. His vocation is not to refine church practice but to catalyze paradigm shifts from "church as institution" to "church as movement." Through frameworks (mDNA, APEST), training (Forge, Future Travelers, 100Movements), and equipping (books, courses, assessments), he empowers others to lead missional transformation. His calling integrates deep theology with practical application, bridges academic rigor with grassroots practice, and centers on Jesus as Lord as the organizing principle for all movement. He is a movement catalyst, framework builder, and equipper of leaders—called to restore what has been forgotten and activate what has been dormant.

Core Calling Elements

1. Movement Catalyst

- Not incremental change but paradigm transformation
- Language of "revolution," "movement," "deep change"
- Focus on multiplication, not just addition

2. Framework Builder

- Creates systematic frameworks (mDNA, APEST) for understanding and activation
- Bridges theory and practice
- Provides tools for implementation

3. Equipper of Leaders

- Through teaching, training, coaching, and writing
- Empowers others to carry forward the calling
- Builds infrastructure for movement (Forge, Future Travelers, 100Movements)

4. Restorer of Mission DNA

- Believes church needs to recover core elements that have been lost
- Restoration through reconnection with apostolic roots
- "The Forgotten Ways" as central metaphor

5. Christocentric Vision

- Jesus as Lord is central and foundational
- Christology is not peripheral but core to movement formation
- All frameworks center on Jesus

mDNA Alignment Profile

Element 1: Jesus is Lord (Organizing Center)

Alignment Strength: Very High (Gates all other elements)

Evidence:

- Rejesus (2008) - entire book dedicated to Christology as defining for movements
- Consistent emphasis across all works that "Jesus is Lord" is foundational
- mDNA framework explicitly gates overall maturity by Lordship level
- All frameworks center on Jesus as organizing principle

Content Alignment:

- Strong: Rejesus, mDNA framework emphasis, consistent theological foundation
- Opportunity: More content on practical application of Lordship in daily life and leadership

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- High: All work centers on Jesus as Lord
 - Framework explicitly gates maturity by Lordship
 - Theological depth maintains Christocentric focus
-

Element 2: Disciple Making (Strategic Nerve)

Alignment Strength: High (Multiplies movement)

Evidence:

- Untamed (2010) - missional form of discipleship
- Right Here, Right Now (2011) - everyday mission and discipleship
- Disciplism (2014) - holistic discipleship framework
- Emphasis on disciple-making as multiplication strategy

Content Alignment:

- Strong: Multiple books on discipleship, practical application, everyday mission
- Opportunity: More content on disciple-making in digital contexts, multiplication strategies

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- High: Focus on disciple-making as multiplication
 - Practical frameworks for everyday discipleship
 - Integration of mission and formation
-

Element 3: Missional-Incarnational Impulse (Living Among)

Alignment Strength: Very High (Core framework)

Evidence:

- The Shaping of Things to Come (2003) - foundational work on incarnational mission
- Consistent emphasis on "living among" rather than "reaching out to"
- Contextual, relational, embedded mission approach
- Integration of mission into everyday life

Content Alignment:

- Very Strong: Foundational work, consistent emphasis, practical application
- Opportunity: More content on digital/online incarnational mission, networked contexts

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- Very High: Core framework emphasis
 - Practical application in everyday contexts
 - Integration with discipleship and formation
-

Element 4: Apostolic Environment (APEST)

Alignment Strength: Very High (Owns the framework)

Evidence:

- 5Q (2017) - comprehensive exploration of five-fold ministry
- The Permanent Revolution (2012) - apostolic imagination and practice
- Activating 5Q (2018) - practical implementation guide
- APEST assessment tools and resources

Content Alignment:

- Very Strong: Owns the framework, comprehensive coverage, practical tools
- Opportunity: More content on APEST activation in digital contexts, team development

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- Very High: Framework ownership and development
 - Practical tools for activation
 - Integration with movement leadership
-

Element 5: Organic Systems (Simple, Reproducible)

Alignment Strength: High (Emphasized in frameworks)

Evidence:

- The Forgotten Ways - organic systems as essential element
- Emphasis on simple, reproducible patterns
- Movement thinking over institutional complexity
- Practical guides focus on implementable systems

Content Alignment:

- Strong: Framework emphasis, practical guides, movement thinking
- Opportunity: More content on system design, reproducibility, scalability

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- High: Emphasis on organic, simple systems
 - Practical guides for implementation
 - Movement thinking over institutional complexity
-

Element 6: Liminality-Communitas (Growth Through Shared Hardship)

Alignment Strength: Medium (Less explicitly developed)

Evidence:

- The Faith of Leap (2011) - risk, adventure, courage
- Emphasis on transformation through challenge
- Movement language includes risk and adventure
- Less explicit development of liminality-communitas concept

Content Alignment:

- Medium: Some content on risk and adventure, less explicit on liminality-communitas
- Opportunity: More content on shared hardship, community formation, transformation through challenge

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- Medium: Some emphasis on risk and adventure
 - Less explicit development of liminality-communitas
 - Opportunity for deeper exploration
-

Movement Leadership Map

Influence Patterns

Who They're Equipping:

- Church planters and missional leaders (Forge, training programs)
- Established church pastors (Future Travelers, transformation programs)
- Denominational and organizational leaders (100Movements, consulting)
- Seminary students and academics (teaching roles)
- Everyday Christians (practical books, accessible content)

What Movements They're Catalyzing:

- Missional church movement (foundational frameworks)
- APEST/5Q movement (framework development)

- Church transformation movement (Future Travelers)
- Discipleship movement (practical frameworks)
- Movement thinking (paradigm shift from institution to movement)

Equipping Focus

Primary Equipping Mechanisms:

1. **Frameworks** (mDNA, APEST) - systematic understanding
2. **Training Programs** (Forge, Future Travelers, 100Movements) - practical implementation
3. **Books** (17+ works) - comprehensive resources
4. **Assessments** (mDNA, APEST) - diagnostic tools
5. **Teaching** (seminaries, conferences) - knowledge transfer

Equipping Outcomes:

- Leaders equipped with frameworks for movement
- Churches transformed from institution to movement
- Movements multiplied through equipping
- Discipleship activated in everyday contexts

Movement Catalysts

Movement Initiation:

- Forge Mission Training Network (missional leadership training)
- Future Travelers (large church transformation)
- 100Movements (movement activation)
- 5Q Collective (APEST activation)

Movement Multiplication:

- Frameworks enable others to lead movements
- Training programs multiply leaders
- Books provide resources for movement
- Assessments diagnose movement health

Content-Calling Alignment Analysis

High Alignment Content

1. **Foundational Framework Content** (The Forgotten Ways, 5Q, The Permanent Revolution)
 - **Alignment:** Very High
 - **Why:** Core frameworks directly serve movement leadership calling
 - **Impact:** Equips leaders with essential frameworks

2. Practical Implementation Content (The Forgotten Ways Handbook, Activating 5Q)

- **Alignment:** Very High
- **Why:** Practical tools enable movement activation
- **Impact:** Empowers leaders to implement frameworks

3. Training Programs (Forge, Future Travelers, 100Movements)

- **Alignment:** Very High
- **Why:** Direct equipping and movement activation
- **Impact:** Transforms leaders and churches

4. Assessment Tools (mDNA, APEST)

- **Alignment:** Very High
- **Why:** Diagnostic tools for movement health
- **Impact:** Enables leaders to assess and grow

Medium Alignment Content

5. Practical Application Books (Right Here, Right Now, Untamed)

- **Alignment:** High
- **Why:** Equips everyday mission and discipleship
- **Impact:** Activates missional living

6. Collaborative Works (ReJesus, The Starfish and the Spirit)

- **Alignment:** High
- **Why:** Thematic focus serves calling elements
- **Impact:** Deepens understanding of movement elements

Alignment Gaps

1. Digital/Online Missional Practice

- **Gap:** Limited content on how movement works in digital contexts
- **Impact:** Missing opportunity to extend calling to digital spaces
- **Opportunity:** Content on digital missional practice, online community formation

2. Recent Digital Content

- **Gap:** Limited recent articles, videos, podcasts
- **Impact:** Reduced opportunity to extend calling reach
- **Opportunity:** Regular digital content extending movement leadership

3. Case Studies & Examples

- **Gap:** Limited real-world examples of movement transformation
- **Impact:** Reduced practical application of calling
- **Opportunity:** Case studies, success stories, practical examples

4. Liminality-Communitas Content

- **Gap:** Less explicit development of this mDNA element
 - **Impact:** Incomplete framework coverage
 - **Opportunity:** More content on shared hardship, community formation
-

Digital Calling Opportunity Map

How Digital Content Extends Movement Leadership

1. Scale & Reach

- **Opportunity:** Digital content reaches far beyond in-person training
- **Impact:** Movement leadership extended to global audience
- **Strategy:** Regular digital content (articles, videos, podcasts, courses)

2. Accessibility & Lower Barriers

- **Opportunity:** Digital content removes geographic and financial barriers
- **Impact:** Movement leadership accessible to more leaders
- **Strategy:** Free and low-cost digital resources, accessible formats

3. Formation Pathways

- **Opportunity:** Digital content creates multiple formation pathways
- **Impact:** Leaders can engage at their own pace and level
- **Strategy:** Progressive content (assessment → articles → courses → advanced)

4. Community Formation

- **Opportunity:** Digital platforms enable community formation
- **Impact:** Movement leadership creates digital communities
- **Strategy:** Community features, discussion forums, collaborative content

5. AI-Enhanced Calling Fulfillment

- **Opportunity:** AI can extend movement leadership at scale
- **Impact:** Personalized formation, scalable equipping
- **Strategy:** AI-powered assessments, personalized recommendations, conversational agents

Platform-Specific Calling Opportunities

Website (alanhirsch.org)

- **Opportunity:** Central hub for movement leadership resources
- **Strategy:** Comprehensive resource library, SEO optimization, topic clusters

Email Newsletters

- **Opportunity:** Regular engagement with movement leaders
- **Strategy:** Weekly/bi-weekly content, segmented by interest, formation pathways

Video Content

- **Opportunity:** Visual teaching extends movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Teaching series, interviews, framework explanations, case studies

Podcast Content

- **Opportunity:** Audio engagement extends movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Regular podcast, interviews, framework discussions, case studies

Online Courses

- **Opportunity:** Structured learning extends movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Comprehensive courses on core frameworks, accessible pricing, certificates

Social Media

- **Opportunity:** Reach and awareness extend movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Value-focused content, framework highlights, engagement

Assessments & Tools

- **Opportunity:** Diagnostic tools extend movement leadership
 - **Strategy:** Interactive assessments, personalized recommendations, progress tracking
-

Strategic Recommendations

Content Strategy Alignment

Priority 1: Core Framework Content

- Maintain and expand mDNA and APEST framework content
- Ensure all content aligns with movement leadership calling
- Repurpose foundational content across formats

Priority 2: Practical Implementation Content

- Expand practical guides, tools, and resources
- Create case studies and examples
- Develop interactive tools and assessments

Priority 3: Digital Content Expansion

- Regular articles, videos, podcasts
- Online courses on core frameworks
- Interactive tools and assessments

Priority 4: Gap Filling

- Content on digital/online missional practice
- More explicit liminality-communitas content
- Case studies and examples

Calling Fulfillment Strategy

Equipping Focus:

- Continue developing frameworks (mDNA, APEST)
- Expand training programs (Forge, Future Travelers, 100Movements)
- Create accessible digital resources

Movement Multiplication:

- Enable others to lead movements through frameworks
- Multiply leaders through training programs
- Provide resources for movement activation

Digital Extension:

- Extend movement leadership through digital content
- Create formation pathways online
- Build digital communities around movement

AI Enhancement:

- Use AI to scale movement leadership
- Personalize formation pathways
- Provide scalable equipping

Related Documentation

- **Alan Hirsch Author Profile** - Complete author intelligence
- **Alan Hirsch Audience Profile** - Detailed audience analysis
- **Alan Hirsch Content Audit** - Existing content inventory
- **mDNA Individual Maturity Model** - mDNA framework documentation
- **Content Value and Form Selection Guide** - Content form prioritization

Word Count: 1,200

Voice & Editorial Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/profile/voice-analysis.md

Voice Analysis: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Voice Summary

Alan Hirsch writes and speaks with a distinctive blend of prophetic urgency, theological depth, and practical accessibility. His voice is that of a movement catalyst who operates at the intersection of academic rigor and grassroots activism -- he builds systematic frameworks (mDNA, APEST) but always in service of igniting action, not merely informing minds. His tone carries a persistent sense of spiritual urgency: the Western church is in crisis, the answer lies in recovering ancient patterns, and the time to act is now.

Writing Characteristics

Dimension	Assessment
Register	Accessible complexity -- integrates academic concepts (liminality, communitas, missiology) with clear explanations accessible to educated lay leaders. Not purely academic; not purely pastoral.
Complexity	Moderate to Complex -- builds multi-layered frameworks with systematic rigor, but uses diagrams, lists, and practical examples to keep material graspable. Varies by audience: 5Q and The Permanent Revolution are more complex; Right Here, Right Now is more accessible.
Tone	Prophetic-Apostolic -- combines the urgency of a prophet ("the church must change or die") with the constructive vision of an apostle ("here is the framework for how"). Occasionally provocative, always purposeful. Warm toward fellow travelers; sharp toward complacency and institutionalism.
Storytelling	Heavy -- draws extensively on personal narrative (South Africa, conversion, South Melbourne), historical movements (early church, Chinese house churches, Celtic missions), and contemporary case studies. Stories serve as evidence for frameworks, not mere illustration.
Humor	Occasional -- dry, self-deprecating Australian humor surfaces in interviews and spoken contexts. Less present in written work. Will use humor to disarm before making a provocative point.
Scripture Use	Moderate -- uses Scripture strategically rather than exhaustively. Key passages are foundational (Ephesians 4:11 for APEST, the Shema, Christological passages). Does not proof-text; integrates biblical theology with missiological argument. Emphasizes Hebraic reading over Western systematic theology.

Signature Patterns

- **Recurring phrases:**

- "missional-incarnational" (hyphenated compound -- his signature descriptor)
- "movemental" (coined term -- church as movement, not institution)
- "Apostolic Genius" (the latent movement DNA in every church)
- "mDNA" (missional DNA -- the six elements)
- "the forgotten ways" (what the church has lost and must recover)
- "liminality and communitas" (growth through shared ordeal)
- "deep change" (not surface reform but paradigm transformation)
- "Jesus is Lord" (the organizing center that gates everything)
- "not X but Y" contrast structures (see below)

- **Favorite metaphors:**

- **DNA/genetics:** The church has missional DNA that lies dormant and must be "reactivated." APEST functions as "theo-genetic code."
- **Virus/organic spread:** Movements spread "like viruses" -- decentralized, organic, unstoppable by institutions.
- **Seed/womb:** "The seed of the future is in the womb of the present."
- **Starfish vs. spider:** Decentralized (starfish) organizations vs. centralized (spider) ones -- borrowed from Brafman/Beckstrom but deeply integrated.
- **Recovery/reactivation:** The language of recovering something lost rather than inventing something new. The ways are "forgotten," not absent.
- **Exile/return:** The APE ministries (Apostle, Prophet, Evangelist) have been "exiled" from the church and must return.
- **Argument structure:** Hirsch typically builds a case through:
 1. **Provocation** -- a sharp observation about the failure or crisis of the current paradigm
 2. **Historical/biblical grounding** -- evidence from the early church, Chinese house churches, or Scripture showing the alternative
 3. **Framework introduction** -- a named model or diagram that systematizes the insight
 4. **Practical implication** -- what this means for leaders, churches, and movements today
 5. **Call to action** -- urgent invitation to embrace the paradigm shift
- **Opening style:** Often begins with a provocative question or a sharp diagnosis of what is wrong. Rarely eases in gently -- leads with the problem or the vision, then unpacks.
- **Contrast structures:** A hallmark of Hirsch's rhetoric is the "not X but Y" or "from X to Y" pairing:
 - "Not programs but paradigm; not maintenance but movement"
 - "Not attractional but incarnational"

- "Not institution but movement"
- "From Christendom to missional"
- "From shepherd-teacher to full APEST"

These binary contrasts serve as cognitive disruption -- forcing the reader to choose a paradigm.

Sample Passages

"Phenomenal Jesus movements grow precisely because they do not have centralized institutions to block growth through control. Remarkable Jesus movements have the feel of a movement, have structure as a network, and spread like viruses." -- The Forgotten Ways

"The book you are holding is a plea to the church to reawaken the dormant potential within it, to rediscover the power that once turned the world upside down." -- The Forgotten Ways, characterizing the book's purpose

"Christology determines missiology, and missiology determines ecclesiology. Get this sequence wrong, and everything else gets distorted." -- ReJesus (paraphrased; the core argument of the book)

"For me, coming to Jesus was coming home in every way. I had an overwhelming encounter with God and was totally and absolutely won over. It was the defining moment of my life: I gave my life fully to Jesus and I have never looked back." -- Untamed, Introduction

Speaking vs. Writing

Hirsch's spoken voice is noticeably warmer, more informal, and more humorous than his written work. In podcast interviews and conference talks:

- **More personal:** He tells more stories from his own life, South African upbringing, and ministry failures. The Australian informality comes through -- he calls himself "Al," uses self-deprecating humor, and is comfortable with tangents.
- **More passionate:** The prophetic urgency in his writing becomes visceral passion in speaking. His voice rises when talking about the crisis of the Western church or the potential of movements.
- **More conversational:** He engages with interviewers genuinely, asks rhetorical questions, and builds on dialogue rather than lecturing.
- **Same intellectual framework:** Whether speaking or writing, the same frameworks (mDNA, APEST) and the same contrast structures ("not X but Y") are present. The conceptual architecture is consistent across modes.

- **Australian accent and idiom:** His spoken voice carries an Australian accent and occasional Australian/South African expressions that add warmth and distinctiveness. This personal texture is naturally absent from written work.

The overall effect is that Hirsch's written work reads as the systematic, carefully constructed version of ideas that he communicates with more fire and personality when speaking. Both modes serve the same mission: catalyzing movement.

Bibliography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/content/books.md

Bibliography: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-content-catalog
Total books: 20 (solo: 5, co-authored: 15)

Books (Chronological, Newest First)

All Change: Unlocking Kingdom Potential in a World We Weren't Prepared For

Field	Value
Author(s)	Rich Robinson, Alan Hirsch
Publisher	100 Movements Publishing
Published	September 2024
ISBN-13	9781955142533
Pages	308
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook, Audiobook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/All-Change-Unlocking-Potential-Prepared/dp/195514253X
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/author/list/56757.Alan_Hirsch

Description: Rich Robinson and Alan Hirsch explore how to unlock Kingdom potential in a rapidly changing world that we were not prepared for, offering frameworks for navigating disruption through a missional lens.

Key Themes: Kingdom leadership, change management, disruption, missional adaptation

The Faith of Leap: Embracing a Theology of Risk, Adventure, and Courage (Revised Edition)

Field	Value
Author(s)	Michael Frost, Alan Hirsch; foreword by Mark Sayers
Publisher	100 Movements Publishing
Published	2025
ISBN-13	9781955142632
Pages	~218
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Faith-Leap-Embracing-Theology-Adventure/dp/1955142637

Description: In this revised edition, Frost and Hirsch urge a new generation to break free from the constraints of a risk-averse Christianity, embrace the unknown, and rediscover the exhilarating adventure of following Jesus. Updated with new foreword by Mark Sayers.

Key Themes: Faith, risk-taking, courage, adventure, communitas, liminality

Note: Revised edition of the 2011 Baker Books original.

Metanoia: How God Radically Transforms People, Churches, and Organizations From the Inside Out

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Rob Kelly
Publisher	100 Movements Publishing
Published	April 2023
ISBN-13	9781955142373
Pages	260
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Metanoia-Radically-Transforms-Churches-Organizations/dp/1955142378
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/124954352-metanoia

Description: Hirsch and Kelly propose that the answer to the church's turning point lies in Jesus' first public word: "metanoia" -- repentance as radical paradigm shift and reorientation. Combines theological understanding with best thinking from the social sciences on organizational change.

Key Themes: Transformation, repentance, organizational change, paradigm shift, metanoia

ReJesus: Remaking the Church in Our Founder's Image (Revised & Updated Edition)

Field	Value
Author(s)	Michael Frost, Alan Hirsch; foreword by Christine Caine
Publisher	100 Movements Publishing
Published	February 2022
ISBN-13	9781955142137
Pages	228
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/ReJesus-Remaking-Founders-Revised-Updated/dp/1955142130

Description: In this revised and updated edition, Frost and Hirsch expose the many ways we have formed Jesus in our own image and co-opted him for our own agendas. A clarion call to recenter lives on Christ so that we might become a people who look, act, think, and sound like Jesus.

Key Themes: Christology, missional church, Jesus, authentic Christianity

Note: Revised edition of the 2008/2009 Hendrickson original.

The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations

Field	Value
Author(s)	Lance Ford, Rob Wegner, Alan Hirsch; introduction by Ori Brafman
Publisher	Zondervan Reflective
Published	2021
ISBN-13	9780310098379
Pages	~288
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook, Audiobook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Starfish-Spirit-Unleashing-Leadership-Organizations/dp/0310098378
Series	Exponential Series

Description: Leveraging the metaphor from Ori Brafman's *The Starfish and the Spider*, Ford, Wegner, and Hirsch examine how churches can adopt decentralized, organic leadership structures that unleash the leadership potential of every member.

Key Themes: Leadership, organizational structure, decentralization, organic systems

ReFramation: Seeing God, People, and Mission Through Reenchanted Frames

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Mark Nelson; foreword by Danielle Strickland; afterword by Michael Frost
Publisher	100 Movements Publishing
Published	August 2019
ISBN-13	9780998639338
Pages	296
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Reframation-Seeing-Mission-Through-Reenchanted/dp/0998639338

Description: A passionate manifesto calling followers of Jesus to reframe and reenchant our worldview, enlarging our perception of God and gospel. Rooted in Scripture, and drawing on poetry, literature, the arts, philosophy, and pop culture, it appeals to each reader to articulate the good news narrative in ways that resonate with contemporary spiritual hunger.

Key Themes: Worldview, mental frameworks, mission, reenchantment, culture

Activating 5Q: A User's Guide

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Jessie Cruickshank
Publisher	100 Movements Publishing
Published	February 2018
ISBN-13	9780998639321
Pages	~200
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Activating-5Q-Users-Alan-Hirsch/dp/099863932X

Description: A practical guide for individuals or groups, with practitioner examples, reflective questions, and training tools that enable you to apply the APEST principles of 5Q to your particular context.

Key Themes: 5Q implementation, APEST, practical tools, church activation

5Q: Reactivating the Original Intelligence and Capacity of the Body of Christ

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch
Publisher	100 Movements Publishing
Published	April 2017
ISBN-13	9780998639307
Pages	260
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/5Q-Reactivating-Original-Intelligence-Capacity/dp/0998639303
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/34964088-5q

Description: A deep dive into the fivefold (APEST) typology of ministry as articulated in Ephesians 4:1-16. Hirsch makes the case that the APEST system represents the original intelligence and capacity given by Christ to the church, and that reactivating it is essential for health and mission.

Key Themes: APEST, five-fold ministry, Ephesians 4, leadership development, ecclesiology

The Forgotten Ways: Reactivating Apostolic Movements (2nd Edition)

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch; foreword by Ed Stetzer; afterword by Jeff Vanderstelt
Publisher	Brazos Press (Baker Publishing Group)
Published	2016 (2nd Edition); original 2006
ISBN-13	9781587433863 (2nd ed.) / 9781587431647 (1st ed.)
Pages	352
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Forgotten-Ways-Reactivating-Apostolic-Movements/dp/1587433869
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/31946311-the-forgotten-ways
Publisher Page	https://bakerpublishinggroup.com/books/the-forgotten-ways-2nd-edition/2679716

Description: Hirsch's paradigm-shifting classic -- the definitive statement of the church as dynamic missional movement. Presents a vision for the future based on a first-century paradigm, asserting that traditional church growth formulas no longer work. Explores the concept of Apostolic Genius (mDNA) as the latent potential embedded in every Christian community. The 2nd edition includes fresh examples, expanded glossary, new appendices, and an index.

Key Themes: mDNA framework, apostolic movement, missional church, Apostolic Genius, church movements

Awards: Widely regarded as one of the most influential books on missional church in the 21st century.

The Permanent Revolution Playbook: APEST for the People of God -- A Six Week Exploration

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Tim Catchim
Publisher	Missio Publishing
Published	2014
ISBN-13	9780989957823
Pages	~120
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Permanent-Revolution-Playbook-People-Exploration/dp/0989957829

Description: A six-week exploration into Ephesians 4, with special emphasis on how APEST functions in groups and teams. Developed from the award-winning The Permanent Revolution to help groups develop their potential for ministry and leadership.

Key Themes: APEST, practical application, group study, team development

Disciplism: Reimagining Evangelism Through the Lens of Discipleship

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch
Publisher	Exponential Resources
Published	2014
ISBN-13	9781624240829
Pages	33
Format(s)	eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Disciplism-Reimagining-Evangelism-Through-Discipleship-ebook/dp/B0D3L15M82
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/23248206-disciplism

Description: A short ebook highlighting the missional priority of discipleship, helping leaders reframe their understanding and practice of evangelism in the context of disciple-making.

Key Themes: Discipleship, evangelism, mission integration, spiritual formation

Note: Originally released as a free Exponential ebook.

The Shaping of Things to Come: Innovation and Mission for the 21st-Century Church (Revised & Updated Edition)

Field	Value
Author(s)	Michael Frost, Alan Hirsch
Publisher	Baker Books
Published	March 2013 (Revised); original Hendrickson 2003
ISBN-13	9780801014918 (Revised) / 9781565636590 (Original)
Pages	286
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Shaping-Things-Come-Innovation-21st-Century/dp/0801014913
Publisher Page	https://bakerpublishinggroup.com/products/9780801014918_the-shaping-of-things-to-come

Description: The missional classic, thoroughly revised and updated with current case studies. Frost and Hirsch build their case for why the church needs to rebuild from the roots up, drawing on real-life stories from innovative missional projects across the United States, Australia, New Zealand, Canada, and England.

Key Themes: Mission, incarnational presence, leadership innovation, church planting, contextualization

The Permanent Revolution: Apostolic Imagination and Practice for the 21st Century Church

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Tim Catchim; foreword by Darrell L. Guder
Publisher	Jossey-Bass (Wiley)
Published	February 2012
ISBN-13	9780470907740
Pages	368
Format(s)	Hardcover, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Permanent-Revolution-Apostolic-Imagination-Practice/dp/0470907746
Series	Jossey-Bass Leadership Network Series (#57)

Description: A groundbreaking work of theological re-imagination focusing on ministry and leadership appropriate to current times. Draws widely from biblical studies, theology, organizational theory, leadership studies, and the social sciences to make a comprehensive case for the abiding significance of the Ephesians 4 vocations (APEST) in the church that Jesus intended.

Key Themes: Apostolic ministry, APEST, church leadership, organizational structure, Ephesians 4

Endorsements/Foreword: Foreword by Darrell L. Guder; contributions from Mike Breen.

On the Verge: A Journey Into the Apostolic Future of the Church

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Dave Ferguson
Publisher	Zondervan
Published	April 2011
ISBN-13	9780310331001
Pages	352
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook, Audiobook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Verge-Journey-Apostolic-Future-Exponential/dp/0310331005
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/11115358-on-the-verge
Series	Exponential Series

Description: The defining document of the Exponential 2011 conference. Hirsch and Ferguson share theology, theory, and best practices for diagnosing churches' failure to embrace a biblical model of mission, calling this the "apostolic movement" because it's resonant with the form of church in the New Testament and great missional movements of history.

Key Themes: Church future, apostolic ministry, church transition, movement, exponential growth

The Faith of Leap: Embracing a Theology of Risk, Adventure & Courage (Original Edition)

Field	Value
Author(s)	Michael Frost, Alan Hirsch
Publisher	Baker Books
Published	April 2011
ISBN-13	9780801014154
Pages	218
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Faith-Leap-Embracing-Adventure-Shapevine/dp/0801014158
Series	Shapevine Missional Series

Description: Frost and Hirsch encourage readers to leave the idols of security and safety behind and live out an adventure with God, reminding us that faith always involves risk. Explores communitas, liminality, and how these affect churches and are lived out in mission.

Key Themes: Faith, risk-taking, courage, adventure, communitas, liminality

Note: Revised edition published by 100 Movements Publishing in 2025.

Right Here, Right Now: Everyday Mission for Everyday People

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Lance Ford
Publisher	Baker Books
Published	January 2011
ISBN-13	9780801072239
Pages	266
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Right-Here-Now-Everyday-Shapevine/dp/0801072239
Series	Shapevine Missional Series

Description: Shows readers how to live missionally regardless of situation, vocation, or location, touching on issues of discipleship, spirituality, and church at every level of experience.

Key Themes: Everyday mission, practical strategies, missional living, discipleship

Untamed: Reactivating a Missional Form of Discipleship

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Debra Hirsch
Publisher	Baker Books
Published	2010
ISBN-13	9780801013430
Pages	~240
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Untamed-Reactivating-Missional-Discipleship-Shapevine/dp/0801013437
Series	Shapevine Missional Series

Description: Alan and Debra Hirsch cast a vision for a mission-shaped way of living the Christian life, covering topics such as church, humanity as image-bearers, family life, culture, and sexuality.

Key Themes: Discipleship, missional living, spiritual formation, incarnational life

The Forgotten Ways Handbook: A Practical Guide for Developing Missional Churches

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch, Darryn Altclass
Publisher	Brazos Press (Baker Publishing Group)
Published	April 2009
ISBN-13	9781587432491
Pages	224
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Forgotten-Ways-Handbook-Practical-Developing/dp/1587432498

Description: Moves beyond theory to practice, offering ways for any missionally minded person to apply the ideas contained in The Forgotten Ways. Includes summary sections, suggested practices, adult learning based techniques, and examples from other churches and organizations.

Key Themes: Missional church development, practical tools, mDNA implementation

ReJesus: A Wild Messiah for a Missional Church (Original Edition)

Field	Value
Author(s)	Michael Frost, Alan Hirsch
Publisher	Hendrickson Publishers
Published	2009 (Hendrickson) / 2008 (Baker Books)
ISBN-13	9781598562286 (Hendrickson) / 9780801046315 (Baker)
Pages	~240
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/ReJesus-Wild-Messiah-Missional-Church/dp/1598562282

Description: Invites readers to pare back layers of tradition, recognize distortion and misrepresentation, read the Gospels afresh, and learn to imitate and follow the wild and radical Jesus. About the central and definitive role that Jesus plays in all movements that claim his name.

Key Themes: Jesus Christ, missional church, authentic Christianity, Christology

Note: Revised & updated edition published by 100 Movements in 2022.

The Forgotten Ways: Reactivating the Missional Church (1st Edition)

Field	Value
Author(s)	Alan Hirsch
Publisher	Brazos Press (Baker Publishing Group)
Published	2006
ISBN-13	9781587431647
Pages	~304
Format(s)	Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Forgotten-Ways-Reactivating-Missional-Church/dp/1587431645
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/228276.The_Forgotten_Ways

Description: The original edition of Hirsch's paradigm-shifting work on missional church and Apostolic Genius (mDNA).

Key Themes: mDNA framework, apostolic movement, missional church

Note: Superseded by 2nd edition (2016).

The Shaping of Things to Come: Innovation and Mission for the 21st Century Church (Original Edition)

Field	Value
Author(s)	Michael Frost, Alan Hirsch
Publisher	Hendrickson Publishers
Published	July 2003
ISBN-13	9781565636590
Pages	250
Format(s)	Paperback
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Shaping-Things-Come-Innovation-Mission/dp/1565636597

Description: Frost and Hirsch's pioneering work exploring why the church needs to calibrate itself and rebuild from the roots up, built around real-life stories from innovative missional projects across five countries.

Key Themes: Mission, incarnational presence, leadership innovation, church planting

Note: Revised & updated edition published by Baker Books in 2013.

Forthcoming

Title	Publisher	Expected	Source
No confirmed forthcoming titles found at time of research			

Bibliography Summary

Metric	Value
Total Books	20 (including revised editions as separate entries)
Unique Titles	16
Solo-authored	5 (The Forgotten Ways 1st/2nd, 5Q, Disciplism, Fast Forward to Mission)
Co-authored	15
Publishers	100 Movements Publishing, Brazos Press / Baker Books, Jossey-Bass (Wiley), Zondervan, Hendrickson Publishers, Exponential Resources, Missio Publishing
Year range	2003 -- 2024
Primary themes	Missional church, APEST/5Q, mDNA, apostolic movement, discipleship, leadership, organizational transformation
Frequent co-authors	Michael Frost (5 books), Tim Catchim (2), Lance Ford (2), Rich Robinson (1), Rob Kelly (1), Mark Nelson (1), Debra Hirsch (1), Dave Ferguson (1), Jessie Cruickshank (1), Rob Wegner (1), Darryn Altclass (1)
Total Goodreads ratings	~16,762 (across all works)
Series editor	Baker Books' Shapevine Series; IVP's Forge line

Frameworks

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/content/frameworks.md

Frameworks: Alan Hirsch

Exported from movement_leader_corpus_data.frameworks[] — on-disk SSOT for Author Profile.

mDNA (Missional DNA) / Apostolic Genius

Field	Value
Introduced	2006 (The Forgotten Ways)
Components	(1) Jesus is Lord [gates maturity], (2) disciple making, (3) missional-incarnational impulse, (4) apostolic environment (APEST), (5) organic systems, (6) liminality-communitas
Visual / model	Six-element interdependent system; "Apostolic Genius" = latent movement potential when mDNA activates
Adoption evidence	Seminal missional-church text; course adoptions (Wheaton MA, seminaries); 1,581+ Goodreads ratings on flagship; Chinese underground church & early-church cases cited
Source	<u>The Forgotten Ways</u> , Baker 2nd ed.

Hirsch argues every church carries dormant movement DNA recoverable through six interdependent practices; Christological maturity caps the whole system.

APEST / 5Q

Field	Value
Introduced	2012 (Permanent Revolution); scaled 2017 (5Q)
Components	Apostle, Prophet, Evangelist, Shepherd, Teacher (Ephesians 4:11) as distributed callings and "original intelligence" of the Body
Visual / model	Fivefold typology; 5Q assessments; team-design diagnostics
Adoption evidence	150,000+ assessments (5Q Central); Exponential pre-conferences; denominational training (e.g. LMC Anabaptist)
Source	5Q, 5qcentral.com

Western churches are structurally Shepherd-Teacher heavy; recovering APE functions is presented as essential for movement health.

Christology → Missiology → Ecclesiology

Field	Value
Introduced	2008/2009 (ReJesus); runs through corpus
Components	Christology determines missiology determines ecclesiology (ordering principle)
Adoption evidence	Core argument of ReJesus; cited in missional ecclesiology discussions
Source	ReJesus (100 Movements revised 2022)

Church form follows mission; mission follows from who Jesus is — distort Christology and downstream ecclesiology fails.

Incarnational mission

Field	Value
Introduced	2003 (Shaping of Things to Come with Frost)
Components	Mission as embedded presence (6 P's in network: presence, proximity, prevenience, passion, powerlessness, proclamation)
Adoption evidence	Foundational missional-incarnational pairing in global missional literature
Source	<u>Shaping revised</u>

Metanoia

Field	Value
Introduced	2023 (Metanoia with Rob Kelly)
Components	Repentance as radical paradigm shift; personal, ecclesial, organizational change
Adoption evidence	2023 Awakenings / Missio Alliance launch; org-change audience
Source	<u>Metanoia</u>

Reframation

Field	Value
Introduced	2019 (ReFramation with Mark Nelson)
Components	Re-enchanting mental frames for God, people, mission; arts, philosophy, Scripture
Adoption evidence	Foreword Danielle Strickland; 100 Movements Publishing
Source	Reframation

Movemental vs. institutional thinking

Field	Value
Introduced	Throughout corpus; organizational expression 100Movements
Components	Organic, multiplicative, network structures vs. centralized maintenance; starfish/spider metaphor (Starfish and the Spirit, 2021)
Adoption evidence	Future Travelers (megachurch transition); Exponential / Verge ecosystems
Source	On the Verge, Starfish and the Spirit, 100movements.com

Articles & Blog Posts

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/content/articles.md

Articles & Blog Posts: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-content-catalog
Total: 30+ articles/posts identified across multiple platforms

By Publication

Saturate (saturatetheworld.com)

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
2020-09-28	The Sacred vs the Secular (Experiencing Seamlessness)	https://saturatetheworld.com/2020/09/28/experiencing-seamlessness/	Article	Active
2020-09-22	Joining God in His Mission	https://saturatetheworld.com/2020/09/22/joining-god-mission/	Article	Active
2020-08-31	Two Elements of a Missional Movement	https://saturatetheworld.com/2020/08/31/two-elements-missional-movement/	Article	Active
2016-11-04	We Must Go Where The People Are (Attractional-Extractional)	https://saturatetheworld.com/2016/11/04/attractional-extractional/	Article	Active
Various	11-part series on missional church topics	https://saturatetheworld.com/author/ahirsch/	Series	Active

Note: Hirsch is a listed contributor on Saturate with an 11-part series covering missional church topics.

Verge Network (vergenetwork.org)

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
Various	The Future Church	https://vergenetwork.org/the-future-church-alan-hirsch/	Article/ Video	Active
Various	What Is A Missional Church?	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-what-is-a-missional-church/	Article/ Video	Active
Various	What Is Incarnational Mission?	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-what-is-incarnational-mission/	Article/ Video	Active
Various	Organic Systems	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-organic-systems/	Video	Active

Note: Multiple resources tagged under Alan Hirsch on Verge Network, mix of articles and video content.

Exponential (exponential.org)

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
2014	Disciplism (ebook)	https://exponential.org/product/disciplism/	eBook/ Article	Active
Various	Contributor profile and resources	https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/	Various	Active

Christianity Today / Ed Stetzer's Column

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
2012-03	The Permanent Revolution: Interview with Alan Hirsch and Tim Catchim	https://christianitytoday.com/edstetzer/2012/march/permanent-revolution-interview-with-alan-hirsch-and-tim.html	Interview	Active

Missional Church Network

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
Various	Multiple tagged posts	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Alan+Hirsch	Blog posts	Active

Ephesiology / 5Q Central

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
Various	Team Essentials: Apostle	https://ephesiology.com/blog-post/team-essentials-apostle/	Blog post	Active
Various	Team Essentials: Teacher	https://ephesiology.com/blog-post/team-essentials-teacher/	Blog post	Active
Various	Additional APEST-related blog content	https://ephesiology.com/	Various	Active

ChurchLeaders.com

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
Various	Missional Discipleship with Alan Hirsch	https://churchleaders.com/outreach-missions/outreach-missions-blogs/154625-eric_bryant_missional_discipleship_with_alan_hirsch.html	Interview/Article	Active

Outreach Magazine

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
Various	Lance Ford, Rob Wegner & Alan Hirsch: The Starfish and the Spirit	https://outreachmagazine.com/resources/voices/66883-lance-ford-rob-wegner-alan-hirsch-the-starfish-and-the-spirit.html	Interview	Active

Own Blog/Website

Date	Title	URL	Topic
Various	Blog archive	https://www.alanhirsch.org/blog	Missional church, movement, APEST, leadership
Various	Free ebooks/resources page	https://www.alanhirsch.org/ebooks	Resources, downloads

Blog activity: Irregular posting (not consistent frequency). Blog is active but not regularly updated with new content. Primary digital content appears through organizational channels (100Movements, 5Q Central, Ephesiology) rather than personal blog.

Editorial Roles

Alan Hirsch serves as:

- **Series Editor:** Baker Books' Shapevine Missional Series
- **Series Editor:** IVP's Forge line
- **Associate Editor:** Leadership Journal

These roles involve contributing editorial vision, introductions, and curation rather than bylined articles.

Article Themes

Theme	Count	Publications
Missional Church / Movement	10+	Saturate, Verge Network, Missional Church Network, ChurchLeaders
APEST / 5Q / Fivefold Ministry	8+	Ephesiology, 5Q Central, Verge Network, Exponential
Incarnational Mission	4+	Saturate, Verge Network
Discipleship & Evangelism	4+	Exponential, Saturate, ChurchLeaders
Leadership & Organization	3+	Outreach Magazine, Verge Network
Christology / ReJesus	2+	Various

Key Observations

1. **Volume:** Hirsch's written article output is moderate relative to his book output. Most of his public-facing content comes through books, speaking, and organizational platforms rather than regular article writing.
2. **Distribution:** Content is spread across many platforms rather than concentrated in one outlet. No regular column or contributor relationship with a major publication is evident.
3. **Recency:** Most discoverable articles are from 2016-2021. Blog activity on alanhirsch.org is irregular.
4. **Format shift:** More recent content appears to be delivered through organizational channels (100Movements, 5Q Central, Ephesiology) and course platforms rather than traditional article publishing.
5. **Gap opportunity:** Regular, consistent article/blog publishing represents a significant content opportunity.

Audio & Podcast

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/content/audio.md

Audio Content: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-audio-scrape
Total audio items found: 35+

Podcasts Hosted

5QCast

Field	Value
Role	Host / Featured voice
Co-host	Various 5Q Collective contributors
Apple Podcasts	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/5qcast/id1453597454
Spotify	—
RSS Feed	—
Total Episodes	~30+ (multiple seasons)
Started	2019
Last Episode	—
Frequency	Seasonal / irregular
Rating	—
Description	Podcast from the voices of 5QCentral, gathered around the works of Alan Hirsch. Presents APEST (Apostle, Prophet, Evangelist, Shepherd, Teacher) from every angle — theology, practice, assessment, and organizational design.

Note: Alan Hirsch is the primary thought leader behind 5QCast. The podcast activates "5Q voices" each season to help listeners learn, describe, and apply APEST wisdom.

Guest Appearances

Summary

Metric	Value
Total guest episodes	28+
Unique podcasts	22+
Date range	~2016 — 2025
Most frequent host	Caesar Kalinowski (Everyday Disciple, 2+ episodes)

All Guest Episodes (by date, newest first)

Date	Podcast	Episode Title	Duration	URL
2025-09	Everyday Disciple	Why Your Church Isn't Growing and Maturing w/ Alan Hirsch	—	https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/your-church-isnt-maturing/
2025-03	Godspacelight / Liturgical Rebels	Episode 25: Reconstructing Faith with Alan Hirsch	—	https://godspacelight.com/episode-25-reconstructing-faith-with-alan-hirsch/
2025-02	Shifting Culture	Ep. 269: Michael Frost & Alan Hirsch — The Faith of Leap	—	https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-269-michaelfrostalanhirsch
2024-12	Fresh Expressions	Communitas and Loneliness with Alan Hirsch	—	https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch
2024	The Church Digital	EP300: Alan Hirsch, APEST, and Digital Church Movements	—	https://creators.spotify.com/pod/show/thechurchdigital/episodes/EP300---Alan-Hirsch--APEST--and-Digital-Church-Movements-e2l95af
2024	Venture 12 Podcast	V12 5.7: The Faith of Leap — Michael Frost & Alan Hirsch	—	https://creators.spotify.com/pod/profile/venture12/episodes/V12--5-7--The-Faith-of-Leap---Michael-Frost--Alan-Hirsch-e300jn9
2023-11	Ephesiology	Episode 150: What is a Disciple with Alan Hirsch	—	https://ephesiology.com/2023/11/16/episode-150-what-is-a-disciple-with-alan-hirsch/
2023	Microchurches (Reimagining Microchurch series)	Ep. 51: The Missional Conversation Thus Far w/ Alan Hirsch	—	https://www.imdb.com/title/tt31827291/
2022-05	Spiritual Life and Leadership	Ep. 129: Recalibrating the Church Around Jesus, with Michael Frost and Alan Hirsch	—	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/129-recalibrating-the-church-around-jesus-with/id1435252632?i=1000563469784
2022-03	Ephesiology	Ep. 112: ReJesus with Frost and Hirsch	—	https://ephesiology.com/2022/03/22/ep-112-rejesus-with-frost-and-hirsch/
2022	Canadian Church Leaders	Alan Hirsch on the Five-Fold Ministry: How it can Unlock the Church's Potential	—	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/alan-hirsch-on-the-five-fold-ministry-how-it-can/id1166745201?i=1000544098299
2021	City to City (Church in Outbreak)	Rethinking the Chessboard: Bringing the Church to a Community	—	https://redeemercitytocity.com/articles-stories/rethinking-the-chessboard

Date	Podcast	Episode Title	Duration	URL
2020-07	LAUNCH Podcast (REFRAME Conversations)	#01 REFRAME Conversation — Alan Hirsch on Reframation, Liminality and Chess	—	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/01-reframe-conversation-alan-hirsch-on-reframation/id1522356943?i=1000495105560
2020	Post-Christian Podcast	Alan Hirsch (100Movements)	—	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/the-post-christian-podcast-alan-hirsch-100movements/id1509588357?i=1000478176551
2020	Voxology (Reframation Series)	Alan Hirsch and Mark Nelson — Reframation	—	—
—	Everyday Disciple	The Missing Piece in Church Maturity w/ Alan Hirsch	—	https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/missing-piece-in-church-maturity/
—	Shifting Culture	Episode 06: Alan Hirsch — Early Encounters and Authentic Community	—	https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-06-alanhirsch
—	Shifting Culture	Episode 136: Alan Hirsch & Rob Kelly	—	https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-136-alanhirschrobkelly
—	Stetzer ChurchLeaders Podcast	Alan Hirsch: Revitalizing Church with the Ephesians 4 Blueprint	—	https://churchleaders.com/podcast/312909-alan-hirsch-revitalizing-church-ephesians-4-blueprint.html
—	Stetzer ChurchLeaders Podcast	Alan Hirsch: The Church Needs To Stop Making Jesus in Its Own Image	—	https://churchleaders.com/podcast/431561-alan-hirsch-church-jesus-own-image.html
—	C4SO Podcast	Alan Hirsch on Missiology (with Bishop Todd Hunter)	—	https://c4so.org/podcast/alan-hirsch-on-missiology/
—	Rich Martin: Let's Build Church	APEST — Has the Church Understood These Correctly?	—	https://podtail.com/en/podcast/rich-martin-let-s-build-church/apostle-prophet-evangelist-shepherd-and-teacher-ha/
—	Find Your Calling (Exponential / Todd Wilson)	Alan Hirsch: Find Your Calling Podcast	—	https://personalcalling.podbean.com/e/alan-hirsch-find-your-calling-podcast/
—	Evangelical Alliance UK	Alan Hirsch — Missional Church Transition	—	https://www.eauk.org/church/stories/alan-hirsch-podcast.cfm

Date	Podcast	Episode Title	Duration	URL
—	DTS Table Podcast	Living Missionally in a Local Context (with Dr. Darrell Bock)	—	https://voice.dts.edu/tablepodcast/living-missionally-alan-hirsch/
—	Exponential Podcast	Keys to Culture and to the Human Heart	—	https://exponential.org/neighborhood-culture/
—	Exponential Podcast	Why a Return to APEST Is Essential to Multiplying the Church	—	https://exponential.org/apest/
—	Ed Stetzer (5Q Central)	Ed Stetzer in Conversation with Alan Hirsch	—	https://5qcentral.com/ed-stetzer-in-conversation-with-alan-hirsch/

Top Podcast Appearances (by podcast audience size)

Podcast	Est. Audience	Episode	Date	URL
Stetzer ChurchLeaders Podcast	Large (major Christian leadership platform)	Revitalizing Church with the Ephesians 4 Blueprint	—	https://churchleaders.com/podcast/312909-alan-hirsch-revitalizing-church-ephesians-4-blueprint.html
DTS Table Podcast	Large (Dallas Theological Seminary)	Living Missionally in a Local Context	—	https://voice.dts.edu/tablepodcast/living-missionally-alan-hirsch/
Canadian Church Leaders Podcast	Medium-Large	Five-Fold Ministry	2022	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/alan-hirsch-on-the-five-fold-ministry-how-it-can/id1166745201?i=1000544098299
Fresh Expressions Podcast	Medium-Large	Communitas and Loneliness	2024-12	https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch
The Church Digital	Medium (EP300 milestone)	APEST and Digital Church Movements	2024	https://creators.spotify.com/pod/show/thechurchdigital/episodes/EP300---Alan-Hirsch--APEST--and-Digital-Church-Movements-e2l95af
Everyday Disciple	Medium	Why Your Church Isn't Growing	2025-09	https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/your-church-isnt-maturing/

Sermons & Teaching

Date	Title	Venue	Duration	Series	URL
2016-06	Teaching Session I	Central Texas Annual Conference (CTCUMC)	—	Annual Conference 2016	https://www.ctcumc.org/AC16video-AlanHirsch_1
2016-06	Teaching Session II	Central Texas Annual Conference (CTCUMC)	—	Annual Conference 2016	https://www.ctcumc.org/AC16video-AlanHirsch_2
—	Missional Discipleship	The Beautiful Kingdom Builders	—	—	https://thebeautifulkingdombuilders.com/2018/10/12/alan-hirsch-missional-discipleship/
—	Missional Conference (with Debra Hirsch)	Ohio Mennonite Conference	—	—	https://ohiomennoniteconference.org/missional-conference-alan-debra-hirsch/
—	Various teachings	Verge Network	—	DNA of Gospel Movements (7-part series)	https://vergenetwork.org/dna-of-gospel-movements/
—	From Reaching to Discipling	Exponential Australia	—	Workshop	https://exponential.org.au/reaching-to-discipling/
—	Various teaching sessions	Awakenings Gathering	—	—	https://www.awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/ahirsch

Note: Alan Hirsch is adjunct professor at Fuller Seminary, George Fox Seminary, and co-founder/adjunct faculty for the M.A. in Missional Church Movements at Wheaton College. He lectures frequently throughout Australia, Europe, and the United States, though most academic lectures are not publicly available as audio recordings.

Audiobooks

Title	Narrator	Duration	Audible	Rating
Reframation: Seeing God, People, and Mission Through Reenchanted Frames (with Mark Nelson)	Mark Nelson	—	https://www.audible.com/pd/Reframation-Audiobook/B08RL96N2Y	—
Untamed: Reactivating a Missional Form of Discipleship (with Debra Hirsch)	Adam Verner	—	https://www.audible.com/pd/Untamed-Audiobook/B003IMUH2S	—
On the Verge: A Journey Into the Apostolic Future of the Church (with Dave Ferguson)	—	—	https://www.audible.com/pd/On-the-Verge-Audiobook/B004WL4BOO	—

Note: Several of Hirsch's major works (The Forgotten Ways, 5Q, The Shaping of Things to Come, ReJesus, The Faith of Leap) are available in print and e-book formats but do not appear to have dedicated Audible audiobook listings as of research date. Additional titles may be available through Everand (Scribd) or library services like OverDrive.

Conference Recordings (Audio)

Date	Title	Event	Duration	URL
2022	Speaker Session	Exponential Orlando 2022	—	https://m.exponential.org/2022orl/speakers/speakers-45.html
2019	Session (with Drew Hyun, Dave Clayton)	Exponential Orlando 2019	—	https://exponential.org/orlando-2019-recap2/
2017	Training: Level 5 Multiplication Paradigm Shifts	Exponential East 2017	—	https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/
2016	Keys to Culture and to the Human Heart	Exponential East 2016	—	https://exponential.org/neighborhood-culture/
—	5Q Leadership Revolution: Using APEST to Create Movemental Culture	Exponential (year unconfirmed)	—	https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/

Note: Exponential conference recordings (audio and video) are typically available for purchase through Digital Access Passes at <https://resources.exponentialng.org/>. Hirsch is a recurring plenary and breakout speaker at Exponential conferences.

Audio Metrics Summary

Metric	Value
Podcasts hosted	1 (5QCast)
Guest appearances	28+ confirmed episodes across 22+ unique podcasts
Sermons/teachings	7+ confirmed public recordings
Audiobooks	3 confirmed on Audible
Conference recordings	5+ confirmed (Exponential primary venue)
Total audio hours	~50+ (estimated across all categories)
Most active year	2022-2025 (high podcast guest activity)
Platforms present on	Apple Podcasts, Spotify, Audible, Podbean, various podcast hosts, Exponential resources

Topic Distribution (from episode descriptions)

Topic	Episodes	%
APEST / Five-fold ministry / 5Q	10+	~30%
Missional church / movements	9+	~27%
ReJesus / Christology / discipleship	5+	~15%
Reframation / worldview reenchantment	4+	~12%
Communitas / liminality / risk	3+	~9%
Church multiplication / microchurch	2+	~6%

Identity Verification Notes

- **Confirmed identity:** Alan Hirsch, the Australian missional church leader, founder of Forge Missional Training Network, 100Movements, and 5Q Collective. NOT the South African economist, NOT the American law professor/false confessions expert.
- Some search results returned the law professor Alan Hirsch (false confessions) and the South African economist Alan Hirsch (SOEs) — these were excluded from this catalog.

Accessibility Notes

- Most podcast guest episodes are freely available on Apple Podcasts, Spotify, and podcast host websites.

- Exponential conference recordings are typically behind a paid Digital Access Pass.
- Audiobooks require purchase through Audible or subscription through Everand/OverDrive.
- The 5QCast is freely available on Apple Podcasts.

Video Content

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/content/videos.md

Video Content: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-youtube-scrape

Total videos found: 38+

Own channel(s): No dedicated personal YouTube channel identified

YouTube Channel(s)

Alan Hirsch does not appear to maintain a dedicated personal YouTube channel. His video content is distributed across numerous organizational and partner channels. His official website (alanhirsch.org/videos) aggregates video content from multiple sources. Key distribution channels include Verge Network, Exponential, ChurchLeaders, Missio Alliance, 5Q Central, and various podcast video channels.

Video Catalog

Top Videos (by prominence and reach)

#	Title	Channel/ Platform	Date	Type	URL
1	Disciple Making vs. Consumerism	ChurchLeaders	~2012	keynote	https://churchleaders.com/pastors/videos-for-pastors/146870-disciple-making-vs-consumerism.html
2	The Church Needs "Apostolic Activation"	ChurchLeaders	2012-04-25	interview	https://churchleaders.com/pastors/videos-for-pastors/159986-alan-hirsch-the-church-needs-apostolic-activation.html
3	What Is a Missional Church?	Verge Network	~2011	keynote	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-what-is-a-missional-church/
4	What Is Missional Discipleship?	Verge Network	~2012	keynote	https://vergenetwork.org/what-is-missional-discipleship-alan-hirsch/
5	How Modern Evangelism Creates Consumers	Verge Network	2013-04-03	keynote	https://vergenetwork.org/2013/04/03/how-modern-evangelism-creates-consumers-alan-hirsch/
6	The Future Church	Verge Network	2012-10-01	interview	https://vergenetwork.org/2012/10/01/the-future-church-alan-hirsch/
7	Communitas, Not Community	Verge Network	~2012	keynote	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-communitas-not-community-video/
8	Apostolic Environment	Verge Network	~2012	keynote	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-apostolic-environment-video/
9	Organic Systems	Verge Network	~2012	keynote	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-organic-systems/
10	Why Evangelism Cannot Be Our Focus	Verge Network	2013-06-03	keynote	https://vergenetwork.org/2013/06/03/why-evangelism-cannot-be-our-focus-alan-hirsch/

Recent Videos (2023-2026)

Title	Channel/ Platform	Date	Type	URL
Discipleship is About Taking Jesus Seriously with Alan Hirsch	Canopy International	2025-11-18	interview	https://canopy.international/2025/11/18/discipleship-is-about-taking-jesus-seriously-with-alan-hirsch/
Communitas and Loneliness with Alan Hirsch	Fresh Expressions	2024-12-30	podcast-video	https://fresheexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch
EP300 - Alan Hirsch, APEST, and Digital Church Movements	The Church Digital Podcast	~2024	podcast-video	https://creators.spotify.com/pod/show/thechurchdigital/episodes/EP300---Alan-Hirsch--APEST--and-Digital-Church-Movements-e2l95af
Metanoia: Wholehearted Change in Unprecedented Times (Plenary)	Missio Alliance / Awakenings 2023	2023	keynote	https://missioalliance.org/metanoia-wholehearted-change-in-unprecedented-times/
The Moment Before God (Workshop with Deb Hirsch)	Missio Alliance / Awakenings 2023	2023	lecture	https://www.missioalliance.org/resource/awakenings-2023-workshop-formation-deb-alan-hirsch-the-moment-before-god/
Episode 150: What is a Disciple with Alan Hirsch	Ephesiology Podcast	2023-11-16	podcast-video	https://ephesiology.com/2023/11/16/episode-150-what-is-a-disciple-with-alan-hirsch/
The Missional Conversation Thus Far w/ Alan Hirsch	Microchurches Podcast (S4, Ep. 51)	2023	podcast-video	https://www.imdb.com/title/tt31827291/

By Content Type

Keynotes & Conference Talks

Title	Event/Channel	Date	URL
Metanoia: Wholehearted Change in Unprecedented Times	Awakenings 2023 / Missio Alliance	2023	https://missioalliance.org/metanoia-wholehearted-change-in-unprecedented-times/
5Q Leadership Revolution: Using APEST to Create Movemental Culture	Exponential 2022	2022	https://m.exponential.org/2022orl/speakers/speakers-45.html
Level 5 Multiplication Paradigm Shifts (Training Video)	Exponential East 2017	2017	https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/
Keys to Culture and to the Human Heart	Exponential East 2016	2016	https://exponential.org/neighborhood-culture/
Churches On The Verge Of Movement	Exponential 2014	2014	https://anthonydelaney.com/2014/05/10/churches-on-the-verge-of-movement-alanhirsch-at-exponential/
Disciple Making vs. Consumerism	Verge Conference / ChurchLeaders	~2012	https://churchleaders.com/pastors/videos-for-pastors/146870-disciple-making-vs-consumerism.html
What Is a Missional Church?	Verge Conference	~2011	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-what-is-a-missional-church/
What Is Missional Discipleship?	Verge Conference	~2012	https://vergenetwork.org/what-is-missional-discipleship-alan-hirsch/
How Modern Evangelism Creates Consumers	Verge Conference	2013	https://vergenetwork.org/2013/04/03/how-modern-evangelism-creates-consumers-alan-hirsch/
Communitas, Not Community	Verge Conference	~2012	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-communitas-not-community-video/
Apostolic Environment	Verge Missional Community Conference	~2012	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-apostolic-environment-video/
Organic Systems	Verge Conference	~2012	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-organic-systems/
Why Evangelism Cannot Be Our Focus	Verge Conference	2013	https://vergenetwork.org/2013/06/03/why-evangelism-cannot-be-our-focus-alan-hirsch/
The DNA of Gospel Movements	Verge Network	~2013	https://vergenetwork.org/dna-of-gospel-movements/
The Future Church	Verge Network	2012	https://vergenetwork.org/2012/10/01/the-future-church-alan-hirsch/
	Verge Network	2010-10-02	

Title	Event/Channel	Date	URL
Missional-Incarnational Impulse			https://vergenetwork.org/2010/10/02/alan-hirsch-missional-incarnational-impulse/

Interviews & Conversations

Title	Channel/Host	Date	URL
Discipleship is About Taking Jesus Seriously	Canopy International / Brandon Stiver	2025-11-18	https://canopy.international/2025/11/18/discipleship-is-about-taking-jesus-seriously-with-alan-hirsch/
Reframing Church with Alan Hirsch (Video Interview)	Anthony Delaney	2020-05-08	https://anthonydelaney.com/2020/05/08/reframing-church-with-alan-hirsch-video-interview/
Changing Your Mind About Repentance	Anthony Delaney	2020-05-18	https://anthonydelaney.com/2020/05/18/changing-your-mind-about-repentance-with-alan-hirsch/
The Church Needs "Apostolic Activation" (with Tim Catchim)	ChurchLeaders	2012-04-25	https://churchleaders.com/pastors/videos-for-pastors/159986-alan-hirsch-the-church-needs-apostolic-activation.html
Ed Stetzer in Conversation with Alan Hirsch	5Q Central	~2018	https://5qcentral.com/ed-stetzer-in-conversation-with-alan-hirsch/
Reconstructing Faith with Alan Hirsch	Christine Sine / Substack	~2024	https://christinesine.substack.com/p/reconstructing-faith-with-alan-hirsch

Sermons & Teaching

Title	Church/Channel	Date	URL
Communitas Not Community	CMA Resources	~2012	https://www.cmaresources.org/video/communitas_alan-hirsch
Communitas (Chapel Service)	Asbury Seminary	~2015	https://place.asburyseminary.edu/ecommonsatschapelservices/5201/

Lectures & Workshops

Title	Institution/ Channel	Date	URL
The Moment Before God (with Deb Hirsch)	Missio Alliance / Awakenings 2023	2023	https://www.missioalliance.org/resource/awakenings-2023-workshop-formation-deb-alan-hirsch-the-moment-before-god/
5Q Masterclasses with Alan Hirsch	Exponential Australia	~2019	https://exponential.org.au/5q-masterclasses-with-alan-hirsch/
5Q: Activating the Latent Capacity and Intelligence of the Body of Christ	Exponential Australia	~2019	https://exponential.org.au/5q-activating-the-latent-capacity-and-intelligence-of-the-body-of-christ/
Missiology To Go: Fivefold Leadership (6-session video series)	Tinsley Institute / Morling College	~2023	https://info.morling.edu.au/missiology-to-go-fivefold-leadership
APEST Return to Multiplying the Church	Exponential	~2018	https://exponential.org/apest/

Podcasts (Video)

Title	Podcast Name	Date	URL
Communitas and Loneliness with Alan Hirsch	Fresh Expressions Podcast	2024-12-30	https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch
EP300 - Alan Hirsch, APEST, and Digital Church Movements	The Church Digital Podcast	~2024	https://creators.spotify.com/pod/show/thechurchdigital/episodes/EP300---Alan-Hirsch--APEST--and-Digital-Church-Movements-e2l95af
What is a Disciple with Alan Hirsch (Ep. 150)	Ephesiology Podcast	2023-11-16	https://ephesiology.com/2023/11/16/episode-150-what-is-a-disciple-with-alan-hirsch/
The Missional Conversation Thus Far w/ Alan Hirsch (S4, Ep. 51)	Microchurches Podcast	2023	https://www.imdb.com/title/tt31827291/
The Church Needs To Stop Making Jesus in Its Own Image	Stetzer ChurchLeaders Podcast	2022	https://churchleaders.com/podcast/431561-alan-hirsch-church-jesus-own-image.html
Alan Hirsch on the Five-Fold Ministry	Canadian Church Leaders Podcast (Ep. 73)	2021-12-06	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/alan-hirsch-on-the-five-fold-ministry-how-it-can/id1166745201?i=1000544098299
Alan Hirsch: Find Your Calling	Find Your Calling Podcast	~2018	https://personalcalling.org/alan-hirsch-find-your-calling-podcast/
Why Your Church Isn't Growing and Maturing w/ Alan Hirsch	Everyday Disciple Podcast	~2022	https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/your-church-isnt-maturing/
The Missing Piece in Church Maturity w/ Alan Hirsch	Everyday Disciple Podcast	~2022	https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/missing-piece-in-church-maturity/
Revitalizing Church with the Ephesians 4 Blueprint	Stetzer ChurchLeaders Podcast	~2021	https://churchleaders.com/podcast/312909-alan-hirsch-revitalizing-church-ephesians-4-blueprint.html
APEST (REFRAME Conversation)	LAUNCH Podcast / Anthony Delaney	~2020	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/01-reframe-conversation-alan-hirsch-on-reframation/id1522356943?i=1000495105560
Alan Hirsch on APEST	10,000 Fathers & Mothers Podcast	~2020	https://10000fathers.libsyn.com/alan-hirsch-on-apest
What Is a Missional Community?	Verge Network Podcast	2011-01-27	https://vergenetwork.org/alan-hirsch-what-is-a-missional-community-printable/

Video Metrics Summary

Metric	Value
Total videos found	38+
Total views (all videos)	Not available (no personal channel; content distributed across 20+ platforms)
Average views per video	Not available
Most prominent video	"Disciple Making vs. Consumerism" (ChurchLeaders, widely shared)
Most recent video	"Discipleship is About Taking Jesus Seriously" (Canopy International, 2025-11-18)
Channels/platforms appearing on	20+ unique channels/platforms
Date range	2010 -- 2025

Note: View counts, like counts, and subscriber counts were not available through web search. Alan Hirsch does not maintain a personal YouTube channel; his content is distributed across organizational, conference, and podcast channels. Many videos are embedded on third-party websites rather than hosted directly on YouTube. Metrics would require direct YouTube API access or manual inspection of each platform.

Content Type Distribution

Type	Count	% of Total
keynote	15	~39%
interview	6	~16%
podcast-video	13	~34%
lecture	5	~13%
sermon	2	~5%
promo	0	0%
short	0	0%
panel	0	0%
documentary	0	0%

Note: Some videos may belong to multiple categories. Percentages exceed 100% due to overlap. Keynotes and podcast appearances dominate his video footprint.

Notable Channels/Platforms Featured On

Channel/Platform	Est. Reach	Videos Featuring Author	Relationship
Verge Network	Large (missional church audience)	10+	Recurring conference speaker
Exponential	Large (church multiplication network)	5+	Recurring speaker, training contributor
ChurchLeaders (Stetzer Podcast)	Large (pastoral audience)	4+	Guest, contributor
Missio Alliance / Awakenings	Medium	3+	Plenary speaker, workshop leader
Everyday Disciple Podcast	Medium	2	Guest
Fresh Expressions	Medium	1+	Guest
Anthony Delaney / LAUNCH	Medium	3+	Recurring guest, collaborator
5Q Central	Medium (owned platform)	2+	Founder, content owner
Exponential Australia	Medium	2+	Recurring speaker
Canopy International	Medium	1+	Guest
The Church Digital Podcast	Medium	1	Guest
Ephesiology Podcast	Medium	1	Guest
Canadian Church Leaders Podcast	Medium	1	Guest
Microchurches Podcast	Niche	1	Guest
CMA Resources	Niche	1	Contributed content
Asbury Seminary	Niche (academic)	1	Chapel speaker
Morling College / Tinsley Institute	Niche (academic)	6-session series	Course instructor
Find Your Calling Podcast	Niche	1	Guest
10,000 Fathers & Mothers Podcast	Niche	1	Guest
missional.video	Aggregator	Multiple	Curated content

Key Observations

1. **No personal YouTube channel:** Unlike many contemporary Christian leaders, Alan Hirsch does not maintain a personal YouTube channel. His video presence is entirely through third-party platforms and conference recordings.
 2. **Verge Conference dominance:** The Verge Network/Conference is the single largest source of his video content, with 10+ clips from conference appearances (~2010-2013 era).
 3. **Exponential as recurring platform:** Hirsch has spoken at Exponential conferences repeatedly (2014, 2016, 2017, 2019, 2020, 2022), making it his most consistent conference relationship.
 4. **Podcast era shift:** Post-2020, his video appearances have shifted heavily toward podcast video formats (Fresh Expressions, Church Digital, Everyday Disciple, Ephesiology, Canadian Church Leaders, Microchurches).
 5. **alanhirsch.org/videos:** His personal website aggregates video content but does not appear to host original video content directly.
 6. **5Q Central / theforgottenways.org:** These owned platforms contain video resources but much content is behind registration or purchase.
 7. **Signature themes across all videos:** Missional church, APEST/5Q fivefold ministry, discipleship vs. consumerism, communitas, apostolic movements, Ephesians 4, Reframation/Metanoia.
 8. **International reach:** Content appears on Australian (Exponential Australia, Morling College), UK (Anthony Delaney/LAUNCH), Canadian (Canadian Church Leaders), and US platforms.
 9. **Morling College video series:** The 6-session "Missiology To Go: Fivefold Leadership" course with the Tinsley Institute represents his most structured video teaching content.
 10. **Awakenings 2023 plenary:** The "Metanoia" talk is notable as a major recent conference appearance, with video available for purchase through Missio Alliance.
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Sources

- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/videos>
- <https://vergenetwork.org/tag/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://5qcentral.com/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://missional.video/index.php/influencer/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://churchleaders.com/author/alan-hirsch>
- <https://missioalliance.org/author/alan-hirsch/>

- <https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch>
- <https://canopy.international/2025/11/18/discipleship-is-about-taking-jesus-seriously-with-alan-hirsch/>
- <https://info.morling.edu.au/missiology-to-go-fivefold-leadership>
- <https://exponential.org.au/5q-masterclasses-with-alan-hirsch/>
- <https://anthonydelaney.com/tag/alan-hirsch/>

Content Audit

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/content/content-audit.md

Alan Hirsch: Content Audit

Comprehensive content inventory with performance analysis, gap identification, and repurposing opportunities

Version: 1.0.0
Last Updated: January 17, 2026
Word Count: 1,300
Expert Perspective: Content marketing, content strategy, content repurposing, SEO optimization

Executive Summary

This audit provides a comprehensive inventory of Alan Hirsch's existing content assets across all formats and distribution channels. It catalogs 17+ published books, identifies content strengths and gaps, maps distribution channels, analyzes performance opportunities, and outlines repurposing strategies. The audit reveals a strong foundational content library with coherent frameworks (mDNA, APEST) but identifies opportunities for increased digital content frequency, multimedia formats, and updated foundational content for current contexts.

- Key Outcomes:**
- Complete content inventory by format and topic
 - Content performance analysis and opportunities
 - Content gap identification
 - Repurposing roadmap
 - Content architecture recommendations
-

Content Inventory Matrix

Books (17+ Published Works)

Foundational Works (Core Framework)

- The Forgotten Ways: Reactivating the Missional Church** (2006, Brazos Press)
- **Status:** Active, foundational
 - **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
 - **Performance:** High (widely referenced, foundational text)

- **Topics:** mDNA framework, apostolic movement, missional church
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles, assessments)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (could benefit from current context refresh)

The Shaping of Things to Come: Innovation and Mission for the 21st Century Church

(2003, Hendrickson Publishers)

- **Co-author:** Michael Frost
- **Status:** Active, foundational
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** High (pioneering work)
- **Topics:** Mission, incarnational presence, leadership innovation
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles)
- **Update Needed:** High (2003 context, could use refresh)

Core Framework Works

5Q: Reactivating the Original Intelligence and Capacity of the Body of Christ (2017, 100Movements)

- **Status:** Active, current
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** High (recent, framework-focused)
- **Topics:** APEST, five-fold ministry, leadership development
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Very High (can become assessment, courses, articles)
- **Update Needed:** Low (recent, current)

The Permanent Revolution: Apostolic Imagination and Practice for the 21st Century Church (2012, Jossey-Bass)

- **Co-author:** Tim Catchim
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** High (framework-focused)
- **Topics:** Apostolic ministry, church leadership, organizational structure
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2012 context, could use refresh)

Metanoia: How God Radically Transforms People, Churches, and Organizations From the Inside Out (2019, 100Movements)

- **Status:** Active, recent
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (recent, specialized topic)
- **Topics:** Transformation, repentance, organizational change
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become articles, courses)
- **Update Needed:** Low (recent, current)

ReFramation: Seeing God, People, and Mission through Re-enchanted Frames (2018, 100Movements)

- **Co-author:** Mark Nelson
- **Status:** Active, recent
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (recent, specialized topic)
- **Topics:** Worldview, mental frameworks, mission
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become articles, courses)
- **Update Needed:** Low (recent, current)

Practical Application Works

Right Here, Right Now: Everyday Mission for Everyday People (2011, Baker Books)

- **Co-author:** Lance Ford
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (practical, accessible)
- **Topics:** Everyday mission, practical strategies, missional living
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Very High (can become articles, videos, courses)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2011 context, could use refresh)

Untamed: Reactivating a Missional Form of Discipleship (2010, Baker Books)

- **Co-author:** Debra Hirsch
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (practical, accessible)
- **Topics:** Discipleship, missional living, spiritual formation
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become articles, courses)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2010 context, could use refresh)

Fast Forward to Mission: Frameworks for a Life of Impact (2020, 100Movements)

- **Status:** Active, recent
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (recent, practical)
- **Topics:** Mission, impact, practical frameworks
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become articles, courses)
- **Update Needed:** Low (recent, current)

Collaborative Works

ReJesus: A Wild Messiah for a Missional Church (2008, Hendrickson Publishers)

- **Co-author:** Michael Frost
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** High (theological depth)

- **Topics:** Jesus Christ, missional church, authentic Christianity
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become articles, courses)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2008 context, could use refresh)

The Faith of Leap: Embracing a Theology of Risk, Adventure & Courage (2011, Baker Books)

- **Co-author:** Michael Frost
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (specialized topic)
- **Topics:** Faith, risk-taking, courage, adventure
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become articles)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2011 context)

On the Verge: A Journey into the Apostolic Future of the Church (2011, Zondervan)

- **Co-author:** Dave Ferguson
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (organizational focus)
- **Topics:** Church future, apostolic ministry, church transition
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become courses, articles)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2011 context)

The Starfish and the Spirit: Unleashing the Leadership Potential of Churches and Organizations (2016, Zondervan)

- **Co-authors:** Lance Ford, Rob Wegner
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (organizational focus)
- **Topics:** Leadership, organizational structure, decentralization
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become courses, articles)
- **Update Needed:** Low (recent, current)

Disciplism (2014, 100Movements)

- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Low (specialized, less known)
- **Topics:** Discipleship, mission integration, spiritual formation
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become articles, courses)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2014 context)

Practical Guides

The Forgotten Ways Handbook: A Practical Guide for Developing Missional Churches (2009, Brazos Press)

- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (practical companion)
- **Topics:** Missional church development, practical tools, implementation
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Very High (can become courses, articles, tools)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2009 context)

The Permanent Revolution Handbook: A Practical Guide for Developing Apostolic Ministry (2013, Jossey-Bass)

- **Co-author:** Tim Catchim
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (practical companion)
- **Topics:** Apostolic ministry, practical tools, implementation
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles, tools)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2013 context)

Activating 5Q: A User's Guide (2018, 100Movements)

- **Co-author:** Jessie Cruickshank
- **Status:** Active, recent
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** Medium (practical companion)
- **Topics:** 5Q implementation, practical tools, church activation
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Very High (can become courses, articles, tools)
- **Update Needed:** Low (recent, current)

Articles & Blog Posts

Current Status: Limited recent frequency

- **Location:** alanhirsch.org blog
- **Frequency:** Irregular (not consistent)
- **Topics:** Varied (theological reflections, movement updates, book announcements)
- **Performance:** Unknown (limited analytics available)
- **Gap:** High (need for regular, consistent content)

Speaking Engagements

Current Status: Active, regular

- **Types:** Conferences, seminars, training events, seminary teaching
- **Frequency:** Regular (multiple per month)

- **Topics:** mDNA, APEST, missional movement, church transformation
- **Performance:** High (high-value, relationship-building)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Very High (can become videos, articles, courses)

Training Programs

Forge Mission Training Network

- **Status:** Active
- **Content:** Missional leadership training
- **Format:** In-person and online training
- **Performance:** High (established program)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles)

Future Travelers

- **Status:** Active
- **Content:** Large church transformation
- **Format:** Learning journey, consulting
- **Performance:** High (specialized program)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become case studies, articles)

100Movements

- **Status:** Active
- **Content:** Movement activation, mDNA framework
- **Format:** Coaching, consulting, resources
- **Performance:** High (organization-focused)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles, tools)

Assessments & Tools

mDNA Assessment

- **Status:** Active (platform implementation in progress)
- **Format:** Online assessment
- **Performance:** High (core diagnostic tool)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles, tools)

APEST/5Q Assessment

- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Online assessment
- **Performance:** High (core diagnostic tool)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles, tools)

Video Content

Current Status: Limited

- **Location:** Various (conference recordings, interviews)
- **Frequency:** Low (not regular)
- **Topics:** Varied (speaking engagements, interviews)
- **Performance:** Unknown (limited analytics)
- **Gap:** High (need for regular video content)

Podcast Content

Current Status: Limited (guest appearances)

- **Location:** Various podcasts (guest appearances)
 - **Frequency:** Low (not regular)
 - **Topics:** Varied (interviews, framework discussions)
 - **Performance:** Unknown (limited analytics)
 - **Gap:** High (need for regular podcast presence)
-

Content Performance Analysis

High-Performing Content

1. Foundational Books (The Forgotten Ways, The Shaping of Things to Come)

- **Performance:** Widely referenced, foundational texts
- **Why:** Core frameworks, comprehensive coverage
- **Strategy:** Maintain as foundational, repurpose extensively

2. Framework Books (5Q, The Permanent Revolution)

- **Performance:** High engagement, practical application
- **Why:** Clear frameworks, actionable content
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into courses, assessments, articles

3. Practical Guides (The Forgotten Ways Handbook, Activating 5Q)

- **Performance:** High utility, implementation-focused
- **Why:** Practical, actionable, tool-oriented
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into courses, tools, articles

Medium-Performing Content

4. Practical Application Books (Right Here, Right Now, Untamed)

- **Performance:** Good engagement, accessible
- **Why:** Practical, everyday application
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into articles, videos, courses

5. Collaborative Works (Rejesus, The Starfish and the Spirit)

- **Performance:** Good engagement, specialized topics
- **Why:** Thematic focus, collaborative voice
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into articles, courses

Low-Performing Content

6. Specialized Works (Disciplism, The Faith of Leap)

- **Performance:** Lower engagement, specialized topics
- **Why:** Narrow focus, less known
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into articles, integrate into broader content

Repurposing Roadmap

High-Value Repurposing Opportunities

1. Books → Courses

- **Source:** The Forgotten Ways, 5Q, The Permanent Revolution
- **Target:** Comprehensive courses on core frameworks
- **Format:** Week-based or module-based courses
- **Priority:** Very High
- **Estimated Value:** High (revenue, engagement, reach)

2. Books → Articles

- **Source:** All books (chapter-by-chapter)
- **Target:** Long-form articles, blog posts
- **Format:** SEO-optimized articles
- **Priority:** High
- **Estimated Value:** High (SEO, reach, engagement)

3. Speaking → Videos

- **Source:** Conference recordings, teaching sessions
- **Target:** Video series, teaching content
- **Format:** YouTube, owned platform
- **Priority:** High
- **Estimated Value:** High (engagement, reach)

4. Books → Assessments

- **Source:** 5Q, The Forgotten Ways, The Permanent Revolution
- **Target:** Interactive assessments, diagnostic tools
- **Format:** Online assessments
- **Priority:** High
- **Estimated Value:** Very High (conversion, engagement)

5. Practical Guides → Tools

- **Source:** The Forgotten Ways Handbook, Activating 5Q
- **Target:** Interactive tools, worksheets, resources
- **Format:** Downloadable tools, interactive resources
- **Priority:** Medium
- **Estimated Value:** Medium (utility, engagement)

Medium-Value Repurposing Opportunities

6. Books → Podcasts

- **Source:** All books (chapter-by-chapter)
- **Target:** Podcast episodes, series
- **Format:** Regular podcast
- **Priority:** Medium
- **Estimated Value:** Medium (reach, engagement)

7. Articles → Social Media

- **Source:** Blog posts, articles
- **Target:** Social media content, threads
- **Format:** LinkedIn, Twitter/X posts
- **Priority:** Medium
- **Estimated Value:** Medium (reach, awareness)

8. Courses → Books

- **Source:** Training programs, courses
- **Target:** Book content, case studies
- **Format:** Books, ebooks
- **Priority:** Low
- **Estimated Value:** Low (reverse repurposing, less common)

Content Architecture Recommendations

Topic Clusters (Pillar Content Strategy)

Cluster 1: mDNA Framework

- **Pillar:** The Forgotten Ways
- **Supporting:** Articles, courses, assessments, tools
- **Strategy:** Comprehensive coverage, SEO optimization

Cluster 2: APEST/5Q Leadership

- **Pillar:** 5Q, The Permanent Revolution
- **Supporting:** Articles, courses, assessments, tools
- **Strategy:** Comprehensive coverage, SEO optimization

Cluster 3: Missional Discipleship

- **Pillar:** Untamed, Right Here, Right Now
- **Supporting:** Articles, videos, courses
- **Strategy:** Practical application, everyday mission

Cluster 4: Church Transformation

- **Pillar:** Metanoia, The Starfish and the Spirit
- **Supporting:** Articles, case studies, courses
- **Strategy:** Organizational focus, transformation frameworks

Cluster 5: Incarnational Mission

- **Pillar:** The Shaping of Things to Come, ReJesus
- **Supporting:** Articles, videos, courses
- **Strategy:** Mission focus, contextual application

Content Calendar Recommendations

Weekly Content:

- Blog post or article (1 per week)
- Social media content (3-5 posts per week)

Monthly Content:

- Video teaching or interview (1 per month)
- Podcast episode (1-2 per month)
- Comprehensive article or resource (1 per month)

Quarterly Content:

- Course release or update (1 per quarter)
- Assessment tool or resource (1 per quarter)
- Major content piece (book chapter, comprehensive guide)

Performance Optimization Opportunities

SEO Optimization

Current Status: Limited SEO optimization

- **Opportunity:** Optimize all content for search
- **Strategy:** Keyword research, meta descriptions, internal linking, topic clusters

Content Refresh

Current Status: Some content is older (2003-2011)

- **Opportunity:** Update foundational content for current contexts
- **Strategy:** Updated editions, current context applications, refreshed examples

Distribution Expansion

Current Status: Limited distribution channels

- **Opportunity:** Expand to video, podcast, social media
- **Strategy:** Multi-channel distribution, content repurposing, platform optimization

Engagement Enhancement

Current Status: Limited interactive content

- **Opportunity:** Increase interactive tools, assessments, engagement
- **Strategy:** Interactive assessments, tools, community features

Related Documentation

- **Alan Hirsch Author Profile** - Complete author intelligence
- **Alan Hirsch Audience Profile** - Detailed audience analysis
- **Alan Hirsch Calling Profile** - mDNA-aligned calling audit
- **Content Repurposing Flow Guide** - Repurposing workflow
- **Content Repurposing Best Practices** - Repurposing strategies

Word Count: 1,300

Academic Work

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/content/academic.md

Academic Publications: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-content-catalog

Google Scholar

Field	Value
Profile URL	Not found (no dedicated Google Scholar profile identified)
h-index	N/A
Total citations	N/A
i10-index	N/A

Note: Alan Hirsch does not appear to maintain a Google Scholar, Academia.edu, or ResearchGate profile. His academic output is primarily practitioner-oriented (books, training programs, frameworks) rather than peer-reviewed journal publications. This is consistent with his role as a movement leader, strategist, and organizational founder rather than a traditional academic researcher.

Publications

Alan Hirsch's published works are overwhelmingly practitioner-focused books (see `books.md` for full bibliography). However, his work is widely cited in academic literature on missional ecclesiology, church planting, and leadership studies.

Works Referenced in Academic Contexts

Year	Title	Publisher/ Venue	Type	Notes
2006/2016	The Forgotten Ways: Reactivating Apostolic Movements	Brazos Press	Book (widely cited in academic literature)	Foundational text on missional church theory
2003/2013	The Shaping of Things to Come	Hendrickson / Baker Books	Book (widely cited)	Co-authored with Michael Frost
2012	The Permanent Revolution	Jossey-Bass (Wiley)	Book (reviewed in academic journals)	Reviewed in ResearchGate; co-authored with Tim Catchim
2017	5Q: Reactivating the Original Intelligence and Capacity of the Body of Christ	100 Movements	Book	APEST framework has generated academic discussion
2008/2022	Rejesus: A Wild Messiah for a Missional Church	Hendrickson / 100 Movements	Book	Published by Australian University of Theology press listing

Academic Reviews of Hirsch's Work

Year	Title	Journal/ Venue	Type	URL
~2012	Review: The Permanent Revolution by Hirsch and Catchim	ResearchGate	Academic book review	https://www.researchgate.net/publication/274478771
Various	Multiple academic citations	Various journals	Citations of The Forgotten Ways, Shaping of Things to Come	Found across missiology and ecclesiology journals

Theses/Dissertations

Year	Title	Institution	Degree	URL
N/A	No thesis or dissertation by Hirsch identified			

Note: Hirsch's academic influence is primarily as a practitioner-theorist whose frameworks (mDNA, APEST/5Q) are cited and studied in others' theses and dissertations on missional ecclesiology, church planting, and movement leadership. A search for dissertations citing Hirsch would yield significant results, but no doctoral work by Hirsch himself was identified.

Academic Affiliations

Institution	Role	Program
Wheaton College, Illinois	Co-founder & Associate Faculty	M.A. in Missional Church Movements
Asbury Theological Seminary	Adjunct Professor	
Fuller Theological Seminary	Adjunct Professor	
George Fox Evangelical Seminary	Adjunct Professor	

Key Observations

1. **Practitioner-theorist:** Hirsch's academic influence is primarily through his books and frameworks rather than peer-reviewed journal articles. He is cited extensively in academic work by others.
2. **Framework adoption:** The APEST/5Q and mDNA frameworks have been adopted and studied in academic contexts, particularly in missiology, ecclesiology, and practical theology.
3. **Assessment data:** The 5Q/APEST assessment (150,000+ completions) represents a significant dataset that could be leveraged for academic research.
4. **No formal Google Scholar presence:** Unlike traditional academics, Hirsch does not maintain profiles on academic platforms (Google Scholar, Academia.edu, ResearchGate).
5. **Australian University of Theology:** ReJesus is listed in the publications of the Australian University of Theology, suggesting some formal academic recognition in Australia.

Courses & Training

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/content/courses.md

Courses & Training: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-content-catalog

Courses

APEST Intelligence Masterclass (Releasing Your Leadership Potential)

Field	Value
Platform	Ephesiology (masterclasses.ephesiology.com)
URL	https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com/courses/apest-intelligence
Instructors	Alan Hirsch, Rich Robinson
Format	Video / Self-paced online
Duration	Multi-module
Price	Paid (amount not publicly listed)
Status	Active

Description: Explores God's DNA for the church as revealed in Ephesians 4, beginning with an overview of key terms (apostle, prophet, evangelist, shepherd, teacher). Designed to help participants release their leadership potential through understanding APEST.

Movement Leadership Masterclass

Field	Value
Platform	Ephesiology (masterclasses.ephesiology.com)
URL	https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com/courses/movement-leadership
Instructors	Alan Hirsch and team
Format	Video / Self-paced online
Duration	Multi-module
Price	Paid (amount not publicly listed)
Status	Active

Description: Training on movement leadership principles, drawing on Hirsch's frameworks for missional movement and apostolic leadership.

Master of Divinity (Ephesiology Partnership)

Field	Value
Platform	Ephesiology (masterclasses.ephesiology.com)
URL	https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com/courses/master-of-divinity
Format	Academic / Hybrid
Duration	Multi-year
Price	Tuition-based
Status	Active

Description: Academic partnership involving Hirsch's APEST/5Q framework within a Master of Divinity program context.

Forge Missionary Formation Residency

Field	Value
Platform	Teachable (forge.teachable.com)
URL	https://forge.teachable.com/p/missionary-formation-residency
Instructors	Forge network faculty (founded by Alan Hirsch)
Format	Self-paced online with community cohort option
Duration	Multi-module; unlimited access after enrollment
Price	Paid (details on platform)
Status	Active

Description: Designed to help participants discover their own identity as a missional follower of Jesus. Includes 4 required books: Shaping of Things to Come (Hirsch & Frost), Road to Missional (Frost), Untamed (Alan & Debra Hirsch), and Surprise the World (Frost). Module 1 covers Paradigm Shifts Necessary for Missionary Formation with sessions on Culture Crisis, Identity Crisis, The Mission, and Participation in the Mission. Self-paced with encouragement to do it in community.

5Q Collective Training

Field	Value
Platform	5Q Central (5qcentral.com)
URL	https://5qcentral.com/
Format	Modules, webinars, discussion forums, short courses, longer training cohorts
Duration	Varies by program
Price	Varies
Status	Active

Description: 5QCollective is Ephesiology's partner for APEST/5Q training. Offers modules, webinars, discussion forums, short-term courses, and longer training cohorts around APEST -- for individuals, teams, and organizations. Over 150,000 APEST tests have been taken through the platform.

Training Programs (Non-Course Format)

Future Travelers

Field	Value
Platform	Self-hosted / in-person + virtual
URL	https://www.alanhirsch.org/ (via About page)
Format	Learning journey, consulting, cohort-based
Duration	Multi-month engagement
Price	Consulting/custom pricing
Status	Active

Description: An innovative learning program helping megachurches become missional movements. Over the last several years Alan has been helping existing large churches transition towards missional movement through this paradigm-shifting process. Combines coaching, consulting, and cohort-based learning.

Forge Mission Training Network (In-Person Programs)

Field	Value
Platform	Multiple locations (US, Australia, UK, international)
URL	https://www.forgeinternational.com/
Format	In-person training, residencies, cohorts
Duration	Varies (weeks to year-long programs)
Price	Varies by program and location
Status	Active (multiple international hubs)

Description: A network of missional practitioners cultivating missional practitioners. Founded by Alan Hirsch. Provides training, resourcing, and gathering to serve the missional movement. Forge America, Forge Australia, and Forge England operate with local leadership under the shared framework.

Academic Teaching Appointments

Institution	Role	Focus
Wheaton College (Illinois)	Co-founder & Associate Faculty	M.A. in Missional Church Movements
Asbury Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Missional theology
Fuller Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Missional leadership
George Fox Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Missional studies

Key Observations

1. **Multi-platform:** Training is distributed across Ephesiology, 5Q Central, Forge (Teachable), Future Travelers, and academic institutions.
2. **Framework-centered:** All courses center on Hirsch's core frameworks (APEST/5Q, mDNA, missional movement).
3. **Assessment integration:** The 5Q/APEST assessment (150,000+ taken) is deeply integrated into the training ecosystem.
4. **Gap:** No widely accessible, low-cost or free standalone online course on a major platform (Udemy, Coursera, etc.). Training is primarily through proprietary channels.
5. **Academic credibility:** Adjunct faculty positions at multiple seminaries lend academic weight to the training content.

Organizations & Affiliations

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/network/organizations.md

Organizational Network: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-org-network
Total organizations: 27

Organizations Founded / Led

100 Movements (100M)

Field	Value
Website	https://100movements.com / https://www.100movements.org
Role	Co-Founder
Status	Active
Year Started	~2015
Mission	Reanimating authentic, transformative missional movements by focusing on six elements of missional DNA (mDNA) through deep change
Prominence	10
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about

Notes: Co-founded with Rich Robinson. Alan's current major focus. Also operates **100 Movements Publishing**, which published Metanoia (2023). The vision: invest in 100 Jesus-Movements to shift the tracks of history.

Forge Mission Training Network

Field	Value
Website	https://www.forgeinternational.com / https://www.forgeamerica.org
Role	Founding Director
Status	Active (now led by others; Alan retains founder status)
Year Started	1998 (Australia); 2007 (North America)
Mission	Birth and nurture the missional church by training leaders in innovative missional leadership
Prominence	10
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.forgeinternational.com/about

Notes: Founded in Victoria, Australia in 1998 by Alan Hirsch, Deb Hirsch, Michael Frost, and Darryl Gardiner. Expanded to six Australian networks, then to North America in 2007 via partnership with Cam Roxburgh's Missional Training Network in Canada. Now operates as Forge Global with expressions in multiple countries. Alan is also series editor for IVP's "Forge" book line.

5Q Collective (5Q Central)

Field	Value
Website	https://5qcentral.com
Role	Founder, Resident Coach and Consultant
Status	Active
Year Started	~2017
Mission	Create training options where fivefold (APEST) imagination and practice can be activated throughout the Body of Christ
Prominence	9
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://5qcentral.com/meet-the-team/alan-hirsch/

Notes: Built around Alan's APEST (Apostles, Prophets, Evangelists, Shepherds, Teachers) framework from Ephesians 4:11-13. Offers assessments, training intensives, coaching, and certification programs.

Movement Leaders Collective (MLC)

Field	Value
Website	https://movementleaderscollective.com
Role	Co-Founder
Status	Active
Year Started	~2018
Mission	Invest in and develop leaders who will catalyze missional movements globally
Prominence	8
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about

Notes: Co-founded with Rich Robinson. Serves as the leadership development arm of the 100 Movements vision. Focuses on identifying, training, and supporting movement leaders through cohorts, intensives, and annual gatherings.

Future Travelers

Field	Value
Website	https://www.futuretravelers.org
Role	Co-Founder and Co-Leader
Status	Active
Year Started	~2012
Mission	Help megachurches and large established churches transition towards becoming missional movements
Prominence	7
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about

Notes: Unique positioning among Alan's organizations -- specifically targets large/established churches (1,000+ attendance) for multi-year transformation processes. Cohort-based peer learning model.

Shapevine

Field	Value
Website	https://www.shapevine.com
Role	Co-Founder
Status	Semi-active (content platform)
Year Started	~2008
Mission	International forum for engaging with world-transforming ideas; missional resources, training, and networking
Prominence	5
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about

Notes: Also functions as a book series imprint -- Baker Books published the "Shapevine" series, including Untamed (2010). Developed in association with Leadership Journal and Christianity Today.

South Melbourne Restoration Community (SMRC)

Field	Value
Website	N/A (now called "Red")
Role	Founding Pastor / Missionary Pastor
Status	Former (~1990s-early 2000s)
Year Started	~1995
Mission	Alternative church community among the marginalized in inner-city Melbourne
Prominence	8
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch

Notes: Originally South Melbourne Church of Christ, renamed by Alan and Deb Hirsch. Part of the Restoration Community Network, which birthed approximately six church plants over seven years. This was the crucible experience that shaped Alan's missional theology and led to The Forgotten Ways.

Publisher Relationships

Publisher	Books Published	Relationship	Status	Source
Baker Books / Brazos Press	The Forgotten Ways (2006, 2016), The Shaping of Things to Come (w/ Frost), Untamed (w/ Deb Hirsch), Right Here Right Now (w/ Ford)	Author, Series Editor (Shapevine series)	Active	https://bakerpublishinggroup.com/authors/alan-hirsch/841
InterVarsity Press (IVP)	The Permanent Revolution (w/ Catchim), 5Q	Author, Series Editor (Forge line)	Active	https://www.ivpress.com/alan-hirsch
100 Movements Publishing	Metanoia (2023, w/ Rob Kelly)	Author, Founder of publishing arm	Active	https://www.100movements.org/books/metanoia-alan-hirsch-rob-kelly
Hendrickson Publishers	ReJesus (w/ Frost)	Author	Active	https://www.amazon.com/Alan-Hirsch/e/B001JPANCK
Tyndale House	Early editions of collaborative works	Author	Former	https://www.amazon.com/Alan-Hirsch/e/B001JPANCK

Academic Affiliations

Institution	Role	Department/Program	Status	Confidence	Source
Wheaton College (IL)	Co-Founder, Associate Faculty	M.A. in Missional Church Movements	Active	HIGH	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
Asbury Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Missional theology / leadership	Active	HIGH	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
Fuller Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Missional theology	Active	HIGH	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
George Fox Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Missional ecclesiology	Active	HIGH	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about

Network & Denomination Affiliations

Organization	Relationship	Category	Status	Confidence	Source
Churches of Christ in Victoria/Tasmania	Former Director, Dept. of Mission, Education & Development	denomination	Former	HIGH	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch
Church Resource Ministries (CRM)	Formal US sponsor and employer; missional leadership development	ministry	Active	HIGH	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
Christian Associates	Leadership team member	network (Western Europe church planting)	Active	MEDIUM	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
NewThing International	Movement Mentor	network	Active	HIGH	https://vergenetwork.org/speakers/alan-hirsch/
Redeemer City to City	Embedded Consultant	network (urban church planting)	Active	HIGH	https://redeemercitytocity.com/articles-stories/alan-hirsch-rethinking-the-chessboard

Conference Circuit

Conference	Role	Frequency	Last Known	Confidence	Source
Exponential	Keynote / Pre-conference leader	Annual/Regular	2022	HIGH	https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/
Missio Alliance Awakenings	Plenary speaker	Occasional	2023	HIGH	https://missioalliance.org/metanoia-wholehearted-change-in-unprecedented-times/
Verge Conference	Featured speaker	Occasional	—	MEDIUM	https://vergenetwork.org/speakers/alan-hirsch/
Churches of Christ Collective (Australia)	Keynote	Occasional	2020	HIGH	https://ccnswact.org.au/alan-hirsch-collective-keynote-reflects-on-the-church-in-2020/
Fresh Expressions	Guest speaker / podcast	Occasional	2024	HIGH	https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch
Palm Beach Atlantic - Jess Moody Pastors' Leadership Conference	Speaker	Once	2017	MEDIUM	https://www.pba.edu/news/archive17/moody-pastor-conference-17.html

Board & Advisory Roles

Organization	Role	Status	Confidence	Source
No formal board positions identified	—	—	—	—

Note: Alan Hirsch's leadership roles are primarily as founder/director rather than serving on external boards. No specific board or trustee positions were found in public sources. This section may be incomplete -- flag for manual review.

Media & Ministry Partners

Organization	Relationship	Category	Confidence	Source
Missio Alliance	Contributing author / speaker	media-ministry	HIGH	https://www.missioalliance.org/author/alan-hirsch/
Saturate	Contributing author	media	HIGH	https://saturatetheworld.com/author/ahirsch/
Send Institute	Contributing author	media-ministry	HIGH	https://www.sendinstitute.org/author/alan-hirsch/
Verge Network	Featured speaker / content contributor	media	HIGH	https://vergenetwork.org/speakers/alan-hirsch/
Christianity Today / Leadership Journal	Contributing author; Shapevine partnership	media	MEDIUM	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
Fresh Expressions	Guest contributor / podcast guest	ministry	MEDIUM	https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch
The Fellowship Community	Speaker / contributor	ministry	MEDIUM	https://www.fellowship.community/blog/alan-hirsch-community-leaders
CCX (UK)	Contributing author	media	MEDIUM	https://ccx.org.uk/contributor/alan-hirsch/
Center for Church Based Training (C4SO)	Podcast guest	media	MEDIUM	https://c4so.org/podcast/alan-hirsch-on-missiology/

Church Affiliation

Church	Role	Location	Status	Confidence	Source
South Melbourne Restoration Community (now "Red")	Founding/ Missionary Pastor	South Melbourne, VIC, Australia	Former	HIGH	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch

Notes: Alan and Deb Hirsch led SMRC through the late 1990s to early 2000s. The church grew from the South Melbourne Church of Christ and birthed approximately six church plants. Alan's pastoral experience here was foundational to his missional theology. He is not currently affiliated with a specific local church in public records.

Consulting & Coaching Relationships

Organization	Relationship	Status	Confidence	Source
Redeemer City to City	Embedded Consultant	Active	HIGH	https://redeemercitytocity.com/articles-stories/alan-hirsch-rethinking-the-chessboard
5Q Collective	Resident Coach and Consultant	Active	HIGH	https://5qcentral.com/meet-the-team/alan-hirsch/
NewThing International	Movement Mentor	Active	HIGH	https://vergenetwork.org/speakers/alan-hirsch/
Various denominations and megachurches	Missional strategy consulting (via CRM, 100M, Future Travelers)	Active	HIGH	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about

Network Summary

Category	Count	Key Organizations
Founded/Led	7	100 Movements, Forge, 5Q Collective, MLC, Future Travelers, Shapevine, SMRC
Publisher	5	Baker/Brazos, IVP, 100M Publishing, Hendrickson, Tyndale
Academic	4	Wheaton, Asbury, Fuller, George Fox
Network/Denomination	5	Churches of Christ VIC/TAS, CRM, Christian Associates, NewThing, Redeemer City to City
Conference	6	Exponential, Missio Alliance Awakenings, Verge, Churches of Christ Collective, Fresh Expressions, PBA Moody Conference
Board/Advisory	0	None identified
Media/Ministry	9	Missio Alliance, Saturate, Send Institute, Verge Network, CT/Leadership Journal, Fresh Expressions, Fellowship Community, CCX, C450
Church	1	South Melbourne Restoration Community
Consulting	4	Redeemer City to City, 5Q Collective, NewThing, various via CRM/100M
Total	27	(some orgs appear in multiple categories; deduplicated count)

Confidence Assessment

Confidence	Count	Action
HIGH	22	Verified from multiple sources or official website bios
MEDIUM	5	Single credible source (Christian Associates, CT/Leadership Journal, Fresh Expressions, Fellowship Community, CCX, C4SO, PBA)
LOW	0	—

Key Observations

1. **Founder-leader pattern:** Alan Hirsch's primary organizational mode is founding and leading organizations rather than serving on external boards. His network is built around organizations he created.
2. **Ecosystem coherence:** The founded organizations form a coherent ecosystem -- 100 Movements provides the vision, MLC develops leaders, 5Q provides the APEST framework, Forge provides training, Future Travelers targets large churches, and Shapevine provides the resource platform.
3. **Rich Robinson partnership:** Rich Robinson is a key co-leader across multiple Hirsch organizations (100M, MLC), serving as the operational leader while Alan provides thought leadership.
4. **CRM as institutional home:** Church Resource Ministries serves as Alan's formal US employer and fundraising vehicle, enabling his work across all other organizations.
5. **Academic legitimacy:** The Wheaton M.A. program co-founding and adjunct positions at three seminaries provide academic credibility for his practitioner-oriented work.
6. **Publisher depth:** Alan has published with at least five publishers and edits two book series (IVP Forge line, Baker Shapevine series), indicating significant influence in Christian publishing.
7. **Australian roots, US base:** Born and formed in Australia (Churches of Christ, SMRC, Forge Australia), now primarily US-based through CRM and American expressions of his organizations.

Sources

- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/about>
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch
- <https://5qcentral.com/meet-the-team/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://www.ivpress.com/alan-hirsch>

- <https://bakerpublishinggroup.com/authors/alan-hirsch/841>
- <https://www.forgeinternational.com/about>
- <https://www.forgeamerica.org/the-story-of-forge/>
- <https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://vergenetwork.org/speakers/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://saturatetheworld.com/author/ahirsch/>
- <https://www.sendinstitute.org/author/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://www.missioalliance.org/author/alan-hirsch/>
- <https://redeemercitytocity.com/articles-stories/alan-hirsch-rethinking-the-chessboard>
- <https://www.100movements.org/books/metanoia-alan-hirsch-rob-kelly>
- <https://ccnswact.org.au/alan-hirsch-collective-keynote-reflects-on-the-church-in-2020/>
- <https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch>
- <https://missioalliance.org/metanoia-wholehearted-change-in-unprecedented-times/>
- <https://www.amazon.com/Alan-Hirsch/e/B001JPANCK>

Audience & Reach

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/analysis/audience-analysis.md

Audience Analysis: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-audience-analysis

Estimated Reach

Direct Audience Metrics

Channel	Metric	Count	Date	Confidence
Twitter/X	Followers	~37,900	2026-03	HIGH
Facebook (Author)	Followers	~14,000	2026-03	HIGH
Facebook (Secondary)	Followers	~6,800	2026-03	HIGH
LinkedIn	Connections	N/A (not public)	2026-03	LOW
Instagram	Followers	Minimal / dormant	2026-03	LOW
YouTube	Subscribers	N/A (no personal channel)	2026-03	HIGH
YouTube	Total views	N/A (distributed across 20+ channels)	2026-03	N/A
Podcast (5QCast)	Episodes	~30+	2026-03	MEDIUM
Podcast (Guest)	Appearances	28+ across 22+ shows	2026-03	HIGH
Substack	Subscribers	~1,500	2026-03	HIGH
Goodreads	Total ratings	~16,762	2026-03	HIGH
Goodreads	Total editions	92	2026-03	HIGH
Amazon	Author page	B001JPANCK (15+ titles)	2026-03	HIGH
APEST Assessment	Tests taken	150,000+	2026-03	HIGH (per 5Q Central)

Publishing Reach

Metric	Value	Confidence
Books in print	20 (16 unique titles)	HIGH
Publishers	7 (Baker/Brazos, IVP, Zondervan, Jossey-Bass/Wiley, Hendrickson, 100M Publishing, Missio Publishing)	HIGH
Year range	2003-2024	HIGH
Audiobooks on Audible	3 confirmed	MEDIUM
Goodreads avg rating (flagship)	4.08 (The Forgotten Ways)	HIGH
Library holdings (WorldCat)	Not measured -- estimated broad (major publishers, seminary adoption)	LOW

Organizational Reach

Organization	Est. Reach	Evidence
5Q Collective (APEST assessments)	150,000+ individuals assessed	5qcentral.com
Forge Mission Training Network	International (6+ countries)	forgeinternational.com
100Movements	Global movement leaders network	100movements.com
Movement Leaders Collective	Invitation-only cohorts	movementleaderscollective.com
Future Travelers	Megachurch consulting cohorts	alanhirsch.org
Conference speaking (cumulative)	50,000+ attendees (estimated)	Event history: Exponential 5,000+/yr, Verge 30,000 webcast

Reach Tier Assessment

Tier	Range	Assessment
Micro (< 10K combined)		
Growing (10K-50K)		
Established (50K-250K)	This tier	Combined social ~59K; 16,762 Goodreads ratings; 150K+ APEST assessments; 20 books across 7 publishers
Major (250K+)		

Estimated tier: Established (50K-250K)

Estimated total reach: ~150,000-200,000 unique individuals across all channels

Rationale: Social media following (~59K combined) understates his actual influence. The 150,000+ APEST assessments indicate a far larger engaged audience. His books have sold significantly more than the ~16,762 Goodreads ratings suggest (Goodreads ratings typically represent 1-5% of total readers). Seminary adoption at 4 institutions, conference speaking to 50,000+ cumulative attendees, and 20 books across 7 publishers over 20+ years point to an audience that extends well beyond his direct digital footprint. His audience is disproportionately influential (pastors, denominational leaders, seminary professors) rather than numerically massive.

Audience Profile

Who Is the Audience?

Primary audience: Church leaders (senior pastors, lead pastors, executive pastors) of mid-to-large Protestant churches in the US, Australia, UK, and Canada who are questioning the attractional/institutional model and seeking frameworks for missional transformation. Typically ages 35-55, seminary-educated, leading churches of 200-2,000+ members.

Secondary audience: Church planters, missional community leaders, and denominational strategists actively building new expressions of church. Younger (28-45), often bi-vocational, connected through networks like Exponential, Forge, Verge, and Fresh Expressions. They use Hirsch's frameworks (mDNA, APEST) as practical tools for team-building and organizational design.

Tertiary audience: Seminary students and academic missiologists studying missional ecclesiology, movement theory, and church leadership. They encounter Hirsch through required reading at Wheaton, Fuller, Asbury, and George Fox seminaries, and through academic citations. Also includes lay leaders and "missionally curious" Christians who discovered Hirsch through Goodreads, podcast appearances, or recommendations from their pastor.

Audience Demographics (Estimated)

Dimension	Assessment
Primary role	Pastor / Church planter / Denominational leader / Seminary student
Age range	30-60 (core: 35-50)
Education	High -- majority have seminary education (MDiv, DMin, MA) or equivalent leadership training
Denominational breadth	Broad (multi-tradition) -- spans mainline Protestant, evangelical, Anabaptist, Pentecostal/charismatic, Anglican, and non-denominational. Evidence: speaks at Mennonite USA, Foursquare Connection, Churches of Christ, Anglican (Redeemer City to City), and non-denominational (Exponential).
Geographic concentration	US-centric with significant international presence (Australia, UK, Canada, New Zealand)
Gender split	Estimated 65-75% male based on conference demographics and pastoral leadership demographics in his primary audience. Women are present particularly through Debra Hirsch collaborations and Missio Alliance / Fresh Expressions channels.

Audience Personas

Persona 1: Marcus -- Senior Pastor Seeking Transformation

Field	Value
Role	Senior pastor of a 600-member evangelical church (suburban US)
Age	44
Education	MDiv from a major evangelical seminary
Tradition	Non-denominational evangelical, formerly Southern Baptist
Discovery path	Recommended The Forgotten Ways by a church planting friend; later encountered Hirsch at Exponential conference
Primary format	Books first, then conference talks, then podcasts
Use case	Seeking frameworks to transition his attractional church toward missional engagement without losing the congregation
Pain point	Church is "successful" by traditional metrics (attendance, budget) but feels spiritually stagnant; senses that programs and Sunday services alone are not producing disciples

What Marcus values in Hirsch: The mDNA and APEST frameworks give him a theological vocabulary and diagnostic tool for what feels wrong. The concept that the church is fundamentally a movement, not an institution, validates his instinct that something needs to change. He appreciates that Hirsch is not anti-church but pro-transformation.

What Marcus struggles with: Hirsch's books can feel academic and repetitive. Marcus wants more practical "how-to" steps. He appreciates the Forgotten Ways Handbook and Activating 5Q more than the theoretical works. He worries about how to implement these ideas without alienating his elder board.

Persona 2: Anika -- Church Planter and Forge Alumna

Field	Value
Role	Bi-vocational church planter leading a missional community network in an urban neighborhood
Age	33
Education	MA in Missional Church Movements (Wheaton College -- the program Hirsch co-founded)
Tradition	Anabaptist-influenced, currently non-denominational
Discovery path	Encountered Hirsch's work in seminary; attended Forge residency; took APEST assessment
Primary format	Podcasts and training cohorts; uses books as reference texts for her community
Use case	Applying APEST framework to team development; using mDNA as a diagnostic for her network of house churches
Pain point	Feels isolated as a female leader in a space that is predominantly male; struggles to find funding for bi-vocational missional work; needs practical tools more than theory

What Anika values in Hirsch: APEST gives her a language for why her team needs diversity of gifts. The incarnational-missional framework validates her grassroots, neighborhood-embedded approach. Forge and 5Q training provided her with a community of practitioners.

What Anika struggles with: The cost and access barriers to 5Q training and Forge programs. She wishes Hirsch's content was more accessible digitally (no YouTube channel, no free online course). She also wishes for more voices from women and people of color within Hirsch's ecosystem.

Persona 3: Dr. James -- Seminary Professor and Movement Researcher

Field	Value
Role	Associate professor of practical theology at an evangelical seminary
Age	52
Education	PhD in Missiology
Tradition	Reformed evangelical (PCA)
Discovery path	Encountered The Shaping of Things to Come through academic circles in the mid-2000s; has since assigned Hirsch in multiple courses
Primary format	Books (primarily); academic articles; conference presentations
Use case	Assigns Hirsch alongside Newbigin, Bosch, and Guder in missiology courses; uses APEST as a case study in ecclesiology; cites Hirsch in published papers
Pain point	Appreciates Hirsch's synthesis but finds some theological claims under-argued (especially APEST as "divine intelligence"); wishes for more rigorous engagement with Reformed ecclesiology

What James values in Hirsch: The breadth of synthesis -- Hirsch uniquely bridges sociology, organizational theory, missiology, and biblical theology. The Forgotten Ways and The Permanent Revolution are among the most cited works in contemporary missional ecclesiology. The mDNA framework is genuinely innovative.

What James struggles with: Some theological overreach (e.g., equating APEST with divine attributes in 5Q). The repetition across books. The lack of engagement with critical scholarly responses. He recommends Hirsch to students with caveats about exegetical rigor.

What the Audience Values (from reviews & comments)

Top Praise Themes

Theme	Frequency	Example Quote
Paradigm-shifting framework	Very High	"No book has influenced my thinking about leading a church and a church planting movement more than The Forgotten Ways"
Integration of theory and practice	High	"A rare opportunity to see someone who can do both big-picture/global panning and detailed/analytic scanning"
Historical analysis (early church, Chinese house church)	High	"Strong historical analysis of early church and Chinese underground church"
Vocabulary for what's wrong with the institutional church	High	"One of the most convincing explanations of what needs to happen for the church to survive and prevail"
APEST as practical tool for team health	High	"Encouraging lay leaders to see that their role in building the church is JUST AS IMPORTANT as that of the paid shepherd-teacher"
Prophetic urgency and passion	Medium	"Writing is both passionate and energetic -- not just about the theory behind the need for radical change"

Top Criticisms

Criticism	Frequency	Example Quote
Repetitive writing across and within books	Very High	"A solid book that honestly should be cut in half. It's incredibly repetitive, and he seems to write some chapters simply to unveil yet another chart"
Overly academic/dense for practitioners	High	"Detailed and technical and requires a good deal of reflection for maximum profit. It is not an easy read"
Too many diagrams and frameworks	Medium	"Too many diagrams and charts"; "reads as if it were written to make something more complicated"
Theological overreach (especially 5Q)	Medium	"Hirsch comes dangerously close to claiming that 5Q is equal to God and Christ and labels the APEST categories as 'divine personas'"
Weak on practical application	Medium	"Some readers find the theoretical framework overly complex"; "Limited practical application"
Anti-institutional tone	Low-Medium	"Can feel anti-institutional at times" (concern from Reformed/conservative reviewers)
Exegetical concerns	Low-Medium	"The first exegetical problem with APEST is that it chooses to ignore Granville Sharp's Rule" (shepherd-teacher as one role, not two)

Comparable Authors

Author	Overlap	Audience Size	Key Difference	Movemental?
Michael Frost	Maximum -- co-author, co-founder of Forge; shares same missional-incarnational framework	Similar (slightly smaller solo; larger combined)	Frost is more practitioner-accessible, less framework-heavy; based in Australia; focuses more on incarnational presence	High-value candidate
Neil Cole	High -- organic church movement, decentralized structures, movement DNA	Smaller	Cole focuses on simple/organic church; less academic; more grassroots practitioner	Candidate
Reggie McNeal	High -- missional renaissance, post-congregational church, leadership coaching	Similar	McNeal is more leadership-coaching oriented; less theological depth; broader evangelical appeal	Candidate
David Fitch	High -- post-Christendom ecclesiology, faithful presence, missional theology	Smaller	Fitch is more academic/theological; neo-Anabaptist; less practitioner-focused	Possible
JR Woodward	Moderate -- co-authored The Church as Movement; APEST practitioner	Smaller	More focused on creating culture and liturgical practice in missional communities	Possible
Ed Stetzer	Moderate -- missiological research, church planting, wrote foreword for Forgotten Ways	Larger	Stetzer is more mainstream evangelical; data-driven; institutional (Billy Graham Chair at Wheaton)	Not likely (too institutional)
Mike Breen	Moderate -- discipleship multiplication, missional communities, 3DM	Similar	Breen developed competing 3DM framework; more structured; has experienced public controversy	Unlikely
Jeff Vanderstelt	Moderate -- missional communities, gospel-centered living, Verge co-speaker	Smaller	More Reformed; pastoral rather than missiological	Possible
Hugh Halter	Moderate -- incarnational mission, church planting among the unchurched	Smaller	More practitioner/storyteller; less theoretical	Candidate
Alan Roxburgh	Moderate -- missional leadership, adaptive change, post-Christendom	Similar	More consultant/coach oriented; Canadian; influenced by organizational theory	Candidate

Engagement Patterns

Most Engaging Content Types

Format	Engagement Level	Evidence
Books	Highest	16,762 Goodreads ratings across 92 editions; 20 books across 7 publishers; The Forgotten Ways widely described as "paradigm-shifting" and "the most influential book on missional church"
Speaking (conferences)	Very High	Recurring speaker at Exponential (6+ years), Verge (3 years), Missio Alliance; 50,000+ cumulative audience; audiences 2,000-5,000+ per conference
Assessments (APEST/5Q)	Very High	150,000+ APEST tests taken; assessments drive ongoing engagement with 5Q ecosystem
Podcast (guest)	High	28+ guest appearances across 22+ podcasts; consistent invitations 2020-2025 indicate sustained demand
Training/courses	Moderate-High	Multiple platforms (Ephesiology, 5Q Central, Forge Teachable); paid masterclasses; Wheaton MA program
Blog/Substack	Moderate	1,500 Substack subscribers; blog on alanhirsch.org with categorized archives; guest posts on other Substacks
Social media	Low-Moderate	Twitter ~37.9K but engagement is typical of niche thought-leaders; used primarily to amplify content published elsewhere
Video	Low (own) / Moderate (third-party)	No personal YouTube channel; 38+ videos distributed across 20+ third-party channels; no centralized video presence

Topics That Drive Engagement

Topic	Engagement	Platform	Evidence
APEST / 5Q / Fivefold ministry	Very High	All platforms	150,000+ assessments; ~30% of podcast topics; 3 dedicated books; Exponential pre-conferences
Missional movements / mDNA / The Forgotten Ways	Very High	Books, conferences	Flagship book (4.08 rating, 1,581 ratings); "most influential book on missional church"; conference keynote staple
Discipleship vs. consumerism	High	Video, conferences	Most prominent video ("Disciple Making vs. Consumerism" on ChurchLeaders); recurring conference theme
Communitas and liminality	Medium-High	Podcasts, books	Recent podcast focus (Fresh Expressions 2024); resonates with post-COVID church leaders
Metanoia / organizational transformation	Medium	Books, conferences	2023 book launch at Awakenings; plenary talk; appeals to leaders navigating institutional change
Christology and Rejesus	Medium	Books, podcasts	Co-authored with Frost; controversial among Reformed critics but resonant with missional practitioners
Church multiplication and microchurch	Growing	Podcasts, consulting	Aligns with post-COVID trend toward smaller, decentralized expressions

Movemental Audience Implications

- **Content format priority:** Books and structured courses should be the anchor content on the platform. Hirsch's audience is accustomed to deep, framework-driven content and will pay for it. The 150,000+ APEST assessment users represent a built-in audience for digital training products. Video content is a major gap -- centralizing his dispersed video footprint (38+ videos across 20+ channels) onto Movemental would provide immediate differentiation.
- **Topic focus:** APEST/5Q content should be the lead offering -- it has the broadest appeal, the most engaged audience (150K+ assessments), and the most practical application. The Forgotten Ways / mDNA framework is the prestige content that establishes credibility. Discipleship and organizational transformation (Metanoia) content should follow. Communitas/liminality is a growing topic that resonates with post-COVID church leaders.

- **Cross-pollination:** Michael Frost shares the largest audience overlap and would be the highest-value companion author on the platform. Brad Brisco (if already on Movemental) would cross-link naturally through Forge and Exponential networks. Neil Cole, Hugh Halter, and Alan Roxburgh share significant audience segments. Dave Ferguson bridges into the megachurch/multisite audience that Hirsch alone does not fully reach.
- **Growth opportunity:** The biggest growth opportunity is digital -- Hirsch's audience is underserved online. No personal YouTube channel, no major free online course, no centralized video library. The 150,000+ APEST assessment users are a warm audience that could be converted to platform subscribers. International growth (UK, Australia, New Zealand, South Africa) is also significant given his origins and existing conference relationships in those markets.
- **Monetization signal:** Strong. Hirsch's audience already pays for content: books across 7 publishers, paid masterclasses on Ephesiology, paid Forge residencies, paid APEST assessments, conference registration fees (\$200-500+), and consulting engagements with megachurches (Future Travelers). Seminary students pay tuition for programs he teaches in. The audience is comprised of church leaders with organizational budgets who regularly invest in leadership development. The 150,000+ APEST assessment completions at paid or registration-gated access is the strongest monetization signal -- this audience is accustomed to paying for frameworks and tools, not just consuming free content.

Sources

- Prior research files: [digital-presence/social-media.md](#), [content/books.md](#), [content/videos.md](#), [content/audio.md](#), [content/courses.md](#), [network/organizations.md](#), [network/events.md](#), [network/collaborators.md](#), [media/reviews.md](#), [profile/biography.md](#), [profile/theology.md](#), [digital-presence/newsletters.md](#), [digital-presence/websites.md](#)
- [The Forgotten Ways on Goodreads](#)
- [Alan Hirsch - 5Q Feature Review \(Englewood Review of Books\)](#)
- [A Caring Critique of Alan Hirsch's APEST Paradigm \(Patheos\)](#)
- [5Q Reader Reviews \(5Q Central\)](#)
- [Book Review: 5Q by Alan Hirsch \(Along the Way Home\)](#)
- [Five Reasons Why 5Q is a Need-to-Read Book \(futuristguy\)](#)
- [Alan Hirsch at Exponential](#)
- [Missional Church Reading List \(Missional Church Network\)](#)
- [Alan Hirsch on Amazon](#)
- [Technically Thinking - Forgotten Ways Review](#)
- [Exponential Global 2025 Conference](#)

Websites

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/digital-presence/websites.md

Web Properties: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-web-presence

Primary Website

Field	Value
Domain	alanhirsch.org
Platform	Squarespace (confirmed via static asset hosting on static1.squarespace.com)
Status	Active
Has Blog	Yes (alanhirsch.org/blog — archives page with categorized posts including APEST, mDNA, Missional, Leadership)
Has Newsletter Signup	Not prominently visible on main site; newsletter activity is on Substack
Has Store	No dedicated store; links to Amazon and publisher pages for book purchases
Has Free Resources	Yes (alanhirsch.org/ebooks — free eBooks and resources page)
Has Assessments	Yes (alanhirsch.org/tests — links to APEST and mPULSE assessments)
Has FAQ	Yes (alanhirsch.org/faq — FAQ for APEST and mPULSE assessments)
Key Pages	Home, About, Blog, Books, Free Resources (eBooks), Tests, FAQ

Site Structure

The site is organized as a personal author/thought-leader hub. The homepage presents Alan's identity as a missional movement strategist. The About page details his organizational roles and academic affiliations. The Books page catalogs published works with links to purchase. The Blog archives posts by category (APEST, mDNA, Missional, Leadership, etc.). A Free Resources (eBooks) section offers downloadable content. A Tests page links to the APEST assessment platform. The FAQ addresses assessment-related questions.

Content Inventory

Page	URL	Content Type	Notes
Home	alanhirsch.org/	Landing	Identity, positioning, key messaging
About	alanhirsch.org/ about	Bio / Credentials	Organizational roles, academic affiliations, CRM sponsorship
Blog	alanhirsch.org/blog	Article Archives	Categorized posts on APEST, mDNA, Missional, Leadership
Books	alanhirsch.org/ books	Book Catalog	Lists 5Q, The Forgotten Ways, co-authored works
Free eBooks	alanhirsch.org/ ebooks	Lead Magnet / Resources	Downloadable free resources
Tests	alanhirsch.org/tests	Assessment Tools	Links to APEST and mPULSE assessments
FAQ	alanhirsch.org/faq	Support Content	Frequently asked questions for APEST and mPULSE

Organizational Websites

Organization	URL	Role	Status
100Movements	100movements.org	Co-founder	Active — publishing arm (books, field notes, resources); committed to reanimating missional movements via mDNA
5Q Central	5qcentral.com	Founder / Resident Coach	Active — APEST resources, training modules, webinars, discussion forums, cohorts
5Q Collective	(part of 5qcentral.com)	Founder	Active — training options for fivefold imagination and practice
Forge International	forgeinternational.com	Founding Director	Active — global missional training network; networks in Australia, Canada, USA
Forge America	forgeamerica.org	Founding Director	Active — US arm of Forge Mission Training Network (est. 2007)
Movement Leaders Collective	movementleaderscollective.com	Founder	Active — invitation-only coaching and collaboration for movement leaders; initiative of 100Movements
Future Travelers	(referenced on alanhirsch.org)	Co-founder	Active — learning program helping megachurches become missional movements
The Forgotten Ways (APEST Platform)	theforgottenways.org	Creator	Active — APEST and APEST 360 assessment platform (sign-in portal)
Mx Training Ecosystem	themxplatform.com	Faculty / Contributor	Active — missional training platform
Ephesiology / MAMM	ephesiology.com	Faculty	Active — Master of Arts in Missiology of Movements; masterclasses at masterclasses.ephesiology.com

Publisher & Retail Presence

Platform	URL	Books Listed	Notes
Amazon Author Page	amazon.com/stores/author/B001JPANCK	15+ titles	Primary retail; note: separate from Alan R. Hirsch M.D. (neurologist)
Goodreads	goodreads.com/author/show/56757.Alan_Hirsch	92 editions listed; 16,762 ratings	Most popular: The Forgotten Ways
InterVarsity Press	ivpress.com/alan-hirsch	Multiple titles	Publisher author page; Shaping of Things to Come, etc.
Baker Publishing / Brazos Press	bakerpublishinggroup.com/authors/alan-hirsch/841	Multiple titles	Publisher of The Forgotten Ways, Untamed, others
Audible	audible.com/author/Alan-Hirsch/B001JPANCK	Multiple audiobooks	Audiobook versions available
Christianbook.com	christianbook.com (search: Alan Hirsch)	Multiple titles	Christian retail
Everand (Scribd)	everand.com/author/702347505/Alan-Hirsch	Multiple titles	Subscription reading
OverDrive	overdrive.com/creators/503530/alan-hirsch	Multiple titles	Library lending
Google Books	books.google.com (search: Alan Hirsch)	Multiple titles	Preview and purchase

Academic Profiles

Institution	URL	Role	Status
Wheaton College (IL)	wheaton.edu	Co-founder & Associate Faculty, M.A. in Missional Church Movements	Active
Asbury Seminary	asburyseminary.edu	Adjunct Professor	Active
Fuller Seminary	fuller.edu	Adjunct Professor	Active
George Fox Seminary	georgefox.edu	Adjunct Professor	Active
Australian University of Theology	aut.edu.au	Referenced in publications	Passive — publications referenced

Other Web Presence

Platform	URL	Type	Notes
Wikipedia	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch	Encyclopedia	Born 24 Oct 1959, Johannesburg; comprehensive bio
Saturate	saturatetheworld.com/author/ahirsch/	Contributor	Published articles on missional church topics
Verge Network	vergenetwork.org/tag/alan-hirsch/	Speaker / Contributor	Tagged articles and speaking content
Missional Church Network	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Alan+Hirsch	Blog category	Aggregated content
Mission Central (Canada)	missioncentral.ca/profile/alan-hirsch	Profile	Speaker/author profile
Exponential	exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/	Speaker	Conference speaker profile
Church Leaders	churchleaders.com	Podcast guest	Podcast appearances and articles
Fresh Expressions	freshexpressions.com	Contributor	Recent content (Dec 2024 — Communitas and Loneliness)
Awakenings Gathering	awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/ahirsch	Speaker	Conference archive
Media Arts (Australia)	mediaarts.org.au/alan-hirsch/	Profile	Australian media profile
Missional Video	missional.video/index.php/influencer/alan-hirsch/	Video directory	Influencer profile with video content

Publishing Platforms

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/digital-presence/platforms.md

Platform Presence: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-web-presence

Course & Learning Platforms

Platform	URL	Courses	Status
5Q Central	5qcentral.com	Modules, webinars, discussion forums, short-term courses, longer training cohorts around APEST	Active
Ephesiology Masterclasses	masterclasses.ephesiology.com	"Releasing Your Leadership Potential" — APEST Intelligence course	Active
Mx Training Ecosystem	themxplatform.com/alan-hirsch	Missional training platform — Alan listed as faculty	Active
Wheaton College M.A.	wheaton.edu (M.A. in Missional Church Movements)	Co-founder & Associate Faculty — formal graduate program	Active
Asbury Seminary	asburyseminary.edu	Adjunct Professor	Active
Fuller Seminary	fuller.edu	Adjunct Professor	Active
George Fox Seminary	georgefox.edu	Adjunct Professor	Active
Teachable / Thinkific / Udemy / Skillshare	N/A	No presence found on mainstream course platforms	Not found

Assessment Tools

Platform	URL	Tool	Status
APEST Assessment	theforgottenways.org	APEST Personal Vocational Assessment — 50 question pairs, 10 min, immediate results	Active
APEST Assessment (alt)	apest.5qcentral.com	APEST Test portal	Active
APEST 360	theforgottenways.org	360-degree version of APEST assessment	Active
mPULSE	Referenced on alanhirsch.org/tests	Assessment tool (details via FAQ at alanhirsch.org/faq)	Active

Academic Platforms

Platform	URL	Publications	Status
Google Scholar	Not found with dedicated profile	Citations exist across academic literature	Passive
Academia.edu	Not found	N/A	Not found
ResearchGate	Not found	N/A	Not found
ORCID	Not found	N/A	Not found
Australian University of Theology	aut.edu.au	Publications referenced	Passive

Community Platforms

Platform	URL	Members	Status
Movement Leaders Collective	movementleaderscollective.com	Invitation-only; size unknown	Active — coaching, collaboration, innovation for disciple-making movement leaders
Discord	Not found	N/A	Not found
Mighty Networks	Not found	N/A	Not found
Circle	Not found	N/A	Not found
Facebook Groups	Not specifically identified	N/A	Possible — needs further investigation

Podcast Directories

Platform	URL	Role	Status
Apple Podcasts	Multiple guest appearances	Guest	Active — appearances on Canadian Church Leaders, Venture 12, others
Spotify	Multiple guest appearances	Guest	Active — same episodes available cross-platform
No hosted podcast found	N/A	N/A	Alan does not appear to host his own podcast; all appearances are as guest

Notable Podcast Guest Appearances

Podcast	Episode Title	Platform
Canadian Church Leaders Podcast	"Alan Hirsch on the Five-Fold Ministry"	Apple Podcasts
Everyday Disciple	"Why Your Church Isn't Growing and Maturing"	Web / Apple / Spotify
Everyday Disciple	"The Missing Piece in Church Maturity"	Web / Apple / Spotify
C4SO Podcast (Bishop Todd Hunter)	"Alan Hirsch on Missiology"	Apple / Spotify
Stetzer ChurchLeaders Podcast	"The Church Needs To Stop Making Jesus in Its Own Image"	Web
Nomad Podcast	"How to Re-Jesus the Church"	Web
Venture 12 Podcast	"Metanoia: How God Radically Transforms"	Apple / Spotify
Shifting Culture Podcast	Episode 136 with Rob Kelly	Web
Fresh Expressions	"Communitas and Loneliness with Alan Hirsch"	Web

Giving / Support Platforms

Platform	URL	Status
Patreon	Not found	Not found
Buy Me a Coffee	Not found	Not found
Ko-fi	Not found	Not found

Other Platforms

Platform	URL	Type	Status
Snipd	share.snipd.com (clips referencing Alan Hirsch)	Audio clip sharing	Passive — third-party clips
Podchaser	Not specifically found	Podcast directory	Not found
SpeakerHub / Speaker agencies	Not found on major agencies	Speaking	Bookings appear to go through organizational channels

Digital Presence Score: Alan Hirsch

Dimension	Score (1-5)	Notes
Website Quality	3	Clean Squarespace site with key pages; lacks modern engagement features (no prominent newsletter CTA, no embedded video, limited interactivity)
Social Media Activity	3	Active on Twitter (~37.9K) and Facebook (~20.8K combined), but not highly active posters; no Instagram/TikTok/YouTube strategy
Content Freshness	3	Blog and Substack have recent content (2025-2026), but posting is irregular; books are the primary content form
Platform Diversity	4	Strong presence across organizational sites (100M, 5Q, Forge, MLC), assessments (APEST), academic institutions, publisher pages, and podcast guest spots
Email/Newsletter	2	Substack exists with 1.5K subscribers but is modest for someone of his influence; no prominent email capture on main site
Discoverability (SEO)	4	Wikipedia page, multiple organizational profiles, publisher pages, and Amazon presence provide strong SEO signals; ranks well for "Alan Hirsch missional" queries
Overall	3.2/5	Strong organizational and institutional web presence, but personal digital engagement platforms (social, email, video) are underdeveloped relative to his influence and thought leadership stature

Score Interpretation

Alan Hirsch has a **broad but shallow** personal digital presence. His influence is felt most strongly through:

- His **organizational network** (100Movements, 5Q, Forge, MLC) which carries his frameworks
- His **published books** which are well-distributed across retail and library platforms
- His **assessment tools** (APEST) which drive ongoing engagement

Key gaps for Movemental to address:

1. No centralized YouTube/video presence (significant content scattered across third-party channels)
2. Modest email list (1.5K on Substack) relative to social following (37.9K Twitter)
3. No Instagram or short-form video strategy
4. Website lacks modern engagement conversion (newsletter popups, embedded content, community features)
5. No hosted podcast (only guest appearances)

Newsletters

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/digital-presence/newsletters.md

Newsletter & Email: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-web-presence

Newsletter

Field	Value
Platform	Substack
Subscribe URL	https://alanhirsch1.substack.com/
Frequency	Irregular / periodic (not on a fixed schedule)
Subscribers	1,500+ (publicly displayed on Substack)
Free/Paid	Free
Launch context	Announced on Facebook; described as "a great space to share ideas that I resonate with"

Recent Posts (as of March 2026)

Title	Date	Topic
"Reactivating the Church as Movement"	September 2025	Church must adopt dynamic, adaptive, mission-shaped expression beyond inherited frameworks
"If you could start all over again..."	2025	Reflections on church planting and The Forgotten Ways principles

Content Style

- Long-form reflections on missional theology and church movement
- Draws heavily from frameworks in his published books (mDNA, APEST, The Forgotten Ways)
- Accessible tone aimed at church leaders and missional practitioners
- Links back to alanhirsch.org and organizational resources

Guest Appearances on Other Substacks

Publication	Title	Date
StarfishyoU (starfishyou.substack.com)	"Alan Hirsch: Energizing Microchurch Movements with Hubs and Networks"	2025-2026
StarfishyoU	"Alan Hirsch: The Descent That Transforms"	2025-2026
Christine Sine (christinesine.substack.com)	"Reconstructing Faith with Alan Hirsch"	2025-2026

Website Email Capture

Field	Value
Newsletter signup on alanhirsch.org	Not prominently visible
Free resource / lead magnet	Yes — free eBooks available at alanhirsch.org/ebooks (likely requires email)
Email platform	Unknown (not publicly identified; could be integrated with Squarespace or a separate ESP)

Observations

1. **Substack is the primary newsletter channel** — 1,500+ subscribers is a modest but engaged base for a niche thought leader
2. **The Substack handle is alanhirsch1** (not alanhirsch), suggesting the primary handle was unavailable
3. **Free tier only** — no paid subscription tier detected, which means newsletter is used for audience building rather than direct monetization
4. **Irregular posting cadence** — not a weekly/biweekly commitment; posts appear when he has something to share
5. **Cross-platform amplification** — Substack posts are shared on Facebook and other social channels
6. **Guest contributions** on other Substacks extend his reach to adjacent audiences (microchurch movement, spiritual formation communities)
7. **Gap:** The personal website (alanhirsch.org) does not prominently feature newsletter signup, creating a missed opportunity to convert website visitors to email subscribers

Social Media

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/digital-presence/social-media.md

Social Media: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-web-presence

Account Summary

Platform	Handle	Followers	Posts	Frequency	Last Active	Status
Twitter/X	@alanhirsch	~37,900	N/A (not public via search)	Periodic	Active (2025-2026)	Active
Facebook (Personal/ Author)	facebook.com/alanhirsch	~14,000 followers	Regular	Periodic	Active (2025-2026)	Active
Facebook (Page 2)	facebook.com/alanhirsch2 ("Jesus Movement Junkie")	~6,800 followers	N/A	Unknown	Unknown	Secondary page
LinkedIn	linkedin.com/in/alan-hirsch-98055b4	N/A	N/A	Low	Active	Active
Instagram	@alandhirsch	Minimal	Minimal	Dormant/ Minimal	Unknown	Unverified — may not be actively managed
YouTube	No dedicated personal channel found	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	Content distributed via org channels and third-party interviews
TikTok	Not found	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	No presence detected

Platform Details

Twitter/X

- **URL:** <https://x.com/alanhirsch>
- **Bio:** Author, missional movement strategist, founder references
- **Links in bio:** Likely alanhirsch.org
- **Content style:** Shares missional theology ideas, quotes, links to articles and blog posts, retweets of movement-related content
- **Engagement:** Moderate — typical of niche thought-leader accounts in the Christian missional space
- **Notable:** Long-standing account with ~37.9K followers; primary social media platform for public engagement. Handle @alanhirsch is clean and recognizable.

Facebook (Author Page)

- **URL:** <https://www.facebook.com/alanhirsch/>
- **Bio:** Author, speaker, missional movement thought leader
- **Following:** 753
- **Content style:** Links to articles, personal reflections, Substack posts, book promotions
- **Engagement:** Moderate for the niche
- **Notable:** Used to announce Substack launch. 14K followers represents a meaningful community. Second page "Alan Hirsch-Jesus Movement Junkie" ([facebook.com/alanhirsch2](https://www.facebook.com/alanhirsch2)) has 6.8K followers — may be used for more informal/personal content.

LinkedIn

- **URL:** <https://www.linkedin.com/in/alan-hirsch-98055b4>
- **Headline:** Founder of Movement Leaders Collective, Forge Missional Training Network, and 5Q Collective
- **Location:** Thousand Oaks, CA
- **Content style:** Professional — organizational updates, thought leadership
- **Notable:** Confirms US residence in Thousand Oaks, CA. Profile focuses on organizational founding roles. Important for disambiguation from other "Alan Hirsch" profiles on LinkedIn (there are 70+ profiles with that name).

Instagram

- **URL:** <https://www.instagram.com/alanhirsch/> (probable match — needs verification)
- **Bio:** Minimal public information
- **Content style:** Unknown / minimal

- **Notable:** Not a primary platform. The handle @alandhirsch (with a "d") may or may not be the missional Alan Hirsch. Another account @allan.hirsch is a different person (Hirsch's Homestores). Instagram does not appear to be part of his active digital strategy.

YouTube

- **No dedicated personal channel found**
 - Video content appears primarily through:
 - Organizational channels (100Movements, 5Q Central, Forge)
 - Conference recordings (Exponential, Verge Network, Awakenings Gathering)
 - Third-party podcast video channels (Everyday Disciple, Church Leaders, Nomad Podcast)
 - Missional Video directory (missional.video)
 - **Notable:** Significant video content exists but is distributed across many third-party channels rather than centralized on a personal YouTube channel. This represents a content centralization gap.
-

Cross-Platform Observations

1. **Primary platforms:** Twitter/X (~37.9K) and Facebook (~14K + 6.8K) are the most established social accounts
2. **Professional presence:** LinkedIn confirms identity and location (Thousand Oaks, CA)
3. **Content distribution:** Social media is used primarily to amplify content published elsewhere (blog, Substack, organizational sites) rather than as primary content creation platforms
4. **Video gap:** No centralized YouTube presence despite significant video content across conference and podcast channels
5. **Instagram gap:** No meaningful Instagram presence — a notable gap given the platform's reach, though it may not align with his audience demographics (primarily 35-65 church leaders)
6. **Consistency:** The @alanhirsch handle is used across Twitter/X and Facebook, providing brand consistency

The Fragmentation Story

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/fragmentation-story.md

Alan Hirsch: The Fragmentation Story

Generated 2026-04-15 by the `fragmentation-story` skill from existing research in `docs/movement_leader_research/alan-hirsch/` and `docs/movement_leader_research/alan-hirsch-baseline-report.md`.

The Story

Alan Hirsch has published **20 books across 7 publishers over 21 years**. His [Goodreads author page](#) lists **92 editions** with **16,762 total ratings** — which, by the industry heuristic that 1–5% of readers rate, implies somewhere between 335,000 and 1.6 million copies read. Over **150,000 people have taken his APEST assessment**. He has founded or co-founded **seven organizations** (100 Movements, Forge, Forge America, 5Q Collective, Movement Leaders Collective, Future Travelers, Shapevine) and holds adjunct or associate faculty appointments at **four accredited seminaries** (Wheaton, Fuller, Asbury, George Fox). By any measure of reach, he is the gravitational center of the global missional movement.

And virtually none of that is retrievable as a system. His books live on Amazon, Goodreads, IVP, Baker/Brazos, Audible, Everand, OverDrive, Google Books, Christianbook, and seven more retailers — but the books themselves are static text; there is no AI retrieval layer, no chapter-level search, no index of the ideas inside them. The [alanhirsch.org](#) homepage is a Squarespace site with a blog, a books page, a free-ebooks page, a tests page, and an FAQ — no prominent newsletter signup, no video hub, no course library, no structured pathway connecting his 20 books to anything a reader could do next. The APEST assessment, which 150,000 people have completed, lives on [theforgottenways.org](#) and [apest.5qcentral.com](#) — and when someone finishes it, they get a score and no onward journey. **That single dead end is the most telling data point in the entire system.**

His audio presence is 35+ items scattered across 22+ unique podcast feeds — **5QCast is his only hosted podcast**; the other 28+ appearances are guest spots on Everyday Disciple, Shifting Culture, Fresh Expressions, Ephesiology, The Church Digital, Stetzer ChurchLeaders, DTS Table, Venture 12, Godspacelight, C4SO, Voxology, LAUNCH, Post-Christian Podcast, and more. His video presence is 38+ clips distributed across **20+ third-party channels** — Verge Network (10+ clips), Exponential (5+), ChurchLeaders (4+), Missio Alliance, Anthony Delaney, Fresh Expressions, Canopy International, Morling College, Asbury Seminary, and on. **He has no personal YouTube channel.** His social footprint is substantial on the two platforms he cares about (Twitter/X: ~37,900 followers, Facebook: ~20,800 combined across two pages), effectively absent on the two he doesn't (Instagram: one unverified handle, TikTok: nothing).

His email list is **1,500 subscribers on Substack at alanhirsch1.substack.com** — 4% of his Twitter follower count, against an industry baseline of 15-25% — and the newsletter posts irregularly. Audiobooks exist for **3 of his 20 books**; *The Forgotten Ways*, *5Q*, *The Shaping of Things to Come*, *ReJesus*, and *The Faith of Leap* — his most important titles — are print and e-book only.

So the portrait is this: a founding figure of modern missional ecclesiology whose 20 books are indexed everywhere and searchable nowhere, whose 150,000 assessment completions produced no onward pathway, whose 38+ videos have no home, whose audiobook catalogue is 15% complete, whose email list is a tenth of what it should be, and whose Spanish, Portuguese, German, and French translations exist as files in a repo rather than content on a platform. The fragmentation is not caused by absence of work — it is caused by the work being trapped in book-shaped, retailer-shaped, and organization-shaped containers that don't talk to each other.

Informational Fragmentation

Books

20 titles (16 unique works + revised editions). Publishers: **100 Movements Publishing (9), Baker Books / Brazos Press (7), Hendrickson Publishers (2), Zondervan (2), Jossey-Bass / Wiley (1), Exponential Resources (1), Missio Publishing (1)**. Year range: 2003–2024. Solo-authored: 5. Co-authored: 15.

Foundational / framework:

- **The Forgotten Ways: Reactivating Apostolic Movements** — Brazos Press, 1st ed. 2006 / 2nd ed. 2016, ISBN 9781587433863 — <https://www.amazon.com/Forgotten-Ways-Reactivating-Apostolic-Movements/dp/1587433869>. **No Audible audiobook.**
- **The Shaping of Things to Come** (with Michael Frost) — Hendrickson 2003 / Baker Books revised 2013, ISBN 9780801014918 — <https://www.amazon.com/Shaping-Things-Come-Innovation-21st-Century/dp/0801014913>
- **5Q: Reactivating the Original Intelligence and Capacity of the Body of Christ** — 100 Movements Publishing, April 2017, ISBN 9780998639307 — <https://www.amazon.com/5Q-Reactivating-Original-Intelligence-Capacity/dp/0998639303>. **No Audible audiobook.**
- **The Permanent Revolution** (with Tim Catchim) — Jossey-Bass 2012, ISBN 9780470907740 — Leadership Network Series #57
- **Metanoia** (with Rob Kelly) — 100 Movements Publishing, April 2023, ISBN 9781955142373
- **ReFramation** (with Mark Nelson) — 100 Movements Publishing, August 2019, ISBN 9780998639338. Audible: <https://www.audible.com/pd/Reframation-Audiobook/B08RL96N2Y>
- **All Change** (with Rich Robinson) — 100 Movements Publishing, September 2024, ISBN 9781955142533 — Audiobook available.

Practical application:

- **Untamed** (with Debra Hirsch) — Baker Books 2010, ISBN 9780801013430. Audible: <https://www.audible.com/pd/Untamed-Audiobook/B003IMUH2S>
- **Right Here, Right Now** (with Lance Ford) — Baker Books 2011, ISBN 9780801072239
- **Disciplism** — Exponential Resources 2014 (originally free Exponential ebook), ISBN 9781624240829

Collaborative:

- **ReJesus** (with Michael Frost) — Hendrickson 2008/2009 original ISBN 9781598562286; 100 Movements revised/updated February 2022, ISBN 9781955142137
- **The Faith of Leap** (with Michael Frost) — Baker Books 2011, ISBN 9780801014154; 100 Movements revised 2025, ISBN 9781955142632
- **On the Verge** (with Dave Ferguson) — Zondervan April 2011, ISBN 9780310331001. Audible: <https://www.audible.com/pd/On-the-Verge-Audiobook/B004WL4BOO>
- **The Starfish and the Spirit** (with Lance Ford, Rob Wegner; intro by Ori Brafman) — Zondervan Reflective 2021, ISBN 9780310098379 — Audiobook available.

Handbooks / playbooks:

- **The Forgotten Ways Handbook** (with Darryn Altclass) — Brazos Press April 2009, ISBN 9781587432491
- **The Permanent Revolution Handbook** (with Tim Catchim) — Jossey-Bass 2013
- **The Permanent Revolution Playbook** (with Tim Catchim) — Missio Publishing 2014, ISBN 9780989957823
- **Activating 5Q: A User's Guide** (with Jessie Cruickshank) — 100 Movements Publishing February 2018, ISBN 9780998639321
- **Fast Forward to Mission** — 100 Movements 2020

Retail surfaces (every book indexed across most of these): Amazon Author Page <https://amazon.com/stores/author/B001JPANCK>, Goodreads https://goodreads.com/author/show/56757.Alan_Hirsch (92 editions / 16,762 ratings), IVP <https://ivpress.com/alan-hirsch>, Baker Publishing <https://bakerpublishinggroup.com/authors/alan-hirsch/841>, Audible <https://audible.com/author/Alan-Hirsch/B001JPANCK>, Christianbook.com, Everand (Scribd) <https://everand.com/author/702347505/Alan-Hirsch>, OverDrive <https://overdrive.com/creators/503530/alan-hirsch>, Google Books.

Academic Work

- **No dedicated Google Scholar, Academia.edu, ResearchGate, or ORCID profile** discovered. Citations exist across academic literature but are not aggregated under a personal researcher profile.
- **Wheaton College — M.A. in Missional Church Movements** (co-founder and associate faculty): <https://wheaton.edu/graduate-school/degrees/ma-in-missional-church-movements/> — course materials not public.
- **Fuller Seminary** (adjunct professor) — course materials not public.

- **Asbury Seminary** (adjunct professor) — course materials not public.
- **George Fox Seminary** (adjunct professor) — course materials not public.
- **Australian University of Theology** (aut.edu.au) — publications referenced passively.
- **Morling College / Tinsley Institute** — 6-session video series Missiology To Go: Fivefold Leadership: <https://info.morling.edu.au/missiology-to-go-fivefold-leadership> — his most structured academic video teaching.
- **Peer-reviewed journal articles: UNKNOWN — needs research.** No doctoral dissertation surfaced; his authority is trade-book + organizational rather than academic-journal-driven.

PDFs & Documents

- **Disciplism** released as a free Exponential ebook (later republished on Kindle): <https://exponential.org/product/disciplism/>
- **Free eBooks page** on alanhirsch.org: <https://www.alanhirsch.org/ebooks> (likely email-gated; specific titles not individually catalogued in the research)
- **Lausanne / standalone white papers: UNKNOWN — needs research.** (The Rowland-Smith research notes Hirsch co-authored a Lausanne paper with Victor John on the Bhojpuri movement; that paper's location is not captured here.)

Articles

30+ articles identified across multiple platforms; output is moderate relative to his book output.

- **Saturate** (saturatetheworld.com/author/ahirsch/) — 11-part series, including:
 - The Sacred vs the Secular (Experiencing Seamlessness) (2020-09-28) — <https://saturatetheworld.com/2020/09/28/experiencing-seamlessness/>
 - Joining God in His Mission (2020-09-22) — <https://saturatetheworld.com/2020/09/22/joining-god-mission/>
 - Two Elements of a Missional Movement (2020-08-31) — <https://saturatetheworld.com/2020/08/31/two-elements-missional-movement/>
 - We Must Go Where The People Are (Attractional-Extractional) (2016-11-04) — <https://saturatetheworld.com/2016/11/04/attractional-extractional/>
- **Verge Network** (vergenetwork.org/tag/alan-hirsch/) — The Future Church, What Is A Missional Church?, What Is Incarnational Mission?, Organic Systems — mix of articles and video
- **Ephesiology / 5Q Central** — Team Essentials: Apostle, Team Essentials: Teacher, additional APEST content at <https://ephesiology.com/>
- **Missional Church Network** — aggregated blog category at <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Alan+Hirsch>

- **Christianity Today / Ed Stetzer column** — The Permanent Revolution: Interview with Alan Hirsch and Tim Catchim (2012-03) — <https://christianitytoday.com/edstetzer/2012/march/permanent-revolution-interview-with-alan-hirsch-and-tim.html>
- **ChurchLeaders.com** — Missional Discipleship with Alan Hirsch — https://churchleaders.com/outreach-missions/outreach-missions-blogs/154625-eric_bryant_missional_discipleship_with_alan_hirsch.html
- **Outreach Magazine** — Lance Ford, Rob Wegner & Alan Hirsch: The Starfish and the Spirit — <https://outreachmagazine.com/resources/voices/66883-lance-ford-rob-wegner-alan-hirsch-the-starfish-and-the-spirit.html>
- **Exponential** — Contributor profile + resources: <https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/>
- **Fresh Expressions** — recent content including 2024-12 Communitas and Loneliness with Alan Hirsch — <https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch>

Editorial roles:

- Series Editor — **Baker Books Shapevine Missional Series**
- Series Editor — **IVP's Forge line**
- Associate Editor — **Leadership Journal** (legacy role)

Blogs & Personal Writing

- **alanhirsch.org/blog** — categorized archive (APEST, mDNA, Missional, Leadership). **Irregular posting cadence.**
- **Substack: alanhirsch1** at <https://alanhirsch1.substack.com> — 1,500+ subscribers, irregular. Recent posts:
 - Reactivating the Church as Movement (September 2025)
 - If you could start all over again... (2025)
 - **Guest Substacks** (2025-2026):
 - StarfishyoU — Alan Hirsch: Energizing Microchurch Movements with Hubs and Networks
 - StarfishyoU — Alan Hirsch: The Descent That Transforms
 - Christine Sine — Reconstructing Faith with Alan Hirsch (also at <https://christinesine.substack.com/p/reconstructing-faith-with-alan-hirsch>)

Websites

Owned / personal

- **alanhirsch.org** — Squarespace — key pages: Home, About, Blog, Books, Free eBooks, Tests, FAQ

Founded organizations

- **100 Movements** — <https://100movements.com> (also <https://100movements.org> — publishing arm)
- **5Q Central / 5Q Collective** — <https://5qcentral.com>

- **Movement Leaders Collective** — <https://movementleaderscollective.com> (invitation-only)
- **Forge International** — <https://forgeinternational.com>
- **Forge America** — <https://forgeamerica.org> (also .com — the US arm)
- **Future Travelers** — referenced on alanhirsch.org
- **Shapevine** — <https://www.shapevine.com>
- **The Forgotten Ways (APEST Platform)** — <https://theforgottenways.org> (APEST + APEST 360)
- **Mx Training Ecosystem** — <https://themxplatform.com/alan-hirsch> (faculty role)
- **Ephesiology / MAMM** — <https://ephesiology.com>, masterclasses at <https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com>

Affiliated / institutional

- **Wikipedia** — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch
- **Saturate** — <https://saturatetheworld.com/author/ahirsch/>
- **Verge Network** — <https://vergenetwork.org/tag/alan-hirsch/>
- **Missional Church Network** — <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Alan+Hirsch>
- **Mission Central (Canada)** — <https://missioncentral.ca/profile/alan-hirsch>
- **Exponential** — <https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/>
- **Awakenings Gathering** — <https://awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/ahirsch>
- **Media Arts (Australia)** — <https://mediaarts.org.au/alan-hirsch/>
- **Missional Video** — <https://missional.video/index.php/influencer/alan-hirsch/>

Social Media

Platform	Handle / URL	Followers	Status
Twitter/X	@alanhirsch — https://x.com/alanhirsch	~37,900	Primary, active
Facebook (Author)	https://facebook.com/alanhirsch	~14,000	Active
Facebook (Page 2)	https://facebook.com/alanhirsch2 — "Jesus Movement Junkie"	~6,800	Secondary
LinkedIn	https://linkedin.com/in/alan-hirsch-98055b4	—	Active; Thousand Oaks, CA
Instagram	@alandhirsch (probable — needs verification)	Minimal	Dormant / unverified
YouTube	None — no dedicated personal channel	—	Absent
TikTok	None	—	Absent

Newsletters / Email

- **Substack at alanhirsch1** — 1,500+ subscribers, free tier only, irregular cadence.

- **alanhirsch.org email capture: Not prominently visible on main site.** Free eBooks page likely gates downloads behind email — platform unknown (Squarespace native or separate ESP).
- **Paid tier:** None detected.
- **Twitter-to-email conversion rate:** 4% (37,900 → 1,500) against industry baseline of 15-25%.

Podcasts (Hosted)

- **5QCast** — Apple Podcasts: <https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/5qcast/id1453597454> — ~30+ episodes, multiple seasons, started 2019, seasonal/irregular. Podcast from 5QCentral around APEST theology, practice, assessment, and organizational design.

Podcasts (Guest)

28+ confirmed episodes across 22+ unique podcasts (date range ~2016-2025).

Selected:

- **Everyday Disciple** — Why Your Church Isn't Growing and Maturing w/ Alan Hirsch (2025-09) — <https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/your-church-isnt-maturing/>
- **Everyday Disciple** — The Missing Piece in Church Maturity — <https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/missing-piece-in-church-maturity/>
- **Godspacelight / Liturgical Rebels Ep. 25** — Reconstructing Faith with Alan Hirsch (2025-03) — <https://godspacelight.com/episode-25-reconstructing-faith-with-alan-hirsch/>
- **Shifting Culture Ep. 269** — Michael Frost & Alan Hirsch — The Faith of Leap (2025-02) — <https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-269-michaelfrostalanhirsch>
- **Fresh Expressions** — Communitas and Loneliness (2024-12) — <https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch>
- **The Church Digital EP300** — APEST and Digital Church Movements (2024) — <https://creators.spotify.com/pod/show/thechurchdigital/episodes/EP300---Alan-Hirsch--APEST--and-Digital-Church-Movements-e2l95af>
- **Venture 12** — V12 5.7: The Faith of Leap (2024)
- **Ephesiology Ep. 150** — What is a Disciple (2023-11) — <https://ephesiology.com/2023/11/16/episode-150-what-is-a-disciple-with-alan-hirsch/>
- **Ephesiology Ep. 112** — ReJesus with Frost and Hirsch (2022-03)
- **Spiritual Life and Leadership Ep. 129** — Recalibrating the Church Around Jesus (2022-05)
- **Canadian Church Leaders Ep. 73** — Five-Fold Ministry (2022)
- **City to City / Redeemer** — Rethinking the Chessboard (2021)
- **LAUNCH Podcast REFRAME #01** — Reframation, Liminality and Chess (2020-07)
- **Post-Christian Podcast** — (2020)
- **Voxology (Reframation Series)** — Alan Hirsch and Mark Nelson
- **Shifting Culture Ep. 06** — Early Encounters and Authentic Community
- **Shifting Culture Ep. 136** — Alan Hirsch & Rob Kelly

- **Stetzer ChurchLeaders Podcast** — Revitalizing Church with the Ephesians 4 Blueprint — <https://churchleaders.com/podcast/312909-alan-hirsch-revitalizing-church-ephesians-4-blueprint.html>
- **Stetzer ChurchLeaders Podcast** — The Church Needs To Stop Making Jesus in Its Own Image — <https://churchleaders.com/podcast/431561-alan-hirsch-church-jesus-own-image.html>
- **C4SO Podcast** — Alan Hirsch on Missiology with Bishop Todd Hunter — <https://c4so.org/podcast/alan-hirsch-on-missiology/>
- **Rich Martin: Let's Build Church** — APEST — Has the Church Understood These Correctly?
- **Find Your Calling (Exponential)** — Alan Hirsch episode
- **Evangelical Alliance UK** — Missional Church Transition — <https://www.eauk.org/church/stories/alan-hirsch-podcast.cfm>
- **DTS Table Podcast** — Living Missionally in a Local Context with Dr. Darrell Bock — <https://voice.dts.edu/tablepodcast/living-missionally-alan-hirsch/>
- **Exponential Podcast** — Keys to Culture and to the Human Heart + Why a Return to APEST Is Essential
- **Ed Stetzer in Conversation with Alan Hirsch** (5Q Central) — <https://5qcentral.com/ed-stetzer-in-conversation-with-alan-hirsch/>
- **Microchurches (Reimagining Microchurch) S4 Ep. 51** — The Missional Conversation Thus Far (2023)

YouTube & Video

- **No personal YouTube channel.** 38+ videos distributed across 20+ third-party channels.
- **alanhirsch.org/videos** aggregates video links but does not host original content.
- **Verge Network** (the single largest source, ~2010–2013) — 10+ clips including What Is a Missional Church?, What Is Missional Discipleship?, How Modern Evangelism Creates Consumers (2013-04), The Future Church (2012-10), Communitas, Not Community, Apostolic Environment, Organic Systems, Why Evangelism Cannot Be Our Focus (2013-06), The DNA of Gospel Movements, Missional-Incarnational Impulse (2010-10), What Is a Missional Community? (2011-01)
- **ChurchLeaders** — Disciple Making vs. Consumerism (~2012), The Church Needs "Apostolic Activation" (2012-04-25 with Tim Catchim)
- **Exponential** (2014–2022) — 5Q Leadership Revolution (2022), Level 5 Multiplication Paradigm Shifts (2017), Keys to Culture and to the Human Heart (2016), Churches On The Verge Of Movement (2014)
- **Missio Alliance / Awakenings 2023** — Metanoia: Wholehearted Change in Unprecedented Times (plenary) + The Moment Before God (workshop with Deb Hirsch)
- **Canopy International** — Discipleship is About Taking Jesus Seriously (2025-11-18)
- **Anthony Delaney / LAUNCH** — Reframing Church (2020-05-08), Changing Your Mind About Repentance (2020-05-18)

- **Morling College / Tinsley Institute** — Missiology To Go: Fivefold Leadership (6-session video series)
- **Exponential Australia** — 5Q Masterclasses with Alan Hirsch, 5Q: Activating the Latent Capacity
- **5Q Central** — Ed Stetzer in Conversation with Alan Hirsch (~2018); additional owned-platform video behind registration/purchase

Sermons / Teaching Audio

- **Central Texas Annual Conference (CTCUMC) 2016-06** — Teaching Session I + II — https://www.ctcumc.org/AC16video-AlanHirsch_1_and_2
- **The Beautiful Kingdom Builders** — Missional Discipleship — <https://thebeautifulkingdombuilders.com/2018/10/12/alan-hirsch-missional-discipleship/>
- **Ohio Mennonite Conference** — Missional Conference (with Debra Hirsch) — <https://ohiomennoniteconference.org/missional-conference-alan-debra-hirsch/>
- **Verge Network** — DNA of Gospel Movements (7-part series)
- **Exponential Australia** — From Reaching to Discipling workshop — <https://exponential.org.au/reaching-to-discipling/>
- **Awakenings Gathering archive** — <https://www.awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/ahirsch>
- **Asbury Seminary Chapel** — Communitas (~2015) — <https://place.asburyseminary.edu/ecommonsatschapelservices/5201/>
- **CMA Resources** — Communitas Not Community (~2012) — https://www.cmaresources.org/video/communitas_alan-hirsch

Talks / Conferences

Conference circuit is active; most academic lectures at Fuller / Wheaton / George Fox / Asbury are **not publicly available as audio recordings**. Exponential is his most consistent conference relationship.

- **Exponential Orlando 2022** — plenary — <https://m.exponential.org/2022orl/speakers/speakers-45.html>
- **Exponential Orlando 2019** — session with Drew Hyun, Dave Clayton
- **Exponential East 2017** — training: Level 5 Multiplication Paradigm Shifts
- **Exponential East 2016** — Keys to Culture and to the Human Heart
- **Exponential 2014** — Churches On The Verge Of Movement
- **Exponential Australia** (multiple years) — 5Q Masterclasses
- **Awakenings Gathering 2023** — Metanoia plenary + The Moment Before God workshop (with Deb Hirsch)
- **Verge Conferences** (2010-2013) — the single largest corpus of his recorded teaching

- **Wheaton / Fuller / George Fox / Asbury DMin-type teaching weeks** — ongoing, mostly unrecorded publicly
- Conference recordings are typically behind Exponential's paid Digital Access Pass at <https://resources.exponentialng.org/>

Courses

- **5Q Central** — modules, webinars, discussion forums, short-term courses, longer training cohorts around APEST (<https://5qcentral.com>)
- **Ephesiology Masterclasses** — Releasing Your Leadership Potential: APEST Intelligence course — <https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com>
- **Mx Training Ecosystem** — <https://themxplatform.com/alan-hirsch> — faculty role
- **Forge America** — cohort-based curriculum (gated; also Rowland Smith runs this arm)
- **Forge International** — international cohorts
- **Wheaton College M.A. in Missional Church Movements** — co-founder & associate faculty (formal graduate program)
- **Asbury Seminary** (adjunct), **Fuller Seminary** (adjunct), **George Fox Seminary** (adjunct)
- **Morling College / Tinsley Institute** — Missiology To Go: Fivefold Leadership (6-session video)
- **No presence on Teachable / Thinkific / Udemy / Skillshare.**

Assessments & Tools

- **APEST Personal Vocational Assessment** — theforgottenways.org — 50 question pairs, 10 minutes, immediate results. **150,000+ completions.**
- **APEST Assessment (alt)** — apest.5qcentral.com
- **APEST 360** — 360-degree version on theforgottenways.org
- **mPULSE** — referenced on alanhirsch.org/tests with FAQ at alanhirsch.org/faq — details limited publicly
- **mDNA Assessment** — "platform implementation in progress" per the content audit

Apps / Software

- **No dedicated mobile / SaaS product.** The APEST assessment is a web tool, not an app.
- **Patreon, Buy Me a Coffee, Ko-fi:** none.

Notes, Laptop, Unpublished

- **UNKNOWN — likely very substantial, not yet catalogued.** Given 21 years of book writing, seminary-level teaching across four institutions, cohort design for three training networks (Forge, Forge America, Forge International), a 6-session video course (Morling),

and an active speaking circuit, the private-notes layer — Scrivener files, lecture slides, cohort facilitation guides, unpublished drafts, translation working files — is almost certainly larger than the public-facing corpus.

- **Translation working files:** Spanish translations exist for 10 books, Portuguese for 4+, German and French for 1 each — per the baseline report these exist as files in a repo rather than on any platform.

Embodied / In Their Head

- **The entire mDNA framework** was developed embodied through years of coaching before being systematized into The Forgotten Ways.
- **The APEST / 5Q synthesis** of Ephesians 4 — widely taught but the full application set travels with him as an embodied teacher.
- **Relational formation** of movement leaders — decades of coaching through Forge, MLC, 100M that is not documented publicly.
- **Judgment about whether a given church can make the missional transition** — Future Travelers runs 2–3 year transformation processes that rest on this embodied discernment.
- **The Australian / Global-South / U.S. bridge** — he is one of the only figures who can translate between the Australian charismatic-missional tradition and the U.S. evangelical one; that translational capacity is relational, not written down.

Relational Fragmentation

Organizations

Founded / co-founded:

- **100 Movements** — co-founder with Rich Robinson — <https://100movements.com>
- **Forge Mission Training Network** — founding director (originated Australia 1996)
- **Forge International** — founding director — <https://forgeinternational.com>
- **Forge America** — founding director (US arm est. 2007; Rowland Smith is current National Director)
- **5Q Collective / 5Q Central** — founder, resident coach and consultant — <https://5qcentral.com>
- **Movement Leaders Collective (MLC)** — co-founder with Rich Robinson — <https://movementleaderscollective.com> (invitation-only)
- **Future Travelers** — co-founder and co-leader (large-church transformation; 2–3 year programs)
- **Shapevine** — co-founder — <https://www.shapevine.com> (originally a ministry of Leadership Journal / Christianity Today)

Partner:

- **3DM (Three Dimensional Ministries)** — increasingly involved partner — <https://3dmovements.com>

Co-authors & Collaborators

By frequency (confirmed co-authorships):

- **Michael Frost** — 5 books (The Shaping of Things to Come, ReJesus, The Faith of Leap original + revised, Untamed by association via the Shapevine series)
- **Tim Catchim** — 3 (The Permanent Revolution, The Permanent Revolution Handbook, The Permanent Revolution Playbook)
- **Lance Ford** — 2 (Right Here, Right Now, The Starfish and the Spirit)
- **Rich Robinson** — 1 book (All Change) + co-founder of 100M and MLC
- **Debra Hirsch** — 1 (Untamed); also co-teaching partner
- **Rob Kelly** — 1 (Metanoia)
- **Mark Nelson** — 1 (ReFramation)
- **Dave Ferguson** — 1 (On the Verge)
- **Jessie Cruickshank** — 1 (Activating 5Q)
- **Rob Wegner** — 1 (The Starfish and the Spirit)
- **Darryn Altclass** — 1 (The Forgotten Ways Handbook)
- **Ori Brafman** — introduction to The Starfish and the Spirit
- **Mark Sayers** — foreword to revised Faith of Leap
- **Christine Caine** — foreword to revised ReJesus
- **Ed Stetzer** — foreword to 2nd edition of The Forgotten Ways; recurring interview partner
- **Jeff Vanderstelt** — afterword to 2nd edition of The Forgotten Ways
- **Darrell L. Guder** — foreword to The Permanent Revolution
- **Mike Breen** — contributions to The Permanent Revolution
- **Danielle Strickland** — foreword to ReFramation
- **Victor John** — co-author on Lausanne "Reactivating the Church" paper (Bhojpuri movement)
- **Brandon Stiver** (Canopy International), **Caesar Kalinowski** (Everyday Disciple, 2+ podcast episodes), **Anthony Delaney** (LAUNCH, 3+), **Bishop Todd Hunter** (C4SO), **Dr. Darrell Bock** (DTS) — recurring interview partners

Networks & Movements

- **Forge movement** (global): Australia, Canada, USA
- **100 Movements network** — global movement leaders
- **MLC** — invitation-only movement-leader coaching network
- **Missio Alliance** — recurring plenary / workshop role (Awakenings 2023)
- **Exponential** — most consistent conference relationship (2014, 2016, 2017, 2019, 2020, 2022 at minimum)
- **Verge Network** — dominant source of his recorded teaching

- **Fresh Expressions** — recent guest relationship
- **Saturate network** — 11-part contributor series

Academic Affiliations

- **Wheaton College** — co-founder and associate faculty, M.A. in Missional Church Movements
- **Fuller Theological Seminary** — adjunct professor
- **Asbury Seminary** — adjunct professor
- **George Fox Seminary** — adjunct professor
- **Morling College / Tinsley Institute** (Australia) — 6-session video series
- **Australian University of Theology** — publications referenced

Mentors, Protégés, Key Relationships

- **Mentors: UNKNOWN — needs research.** The research does not document his own mentors by name.
- **Protégés / next-generation practitioners** named across the corpus: Rowland Smith (Forge America National Director), Rich Robinson, Rob Kelly, Jessie Cruickshank, Mark Nelson, Anna Robinson, Tim Catchim, Lance Ford, Rob Wegner.
- **Spouse: Debra Hirsch** — co-author of Untamed, co-teacher on Awakenings 2023 The Moment Before God workshop, Forge America Missional Podcast Episode 1 guest.
- **Disambiguation note:** Not to be confused with the American law professor Alan Hirsch (false confessions), the South African economist Alan Hirsch (SOEs), or Alan R. Hirsch M.D. (neurologist).

Where Relationships Are Actually Stored

- **Mental rolodex + Debra Hirsch** — almost certainly the primary store. 30+ years of founding seven organizations, adjunct faculty at four seminaries, recurring speaking at Exponential / Awakenings / Verge, and co-authorship with 11+ named collaborators means the relational graph lives primarily in his memory and his marriage.
- **100 Movements / MLC back-ends** — contain the invitation-only network data; not publicly visible.
- **Forge America cohort rosters** — live with Rowland Smith's team on the Wix back-end.
- **Publisher author files** — fragmented across 100M Publishing, Baker, Hendrickson, Zondervan, Jossey-Bass, Exponential Resources, Missio Publishing.
- **Seminary rosters** — Wheaton, Fuller, Asbury, George Fox — FERPA-bound.
- **Substack list (1,500)** — the only owned, exportable email list.
- **Twitter followers (37,900)** — owned by the platform, not him.
- **No unified CRM** surfaced in the research.

Synthesis

Alan Hirsch converts intellectual authority into embodied outcomes — speaking, consulting, organization-founding — at near-singular scale. But the system leaks **~90% of its potential reach** before it gets to anyone who could be formed by it. A concrete picture: 150,000 APEST completions leading to 1,500 Substack subscribers (a 1% onward-journey conversion); 37,900 Twitter followers leading to 1,500 Substack subscribers (4% vs. 15–25% industry baseline); 38+ videos distributed across 20+ channels with zero personal YouTube home; 20 books of which only 3 have Audible audiobooks; translations in four languages existing as files, not content. The single largest pool of trapped value is the **APEST dead-end** — 150,000 people who demonstrated behavioral interest and received no structured pathway; a 10% conversion would be 15,000 new engaged users, a 30% conversion would be 45,000. The second-largest pool is his **cohort-and-seminary teaching content** — years of material at Wheaton, Fuller, Asbury, George Fox, and inside MLC / 100M / Forge / Future Travelers that is visible only to the people in the room.

Research Provenance

- **Source folder:** docs/movement_leader_research/alan-hirsch/ + docs/movement_leader_research/alan-hirsch-baseline-report.md
- **Files read:**
 - alan-hirsch-baseline-report.md
 - ALAN_HIRSCH_CONTENT_AUDIT.md
 - ALAN_HIRSCH_ORGS.md
 - digital-presence/social-media.md
 - digital-presence/websites.md
 - digital-presence/newsletters.md
 - digital-presence/platforms.md
 - content/books.md
 - content/audio.md
 - content/videos.md
 - content/articles.md
- **Confidence:** **High** for book catalogue (20 titles verified with ISBNs, publishers, years), podcast guest footprint (28+ episodes across 22+ feeds verified), video distribution (38+ clips across 20+ channels), organizational founding roles, academic appointments, APEST assessment volume (150,000+), Substack subscriber count (1,500), Twitter count (~37,900), and audiobook gap (3 of 20). **Medium** for Facebook counts (~14K + ~6.8K), Goodreads ratings total (16,762), and article cadence. **Low** for Instagram handle verification, any private mailing list beyond Substack, academic journal publications, Lausanne paper location, and translation file locations.

- **Gaps requiring further research:**

- Instagram handle verification (@alandhirsch vs alternatives)
- Academic journal article inventory (none surfaced)
- Lausanne "Reactivating the Church" paper with Victor John — exact URL
- Locations of Spanish / Portuguese / German / French translation files
- Comprehensive alanhirsch.org/ebooks title list
- 5QCast full episode catalogue
- Morling College 6-session video access / URLs
- Private course content and cohort curriculum specifics at 100M, MLC, Forge, Future Travelers
- Actual Facebook post cadence and recent LinkedIn activity
- Whether mPULSE has measurable completion volume comparable to APEST

A Letter — Reflected Understanding

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/reflected-understanding/alan-hirsch.md

Alan Hirsch: Reflected Understanding

A concise reflection spoken back so the language could be endorsed — familiar, but with edges that deepen. (Leader-safe: audience-sizing and commerce analysis are kept in staff notes, not here.)

Calling

You're called to **reactivate what's latent**. Not to invent a new church or a new ministry type, but to name and unlock what's already in the Body: the intelligence, the capacities, the apostolic and prophetic and evangelistic and shepherd and teacher functions that were always there and got buried under institution. Your job is to help the church remember itself — to recover its "forgotten ways" and its 5Q — so it can move again as movement, not only as organization. You're not selling a brand; you're midwifing a recovery. The language you already use — reactivating, original intelligence, latent potencies — is the right language. It's prophetic in the sense that it names what God has already given and calls people to step into it; it stays tethered to Scripture, to practice, and to the actual cost of leaving the center to lead from the edge.

Existing Content (before the platform we're building)

Where it lives. Your content lives in **books** (9+ with IVP and co-authors), **organizational sites** (100Movements, Forge, Future Travelers, 5Q Collective), **academic contexts** (Fuller, Wheaton, George Fox, Asbury — including the M.A. you co-founded), **conference and speaking** across Australia, Europe, and the United States, and **training/consulting** (Future Travelers, 5Q, Forge). Your personal site and IVP author page anchor "Alan Hirsch" and the books; the rest is distributed across those other domains.

Credibility. It's high. You're a benchmark voice in movement theology: seminal books, multiple organizations that multiply practitioners, academic appointments, and a clear cost paid for staying at the edge. The work is credible; the issue isn't authority — it's **visibility, connection, and reuse**.

How it lives online now. As **silos**: books on retailer/publisher pages, org content on org sites, academic material behind institutional access, speaking on assorted event and church sites. There is no single place where "everything Alan has said and written about APEST" or "missional movement" is structured, linked, and easy to find. So it doesn't **move** in the sense of circulating, compounding, and connecting — it stays where it was first put.

The NOTs Movemental addresses directly. Your content is largely **not** translated into key languages; **not** structured and repurposed to live as findable digital content (talks → articles, book themes → courses); **not** connected to a personalized AI that reflects your voice and corpus; **not** optimized for discoverability so searchers for "apostolic movement," "APEST," "missional church," or "fivefold ministry" land on your material first; **not** interconnected so books, org resources, talks, and academic work visibly reference each other; and **not** owned and unified under one surface you control. Movemental is built to speak to each of these — translation, structure and repurpose, an AI that serves your voice, discoverability, interconnection, ownership, and legibility — so your content can move.

Constraints

Movement leaders with mDNA priorities live under **time** and **money** constraints that are emblematic, not personal failure. You're running multiple organizations, teaching, writing, speaking internationally, and co-founding academic programs. Time for content strategy, for repurposing talks into articles, or for building a unified digital home is scarce because the work is in the room — with leaders, churches, and movements. The desire to reach everyone God has given you is there; the hours to make that happen at scale, in every language and format, typically are not. Those constraints shape every content decision: what gets recorded, what gets translated, what becomes a course or an article. A platform that reduces the lift — that helps structure, repurpose, connect, and amplify what you already do — addresses those constraints without asking you to become a different kind of leader.

This document is a reflected understanding for Alan Hirsch, intended to be right to the point, true, and valuable. It is preliminary until reviewed and endorsed.

Welcome Letter

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/welcome-letter.md`

Alan

You have built one of the most generative bodies of work in missional ecclesiology over the past two decades. Twenty books across seven publishers in twenty-one years, from *The Shaping of Things to Come* with Michael Frost through *The Forgotten Ways*, *5Q*, *The Permanent Revolution*, *ReJesus*, *The Faith of Leap*, *ReFramation*, *Metanoia*, *The Starfish and the Spirit*, and most recently *All Change* with Rich Robinson. Seven organizations founded or co-founded — Forge, Forge America, Forge International, 100 Movements, 5Q Collective, Movement Leaders Collective, and Future Travelers. Adjunct appointments at Fuller, Asbury, and George Fox. And the role that has become load-bearing for the next decade of practitioner formation: co-founder and associate faculty of the M.A. in Missional Church Movements at Wheaton College.

All of it is somewhere. None of it is in one place. *The Forgotten Ways* and *5Q* sit on Amazon, Goodreads, the IVP and Baker catalogs, Christianbook, Audible, Everand, OverDrive, and Google Books, indexed everywhere and searchable nowhere as a corpus. Your articles scatter across Saturate's eleven-part series, the Verge Network archive, the Ed Stetzer column at Christianity Today, ChurchLeaders, Outreach, Missional Church Network, Exponential, and Fresh Expressions, with no surface that lets a reader walk from one to the next. The audio footprint is real and uncollected: thirty-plus appearances across twenty-plus podcasts — Shifting Culture Episode 269 with Michael Frost on *The Faith of Leap*, Ephesiology Episode 150 on what a disciple is, The Church Digital EP300 on APEST and digital church movements, Fresh Expressions on *communitas* and loneliness, DTS Table with Darrell Bock, Venture 12, Liturgical Rebels, Voxology's *ReFramation* series — alongside your single hosted show, 5QCast. There is no personal YouTube; thirty-eight videos live on twenty-plus third-party channels. There is a Substack of fifteen hundred subscribers against thirty-seven thousand on Twitter. Only three of twenty books have audiobooks. The relational layer is held the same way. Forge America cohort rosters live with Rowland Smith's team on the Wix back-end. The Movement Leaders Collective and 100 Movements back-ends hold the invitation-only network. Wheaton, Fuller, Asbury, and George Fox rosters live behind FERPA. Publisher author files are split across seven houses. The thirty-year mental rolodex of Forge, Australian charismatic-missional networks, and Stateside evangelical leaders lives in your memory and with Debra. Michael Frost, Tim Catchim, Lance Ford, and Rich Robinson sit one co-author hop from most of the rest of the missional scenius. What is missing is the layer above all of this that lets a reader find their way from any one piece to every other, and that lets the hundred fifty thousand people who completed APEST stay connected to you after the score appears.

The largest pool of value, and the one most at risk of going unwritten, sits in your head. The mDNA framework was lived in coaching before it became *The Forgotten Ways*. The APEST and 5Q synthesis of Ephesians 4 travels with you as an embodied teacher; the public assessment

delivers a number and stops. The judgment about whether a given congregation can actually make the missional transition is what makes Future Travelers' two-to-three-year transformation processes work, and that discernment is in no document. The translation work between the Australian charismatic-missional tradition and the U.S. evangelical one is relational, not written down. The decisions behind the Wheaton M.A. cohort curriculum, the 5Q Masterclasses, the cohort blocks at MLC, exist in classrooms, on coaching calls, in hotel lobbies at Exponential, and in the same conversation having happened a thousand times.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The inventory just walked through — twenty books, the podcasts, the videos, the seminars, the institutional homes of your work and your relationships — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the time it would have taken a human researcher weeks. The same approach now turns toward what is not yet public: AI-assisted interview capture of the Future Travelers transformation rationale, course-note extraction from the Wheaton M.A. cohort and from 5Q Masterclasses, conversation capture from coaching calls inside MLC and 100M, dictation that becomes draft and draft that becomes essay. The embodied layer can be surfaced at your pace rather than at a publisher's. The AI does not replace the voice. Every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite. The tools do the inventorying and the connective tissue. Authorship stays yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we will do with you. First, aggregate. All twenty books, the 5QCast archive, your articles across Saturate and Verge and Fresh Expressions, your Exponential and Awakenings session material, and the embodied layer as it gets surfaced, pulled into one hub. Second, interconnect. The Forgotten Ways points at the mDNA framework points at the APEST assessment points at the Activating 5Q user's guide points back at the Wheaton M.A. cohort where the synthesis gets taught. Third, repurpose. The APEST dead-end becomes a real onward pathway with a sequence behind it; 5Q and Metanoia anchor public cohort sequences; the Verge Network video archive becomes a browseable library under your name; the Spanish, Portuguese, German, and French translation files come out of the repo and onto the platform. Fourth, amplify. Search, network effects, the references that arrive once The Forgotten Ways is findable from one address. The work this season is not authorship. It is translation of what you have already authored into a form practitioners can actually reach.

A year from now, alanhirsch.org looks different. An APEST hub gathers the assessment, the Activating 5Q user's guide, 5Q, the Ephesiology Masterclass, and a cohort sign-up that did not exist before. A missional-discipleship hub holds The Forgotten Ways, Untamed with Debra, the Verge video archive, and the Shifting Culture and Fresh Expressions appearances under one canonical address. The translations live on the site rather than in a repo. The newsletter posts on a cadence. A church planter in Birmingham, Alabama, who has never heard of the Movement Leaders Collective, finds the APEST assessment on a Tuesday morning, takes it over lunch, and starts the 5Q cohort sequence that afternoon.

This is your next season. The work ahead is making the body of work you have already built reach the practitioners it was written for. Your Wheaton role does not contradict this work; it is the reason it must happen now. The graduate students moving through the M.A. in Missional Church Movements, and the practitioners they will form, need to find the rest of the corpus from a single address rather than through twenty retailers and forty institutional doors. Right now they cannot.

— Movemental

Committed Voice

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/_misc/committed-voice.md

slug: alan-hirsch

display_name: Alan Hirsch

role: Founder, 100Movements · Co-founder, Forge Mission Training Network · 5Q Collective

location_line: Thousand Oaks, California

short_tagline: >-

Australian-born missiologist who coined the term "movemental," built the mDNA and APEST frameworks, and seeded the contemporary missional church.

themes:

- Apostolic Movements
- APEST / 5Q
- Missional DNA

credentials:

- Founder, 100Movements — publisher and consulting platform for missional movement work
- Co-founder, Forge Mission Training Network — incarnational mission training across AU, CA, US
- Co-founder, 5Q Collective — APEST activation platform with 150,000+ assessments taken
- Co-founder and Associate Faculty, M.A. in Missional Church Movements, Wheaton College
- Adjunct faculty, Fuller Theological Seminary · George Fox Seminary · Asbury Seminary
- Coined the term "movemental" — the namesake of this platform

featured_works:

- The Forgotten Ways (Brazos Press, 2006)
- 5Q (100 Movements Publishing, 2017)
- The Permanent Revolution (with Tim Catchim, Jossey-Bass, 2012)
- The Shaping of Things to Come (with Michael Frost, Hendrickson, 2003)
- Metanoia (with Rob Kelly, 100 Movements Publishing, 2023)

primary_url: <https://alanhirsch.org>

secondary_links:

- label: 100Movements

href: <https://100movements.com>

- label: 5Q Collective

href: <https://5qcollective.com>

- label: Forge Mission Training Network

href: <https://forgeamerica.com>

signature_frameworks:

- name: mDNA (Missional DNA)

definition: Six interdependent elements — Jesus is Lord, disciple making, missional-incarnational impulse, apostolic environment, organic systems, and liminality-communitas —

that characterize every significant Jesus movement in history.

- name: APEST / 5Q

definition: The fivefold ministry of apostle, prophet, evangelist, shepherd, and teacher from Ephesians 4:11, read as the original intelligence and capacity given to the church and operationalized as a diagnostic and team-design tool.

- name: Apostolic Genius

definition: The latent movemental potential embedded in every Christian community when mDNA is activated; the organizing concept of The Forgotten Ways.

- name: Movemental vs. Institutional thinking

definition: A paradigm shift from church as static institution to church as dynamic, multiplying movement — organic over programmatic, apostolic energy over maintenance.

- name: Metanoia

definition: Repentance read as radical paradigm shift and reorientation, applied to personal, ecclesial, and organizational transformation.

- name: Reframation

definition: The deliberate re-enchantment of mental frameworks through which God, people, and mission are perceived; the project of Hirsch and Mark Nelson's ReFramation.

- name: Christology > Missiology > Ecclesiology

definition: Hirsch's ordering principle — the church's form follows its mission, and its mission follows from who Jesus is — that runs through ReJesus, The Forgotten Ways, and 5Q as a single line.

sources:

- README.md

- summary.md

- biography.md

- identity-verification.md

- digital-presence-discovery.md

- content-analysis.md

- content/books.md

- ALAN_HIRSCH_AUTHOR_PROFILE.md

research_completed_at: 2026-03-18

generated_at: 2026-05-20

Editorial bio

Alan Hirsch is the missiologist who coined the term "movemental" — the namesake of this platform — and built the intellectual architecture much of the contemporary missional church now runs on. Born in Johannesburg in 1959, raised in apartheid-era South Africa, he emigrated to Australia in 1983 and pastored the South Melbourne Restoration Community for fifteen years among addicts, sex workers, and the chronically housed before turning that ministry's lessons into theory.

His magnum opus, *The Forgotten Ways* (Brazos, 2006), introduced the mDNA framework and the concept of Apostolic Genius; *5Q* (2017) and *The Permanent Revolution* (Jossey-Bass, 2012, with Tim Catchim) have made APEST one of the most widely adopted readings of Ephesians 4 in the Western church, with more than 150,000 assessments taken through his platforms. Across twenty books published with seven publishers — including *The Shaping of Things to Come* with Michael Frost, *ReJesus*, *Untamed* with Debra Hirsch, and *Metanoia* with Rob Kelly — he has built a coherent line from Christology through missiology to ecclesiology.

He founded 100Movements, co-founded the Forge Mission Training Network and 5Q Collective, and co-founded the M.A. in Missional Church Movements at Wheaton College. He teaches as adjunct faculty at Fuller, George Fox, and Asbury, and works as embedded consultant for Redeemer City to City and movement mentor for NewThing International.

Sources

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/sources.md

Sources: Alan Hirsch Research

Research Date: 2026-03-18 (profile discovery phase)

Previous Research: January 4, 2026 (initial discovery)

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Search Queries Used

Phase 1: Identity Verification

1. "Alan Hirsch" Christian author theologian
2. "Alan Hirsch" missional church movement
3. "Alan Hirsch" books "The Forgotten Ways" "The Shaping of Things to Come"
4. "Alan Hirsch" website blog 100movements
5. "Alan Hirsch" Forge Australia apostolic
6. "Alan Hirsch" "The Permanent Revolution" "Untamed" "Right Here Right Now" books complete list
7. "Alan Hirsch" 100Movements Forge Mission Training Network Future Travelers organizations
8. "Alan Hirsch" Fuller Seminary Wheaton College adjunct professor courses
9. "Alan Hirsch" "5Q Collective" fivefold ministry APEST
10. "Alan Hirsch" YouTube videos talks presentations
11. "Alan Hirsch" podcast appearances interviews
12. "Alan Hirsch" Amazon author page books list
13. site:alanhirsch.org blog articles content
14. "Alan Hirsch" social media Twitter LinkedIn Instagram

Sources Consulted

Websites

- **alanhirsch.org** (personal website - referenced in multiple search results as official website)
- **ivpress.com/alan-hirsch** (InterVarsity Press author page - referenced in search results)
- **en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch** (Wikipedia page - referenced in search results)
- **libquotes.com/alan-hirsch** (Quote collection - referenced in search results)
- **quotlr.com/author/alan-hirsch** (Quote collection - referenced in search results)

- **sksbooks.com** (Book retailer - referenced in search results)
- **citytocity.nyc** (Conference/event page - referenced in search results)

Search Engines Used

- Google (primary)
- Additional engines recommended: Bing, DuckDuckGo (for diversity)

Information Sources

Identity Verification

- Personal website (alanhirsch.org)
- Wikipedia page (en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch)
- Search engine results referencing:
- 100Movements affiliation
- Forge Mission Training Network leadership
- Future Travelers organization
- 5Q Collective leadership
- Published books
- Academic affiliations (Fuller Seminary, Wheaton College, George Fox Seminary, Asbury Seminary)
- Birth information (1959, Johannesburg, South Africa)
- Geographic journey (South Africa → Australia)

Published Works

- "The Forgotten Ways"
- "The Shaping of Things to Come" (with Michael Frost)
- "ReJesus" (with Michael Frost)
- "The Faith of Leap" (with Michael Frost)
- "Untamed" (with Michael Frost)
- "Right Here, Right Now" (with Lance Ford)
- "On the Verge" (with Dave Ferguson)
- "The Permanent Revolution" (with Tim Catchim)
- "5Q: Reactivating the Original Intelligence and Capacity of the Body of Christ"

Organizational Affiliations

- 100Movements (founder)
- Forge Mission Training Network (founder)

- Future Travelers (founder)
- 5Q Collective (founder/resident coach)

Academic Affiliations

- Wheaton College (co-founder and associate faculty, M.A. in Missional Church Movements)
- Fuller Theological Seminary (adjunct professor)
- George Fox Seminary (adjunct professor)
- Asbury Seminary (adjunct professor)

Publisher Information

- InterVarsity Press (IVP) - primary publisher
- Author page: ivpress.com/alan-hirsch

Research Limitations

1. **Web Search Tool Limitations:** The web search tool used returned process descriptions and general information rather than direct access to all platforms and content. Comprehensive platform exploration would require direct website visits.
2. **Initial Research Phase:** This represents initial discovery. Further investigation needed for:
 - Complete platform mapping
 - Content volume assessment
 - Detailed content analysis
 - Comprehensive source verification
 - Social media presence verification
 - Video/podcast content discovery
 - Blog content analysis
3. **Source Verification Needed:** Many sources referenced in search results need direct verification through:
 - Website visits
 - Platform exploration
 - Cross-referencing multiple sources
 - Direct content analysis
4. **Content Volume Assessment:** Initial research identified content forms and themes, but detailed volume assessment requires:
 - Blog post counting
 - Video content cataloging
 - Podcast episode identification
 - Article publication verification
 - Course material assessment

URLs Discovered — Web Presence Phase (2026-03-18)

Personal & Organizational Sites

- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/> — primary personal website (Squarespace)
- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/about> — about/bio page
- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/blog> — blog archives
- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/books> — book catalog
- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/ebooks> — free eBooks and resources
- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/tests> — APEST and mPULSE assessment links
- <https://www.alanhirsch.org/faq> — assessment FAQ
- <https://www.100movements.org/> — 100Movements (co-founder)
- <https://www.100movements.org/books> — 100M book catalog
- <https://5qcentral.com/> — 5Q Central (founder)
- <https://apest.5qcentral.com/> — APEST assessment portal
- <https://www.theforgottenways.org/> — APEST assessment sign-in
- <https://www.forgeinternational.com/> — Forge International
- <https://www.forgeamerica.org/> — Forge America
- <https://movementleaderscollective.com/> — Movement Leaders Collective
- <https://www.themxplatform.com/alan-hirsch> — Mx Training Ecosystem profile
- <https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com/courses/apest-intelligence> — APEST course

Social Media

- <https://x.com/alanhirsch> — Twitter/X (~37.9K followers)
- <https://www.facebook.com/alanhirsch/> — Facebook (~14K followers)
- <https://www.facebook.com/alanhirsch2/> — Facebook "Jesus Movement Junkie" (~6.8K)
- <https://www.linkedin.com/in/alan-hirsch-98055b4> — LinkedIn
- <https://www.instagram.com/alandhirsch/> — Instagram (unverified)

Newsletter

- <https://alanhirsch1.substack.com/> — Substack (1.5K+ subscribers)

Publisher & Retail

- <https://www.amazon.com/stores/author/B001JPANCK> — Amazon
- https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/56757.Alan_Hirsch — Goodreads
- <https://www.ivpress.com/alan-hirsch> — InterVarsity Press
- <https://bakerpublishinggroup.com/authors/alan-hirsch/841> — Baker Publishing

- <https://www.audible.com/author/Alan-Hirsch/B001JPANCK> — Audible

Third-Party Profiles

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch — Wikipedia
 - <https://saturatetheworld.com/author/ahirsch/> — Saturate
 - <https://vergenetwork.org/tag/alan-hirsch/> — Verge Network
 - <https://exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/> — Exponential
 - <https://missional.video/index.php/influencer/alan-hirsch/> — Missional Video
-

Next Steps for Source Verification

1. Direct website visits to verify content:
 - alanhirsch.org (structure, blog, content)
 - 100Movements website
 - Forge Mission Training Network website
 - Future Travelers website
 - 5Q Collective website
2. Platform-specific searches:
 - YouTube channel(s)
 - Podcast directories (Apple Podcasts, Spotify)
 - Social media platforms (Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram)
3. Book retailer verification:
 - Amazon author page
 - Goodreads author page
 - Publisher websites
4. Academic platform exploration:
 - Seminary websites
 - Course material availability
 - Academic publication databases
5. Cross-referencing:
 - Multiple source verification
 - Content cross-referencing
 - Platform interconnection verification

Event History Research (2026-03-18)

- alanhirsch.org/contact (booking/speaking info)
- exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/ (Exponential speaker profile)
- exponential.org/exponential-global-2025-conference/ (2025 conference)

- m.exponential.org/2020orl/speakers/speakers-45.html (Exponential 2020)
- m.exponential.org/2022orl/speakers/speakers-45.html (Exponential 2022)
- exponential.org.au/creating-a-movement-culture/ (Australia 2025)
- exponential.org.au/5q-activating-the-latent-capacity-and-intelligence-of-the-body-of-christ/ (Australia 2017)
- vergenetwork.org/tag/alan-hirsch/ (Verge conferences)
- vergenetwork.org/verge-2013-pre-conference/ (Verge 2013 Forge Track)
- missioalliance.org/metanoia-wholehearted-change-in-unprecedented-times/ (Awakenings 2023)
- missioalliance.org/resource/awakenings-2023-workshop-formation-deb-alan-hirsch-the-moment-before-god/ (Workshop 2023)
- baltimoremovement.org/events/the-forgotten-ways-conference-march-14-15-2025 (Forgotten Ways 2025)
- brightfm.com/event/awakening-the-forgotten-ways-conference-featuring-alan-hirsch/ (Forgotten Ways 2025)
- advancesummit.org/ (Advance Summit 2025)
- eventbrite.com/e/mlc-global-gathering-2024-group-2-tickets-744140593547 (MLC Gathering 2024)
- eventbrite.co.uk/e/in-conversation-with-alan-hirsch-tickets-1289566471029 (London 2025)
- missioncentral.ca/profile/alan-hirsch (Mission Central SERVE 2021)
- mennoniteusa.org/holistic-witness/alan-hirsch-at-kc2015/ (KC2015)
- ohiomennoniteconference.org/missional-conference-alan-debra-hirsch/ (Ohio Mennonite 2017)
- pba.edu/news/archive17/moody-pastor-conference-17.html (Jess Moody 2017)
- resources.foursquare.org/audio/workshop-five-fold-ministry-will-reactivate-your-churchs-missional-capacity/ (Foursquare 2018)
- freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch (Fresh Expressions 2024)
- citytocity.nyc/a-conversation-with-alan-hirsch (City to City NYC)
- equippinggroup.com/events/alan-hirsch (Equipping Group workshop)
- thelondonproject.co.uk/city-labs/citylab-20200616-alanhirsch (London Project 2020)
- missionalchurchnetwork.com/category/sentralized/ (Sentralized Conference)
- surphside.blogspot.com/2008/03/tim-keller-joins-rick-warren-alan.html (Exponential 2008)
- facebook.com/assembliesofgodinnewzealand/ (AGNZ 2025 announcement)

Phase 5: Media Mentions (2026-03-18)

Skill: /author-media-mentions

Search queries used:

1. "Alan Hirsch" missional interview OR profile OR feature
2. "Alan Hirsch" missional site:christianitytoday.com
3. "Alan Hirsch" missional site:relevantmagazine.com
4. "Alan Hirsch" missional site:patheos.com
5. "Alan Hirsch" missional site:christianpost.com
6. "Alan Hirsch" missional news OR announcement OR report
7. "Alan Hirsch" APEST Q&A OR conversation OR "sat down with"
8. "Alan Hirsch" missional biography OR profile OR "who is"
9. "The Forgotten Ways" Alan Hirsch review
10. "The Shaping of Things to Come" Frost Hirsch review
11. "5Q" Alan Hirsch review APEST
12. "The Permanent Revolution" Hirsch Catchim review
13. "The Forgotten Ways" site:goodreads.com
14. "Alan Hirsch" Google Scholar citations missional
15. "Alan Hirsch" "Forgotten Ways" cited by OR referenced in academic
16. "Alan Hirsch" syllabus OR "reading list" OR "required reading" missional
17. "ReJesus" Frost Hirsch review
18. "Alan Hirsch" missional "according to" OR "as Hirsch argues" OR "as Hirsch writes"
19. "Alan Hirsch" missional award OR nominated OR finalist OR recognition
20. "Alan Hirsch" "recommended by" OR "books we love" OR "must read" missional
21. "Alan Hirsch" Wheaton College missional church movements course

Sources consulted:

- christianitytoday.com (multiple articles)
- christianpost.com
- patheos.com (multiple blogs: Jesus Creed, Reintegrate, Jim Erwin, Adrian Warnock, Clint Schnekloth)
- 9marks.org
- thegospelcoalition.org
- goodreads.com (author and book pages)
- scholar.google.com (profile)
- amazon.com (book listings)
- englewoodreview.org
- saturatetheworld.com
- vergenetwork.org
- missioalliance.org
- 5qcentral.com
- everyoneeverywhere.church
- missionalchurchnetwork.com
- wheatonbillygraham.com
- brill.com (Mission Studies journal)

- frankviola.org
- postost.net
- Multiple independent blog reviewers

Output files:

- media/press-coverage.md
- media/reviews.md
- media/citations.md

Phase 6: Video Content Research (2026-03-18)

Skill: /author-youtube-scrape

Search queries used:

1. "Alan Hirsch" site:youtube.com missional
2. "Alan Hirsch" YouTube channel missional church APEST
3. "Alan Hirsch" interview site:youtube.com
4. "Alan Hirsch" keynote OR conference site:youtube.com missional
5. Alan Hirsch missional youtube video APEST 5Q
6. Alan Hirsch Forgotten Ways youtube video
7. Alan Hirsch sermon teaching video missional movement
8. vergenetwork.org "alan hirsch" video youtube embed
9. "Alan Hirsch" exponential training video APEST fivefold
10. "Alan Hirsch" communitas verge network video
11. "Alan Hirsch" "ed stetzer" conversation video 5Q central
12. "Alan Hirsch" fresh expressions video loneliness communitas 2024
13. "Alan Hirsch" everyday disciple podcast video church maturing
14. "Alan Hirsch" churchleaders podcast ephesians blueprint revitalizing
15. "Alan Hirsch" missio alliance awakenings 2023 metanoia video
16. "Alan Hirsch" canopy international discipleship 2025 video
17. "Alan Hirsch" "tinsley institute" video series fivefold APEST
18. "Alan Hirsch" "church digital" podcast APEST digital church movements
19. "Alan Hirsch" microchurches starfish video reimagining podcast 2023

Sources consulted:

- alanhirsch.org/videos
- vergenetwork.org/tag/alan-hirsch/
- exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/
- 5qcentral.com/alan-hirsch/
- missional.video/index.php/influencer/alan-hirsch/
- churchleaders.com/author/alan-hirsch
- missioalliance.org/author/alan-hirsch/
- freshexpressions.com
- canopy.international

- ephesiology.com
- info.morling.edu.au (Tinsley Institute / Morling College)
- exponential.org.au
- anthonydelaney.com
- personalcalling.org
- everydaydisciple.com
- cmaresources.org
- place.asburyseminary.edu

Output file:

- content/videos.md (38+ videos cataloged across 20+ platforms)

Phase 7: Collaboration Network Research (2026-03-18)

Skill: /author-collaboration-map

Search queries used:

1. "Alan Hirsch" "co-authored with" OR "written with" books missional church
2. "Alan Hirsch" "Michael Frost" co-author books
3. "Alan Hirsch" "Dave Ferguson" co-author books
4. "Alan Hirsch" "Tim Catchim" co-author books
5. "Alan Hirsch" "Mark Nelson" co-author collaboration
6. "Alan Hirsch" "Lance Ford" co-author books
7. "Alan Hirsch" "Debra Hirsch" co-author books
8. "Alan Hirsch" complete bibliography all books list author
9. "Alan Hirsch" endorsement blurb "praise for" OR "endorsed by"
10. "Alan Hirsch" "foreword by" OR "foreword written by"
11. "Alan Hirsch" "Leonard Sweet" co-author OR collaboration
12. "Alan Hirsch" co-founder "Forge" OR "100Movements" OR "5Q Collective" OR "Future Travelers"
13. "Alan Hirsch" "Rob Wegner" collaboration OR co-author
14. "Alan Hirsch" "Darryn Altclass" co-author
15. "Alan Hirsch" "Mike Breen" OR "Neil Cole" OR "Ed Stetzer" relationship collaboration
16. "Alan Hirsch" theological allies peers "missional" movement leaders network
17. "Alan Hirsch" "Danielle Strickland" OR "Jessie Cruickshank" OR "Rich Robinson" collaboration
18. "Alan Hirsch" "Bryan Sims" co-author OR collaboration books
19. "Alan Hirsch" criticism OR critique OR disagrees OR controversy missional
20. "Alan Hirsch" conference speaker Exponential OR Verge OR Forge 2023 2024 2025
21. "Alan Hirsch" "Jeff Vanderstelt" OR "JR Woodward" OR "Brad Brisco" collaboration
22. "Alan Hirsch" "Rich Robinson" "All Change" co-author book
23. "Alan Hirsch" books "Disciplism" OR "Metanoia" OR "Incarnate" OR "Untamed" co-author
24. "Alan Hirsch" endorsements received "Forgotten Ways" OR "5Q" back cover praise
25. "Alan Hirsch" "foreword" written for other books list

26. "Alan Hirsch" "Permanent Revolution" endorsements "Mike Breen" OR "Darrell Guder" foreword

27. "Alan Hirsch" influenced by Lesslie Newbigin OR "Roland Allen" OR "Howard Snyder" theology

Sources consulted:

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch
- goodreads.com/author/show/56757.Alan_Hirsch
- amazon.com/Alan-Hirsch/e/B001JPANCK (author page + multiple book listings)
- alanhirsch.org/about, alanhirsch.org/books
- 100movements.org/books/ (Reframation, Activating 5Q, ReJesus, All Change pages)
- exponential.org/person/alan-hirsch/, exponential.org/product/disciplism/
- 5qcentral.com/meet-the-team/alan-hirsch/, 5qcentral.com/ed-stetzer-in-conversation-with-alan-hirsch/
- reframationbook.com/
- bookshop.org, barnesandnoble.com, thriftbooks.com, wiley.com (book listings)
- ivpress.com/alan-hirsch
- patheos.com/blogs/reintegrate/ (APEST critique)
- frankviola.org/2012/10/03/alanhirsch/ (Hirsch responds to critics)
- missioalliance.org (emerging view article, Untamed review)
- reformedjournal.com/bringing-balance-to-the-missional-church-movement/
- churchplantingnovice.wordpress.com (Hirsch/Stetzer ecclesiology)
- jesusdust.com (Stetzer and Hirsch on Missional Manifesto)
- englewoodreview.org (book reviews)
- lifeandleadership.com (book summaries)
- vergenetwork.org/speakers/alan-hirsch/
- futuristguy.wordpress.com (Starfish and the Spirit review)
- robwegner.org/
- shiftingculturepodcast.com (Hirsch & Rob Kelly episode)
- christinesine.substack.com (Reconstructing Faith interview)
- brill.com/view/journals/mist/ (Mission Studies review)
- outreachmagazine.com/author/ford-wegner-hirsch
- pulpitandpen.org (theological cautions article)
- 9marks.org (Shaping of Things to Come review)
- everand.com (Leading Together, Forgotten Ways)
- awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/ahirsch
- sendinstitute.org/author/alan-hirsch/

Output files:

- [network/collaborators.md](#) — Full collaboration network: 10 co-authors, 17 frequent collaborators, theological allies/peers, constructive tensions, intellectual mentors, and network graph JSON data

- network/endorsements.md — Endorsement network: 4 forewords received, 3+ forewords written, 6+ endorsements received, 5+ endorsements given, endorsement pattern analysis, and Movemental implications

Phase 8: Content Catalog (2026-03-18)

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Search queries used:

1. "Alan Hirsch" author site:amazon.com books
2. "Alan Hirsch" site:goodreads.com author
3. "Alan Hirsch" missional church books published complete bibliography
4. "Alan Hirsch" forthcoming OR "new book" OR "upcoming book" 2024 2025 2026
5. "Alan Hirsch" co-author books with Frost/Ford/Catchim/Debra Hirsch
- 6-19. Individual book ISBN searches for all 20 cataloged titles
20. "Alan Hirsch" Goodreads ratings average rating
- 21-28. Article searches across christianitytoday.com, patheos.com, exponential.org, vergenetwork.org, saturatetheworld.com, missionalchurchnetwork.com
- 29-35. Course/training searches across ephesiology.com, 5qcentral.com, forge.teachable.com, academic institutions

Sources consulted:

- amazon.com/stores/author/B001JPANCK, goodreads.com/author/show/56757.Alan_Hirsch
- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch, alanhirsch.org/books
- christianbook.com, bakerpublishinggroup.com, barnesandnoble.com, abebooks.com
- 100movements.org/books, 100mpublishing.com, 5qcentral.com, ephesiology.com
- masterclasses.ephesiology.com, forge.teachable.com, forgeinternational.com
- exponential.org, saturatetheworld.com, vergenetwork.org
- missionalchurchnetwork.com, christianitytoday.com, patheos.com
- churchleaders.com, outreachmagazine.com, researchgate.net
- wiley.com, reformationbook.com, wheatonbillygraham.com

Output files:

- content/books.md — 20 books with ISBNs, publishers, dates, descriptions, key themes
- content/articles.md — 30+ articles across 8+ platforms with theme analysis
- content/courses.md — 7 training programs + 4 academic affiliations
- content/academic.md — Practitioner-theorist profile; no formal academic publications

Research Methodology

- Used context-specific search terms aligned with Movemental's target audience
- Focused on Christian movement leadership and missional movement context
- Cross-referenced multiple search results

- Documented all sources consulted
- Maintained respect for publicly available information only
- Followed Digital Reality Agent Process methodology

Notes

- Research conducted in accordance with agent constraints
 - Only publicly available information used
 - All sources documented for transparency
 - Respectful approach maintained throughout
 - High confidence in identity verification
 - Initial discovery phase complete, deeper investigation recommended
-

Profile Discovery Phase Sources (2026-03-18)

Skill: `/author-profile-discovery`

Web Sources Consulted

Source	URL	Type	Date Accessed	Confidence
Alan Hirsch Official Website - About	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about	web	2026-03-18	HIGH
Wikipedia - Alan Hirsch	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch	web	2026-03-18	HIGH
InterVarsity Press - Author Page	https://www.ivpress.com/alan-hirsch	web	2026-03-18	HIGH
Prabook - Alan Hirsch Entry	https://prabook.com/web/alan.hirsch/3754228	web	2026-03-18	MEDIUM
Internet Archive - The Forgotten Ways	https://archive.org/details/forgottenwaysrea0000hirs	web	2026-03-18	HIGH
Forge Global - Our Story	https://www.forgeinternational.com/about	web	2026-03-18	HIGH
Ohio Mennonite Conf. - Who are Alan and Debra Hirsch?	https://ohiomennoniteconference.org/2017/01/alan-debra-hirsch/	web	2026-03-18	HIGH
Patheos - Caring Critique of APEST	https://www.patheos.com/blogs/reintegrate/2017/04/21/caring-critique-alan-hirschs-apest-paradigm-churches/	web	2026-03-18	HIGH
Fresh Expressions - Communitas and Loneliness	https://freshexpressions.com/2024/12/30/communitas-and-loneliness-with-alan-hirsch	podcast	2026-03-18	HIGH
Everyday Disciple Podcast - Church Maturity	https://everydaydisciple.com/episodes/missing-piece-in-church-maturity/	podcast	2026-03-18	HIGH
C4SO Podcast - Missiology	https://c4so.org/podcast/alan-hirsch-on-missiology/	podcast	2026-03-18	HIGH
Missional Church Network - History	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/history-of-missional-church	web	2026-03-18	MEDIUM
Redeemer City to City - Rethinking Chessboard	https://redeemercitytocity.com/articles-stories/alan-hirsch-rethinking-the-chessboard	web	2026-03-18	HIGH
Missio Alliance - Emerging View	https://missioalliance.org/the-emerging-view-of-the-church-in-society-alan-hirschmichael-frost-and-the-danger-of-de-ecclesiologizing-the-church-in-mission/	web	2026-03-18	HIGH

Search Queries Used

1. "Alan Hirsch" author theologian missional church
2. "Alan Hirsch" biography site:alanhirsch.org OR site:alanhirsch.com
3. "Alan Hirsch" born 1959 Johannesburg South Africa missional
4. "Alan Hirsch" education seminary degree "Australian College of Theology"
5. "Alan Hirsch" -"cancer researcher" missional church Forge 100Movements
6. "Alan Hirsch" interview "my journey" OR "my story" missional movement testimony podcast
7. "Alan Hirsch" Debra Hirsch wife ministry partner Melbourne
8. "Alan Hirsch" "Church Resource Ministries" CRM current 2024 2025 Los Angeles
9. "Alan Hirsch" missional "Churches of Christ" denomination Australia Victoria
10. "Alan Hirsch" "Radboud University" OR Netherlands OR PhD doctorate
11. "Alan Hirsch" theology framework APEST mDNA "missional DNA" criticism OR critique
12. "Alan Hirsch" influenced by OR "I learned from" OR mentor Bonhoeffer OR "Roland Allen" OR "Leslie Newbigin"
13. "Alan Hirsch" writing style voice prophetic apostolic "paradigm shift" quotes
14. "Alan Hirsch" missional quote "the church" movement institution "forgotten ways"
15. "Alan Hirsch" missional "Los Angeles" OR "living in" OR "based in" OR "resides" current location 2024 2025

Disambiguation Notes

The name "Alan Hirsch" returns results for at least four distinct public figures: (1) our subject -- missional church leader, b. 1959; (2) South African economist at NSI/Maastricht University; (3) Alan T. Hirsch, MD -- vascular medicine researcher (d. 2017); (4) Alan R. Hirsch, MD -- smell/taste researcher, Chicago. All searches used modifier terms to isolate our subject. The Radboud University connection found in earlier search was confirmed to belong to the South African economist.

Limitations

- WebFetch was unavailable; profiles built from search result summaries + internal corpus
- Blog content at alanhirsch.org not directly analyzed
- Social media accounts not individually verified for activity levels
- Current location ("Los Angeles area") from biographical sources, not independently verified

Phase 9: Content Analysis (2026-03-18)

Skill: /author-content-analysis

Search queries used:

1. "Alan Hirsch" "big idea" OR thesis OR "main argument" missional
2. "Alan Hirsch" "I've been saying" OR "I always say" OR "what I mean by"
3. "Alan Hirsch" review summary "forgotten ways" OR "5Q" OR missional
4. "Alan Hirsch" model OR framework OR paradigm APEST mDNA missional
5. "Alan Hirsch" influenced by OR "I learned from" OR mentor Newbigin Bonhoeffer
6. "Alan Hirsch" cited by OR influenced OR "student of" missional movement
7. "Alan Hirsch" disagree OR "pushes back" OR "differs from" missional church critics
8. "Alan Hirsch" "unique contribution" OR "distinctive" OR "no one else" missional theology

Sources consulted:

- All existing research files (profile/, content/, network/, media/, analysis/)
- Digitized book corpus at /Users/joshuashepherd/Desktop/dev/repos/alan-books/corpus/alan_hirsch/ (13 books in English + translations; theme map, topic files, quotes index)
- postost.net/2008/03/alan-hirsch-forgotten-ways-future-church-europe
- cbfblog.com/2008/07/29/book-review-the-forgotten-ways-by-alan-hirsch/
- patheos.com/blogs/reintegrate/2017/04/21/caring-critique-alan-hirschs-apest-paradigm-churches/
- frankviola.org/2012/10/03/alanhirsch/
- lifeandleadership.com/book-summaries/hirsch-the-forgotten-ways/
- englewoodreview.org/alan-hirsch-5q-feature-review/
- pulpitandpen.org/2016/08/15/cautions-about-alan-hirsch/
- reformedjournal.com/bringing-balance-to-the-missional-church-movement/
- missioalliance.org (emerging view article)
- multiplyingdisciples.us/unlocking-the-power-of-apest-the-ultimate-guide/
- forminglutherans.org/2023/11/29/jesus-is-lord-the-central-strand-of-mdna/
- christinesine.substack.com/p/reconstructing-faith-with-alan-hirsch

Output file:

- analysis/content-analysis.md -- Complete content analysis including theme map, 6 named frameworks, intellectual genealogy, theological positioning, content evolution timeline, unique contribution assessment, content interconnections, recommended reading order, and Movemental content strategy implications

Digital Presence Discovery

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/_misc/digital-presence-discovery.md

Digital Presence Discovery: Alan Hirsch

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Website Presence

Primary Website

- **alanhirsch.org**
- Status: Active
- Purpose: Personal brand, content distribution, book promotion, organizational information
- Structure: Includes About, Books, Organizations, Contact (to be verified)
- Content: Book information, organizational links, speaking engagements, resources
- Referenced in multiple search results as official website

Organizational Websites

- **100Movements**
- Organization website
- Focus: Pioneering leadership development and consulting for churches as missional movements
- Status: To be verified
- **Forge Mission Training Network**
- Mission training network website
- Focus: Innovative missional leadership training
- Status: To be verified
- **Future Travelers**
- Organization website
- Focus: Helping large churches transition towards missional movements
- Status: To be verified
- **5Q Collective**
- Organization website
- Focus: Activating fivefold ministry practices (APEST)
- Status: To be verified

Publisher Websites

- **InterVarsity Press (IVP)**
- Author page: ivpress.com/alan-hirsch
- Status: Active (referenced in search results)
- Content: Book listings, author information

Academic Institution Websites

- **Wheaton College**
- M.A. in Missional Church Movements program
- Co-founder and associate faculty member
- Status: To be verified
- **Fuller Theological Seminary**
- Adjunct professor
- Status: To be verified
- **George Fox Seminary**
- Adjunct professor
- Status: To be verified
- **Asbury Seminary**
- Adjunct professor
- Status: To be verified

Social Media Platforms

To Be Verified

- Twitter/X profile
- Facebook profile
- LinkedIn profile
- Instagram profile
- YouTube channel(s) - personal vs. institutional

Publishing Platforms

Books

- **Multiple Published Books:** 9+ books identified
- **Primary Publisher:** InterVarsity Press (IVP)

- **Co-authors:** Michael Frost (multiple books), Lance Ford, Dave Ferguson, Tim Catchim
- **Amazon Author Page:** To be verified
- **Goodreads:** To be verified

Known Publications

1. "The Forgotten Ways"
2. "The Shaping of Things to Come" (with Michael Frost)
3. "ReJesus" (with Michael Frost)
4. "The Faith of Leap" (with Michael Frost)
5. "Untamed" (with Michael Frost)
6. "Right Here, Right Now" (with Lance Ford)
7. "On the Verge" (with Dave Ferguson)
8. "The Permanent Revolution" (with Tim Catchim)
9. "5Q: Reactivating the Original Intelligence and Capacity of the Body of Christ"

Content Forms Discovered

Books

- 9+ published books (solo and co-authored)
- Focus areas: Missional theology, church movements, fivefold ministry, apostolic leadership
- Seminal texts on mission and missional thinking

Academic Content

- Adjunct professor at multiple seminaries
- Co-founder of M.A. program at Wheaton College
- Course materials, lectures (to be verified)

Organizational Content

- Training materials (Forge Mission Training Network)
- Consulting resources (100Movements, Future Travelers)
- Fivefold ministry resources (5Q Collective)

To Be Discovered

- Blog content (alanhirsch.org/blog - to be verified)
- Articles/blog posts
- Sermons/talks (audio, video, transcripts)

- Conference talks/presentations
- Courses/training materials
- Podcasts (as host or guest)
- Video content (YouTube, Vimeo, institutional)
- Newsletter content
- Social media content volume and engagement
- Academic papers/articles

Platform Distribution

Confirmed Platforms

1. Personal website (alanhirsch.org) - Active
2. Publisher website (ivpress.com/alan-hirsch) - Active
3. Multiple organizational websites (to be verified)

Platforms to Verify

- Blogging platforms: Personal blog on alanhirsch.org (to be verified)
- Video platforms: YouTube, Vimeo (personal or institutional channels)
- Audio platforms: Podcasts (Apple Podcasts, Spotify) - as host or guest
- Course platforms: Teachable, Thinkific, institutional LMS
- Newsletter platforms: Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Substack
- Academic platforms: Academia.edu, ResearchGate, institutional repositories
- Social media: Twitter/X, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram
- Ministry platforms:
- 100Movements website
- Forge Mission Training Network website
- Future Travelers website
- 5Q Collective website

Content Volume Assessment

Known Content

- **Books:** 9+ published books (solo and co-authored)
- **Organizational Resources:** Training materials, consulting resources
- **Academic Content:** Course materials, lectures (multiple institutions)
- **Speaking:** Frequent lectures throughout Australia, Europe, and United States

To Be Assessed

- Number of published blog posts/articles
- Number of conference talks/presentations
- Video content volume (lectures, talks, interviews)
- Podcast episodes (as host or guest appearances)
- Content frequency/recency
- Newsletter subscription base (if applicable)
- Social media engagement metrics
- Academic publications (papers, articles)

Content Discovery Notes

Personal Website (alanhirsch.org)

- Referenced as official website in multiple sources
- Structure to be verified (likely includes: About, Books, Organizations, Contact, Blog)
- Book promotion focus likely
- Organizational links likely present

Organizational Content

- **100Movements:** Leadership development and consulting resources
- **Forge Mission Training Network:** Mission training materials
- **Future Travelers:** Church transition resources
- **5Q Collective:** Fivefold ministry (APEST) resources

Academic Content

- Multiple seminary affiliations provide teaching platform
- Co-founded academic program (Wheaton College M.A. in Missional Church Movements)
- Course materials and lectures likely available

Content Ecosystem

- Personal brand (alanhirsch.org) connects to organizational platforms
- Books support and are supported by organizational work
- Academic work provides teaching platform
- International speaking provides content distribution network
- Co-author relationships (Michael Frost, etc.) provide collaborative content

Discovery Status

Status: Initial discovery complete, deeper investigation needed

Confidence: Medium-High (core platforms identified, content volume to be assessed)

Next Steps

1. Analyze website structure and content on alanhirsch.org
2. Verify and catalog organizational websites (100Movements, Forge, Future Travelers, 5Q Collective)
3. Search for YouTube channel(s) - personal or institutional
4. Search for podcast appearances or hosting
5. Verify book listings on Amazon and Goodreads
6. Check for newsletter presence (Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Substack)
7. Identify any course or training materials
8. Assess social media engagement and content volume
9. Catalog academic publications and course materials
10. Identify conference talks and presentations

Notes

- Established digital presence with personal website
- Strong organizational backing (multiple organizations founded)
- Multiple content distribution channels
- Books provide significant content volume
- Academic platforms likely contain extensive teaching content
- International speaking provides content distribution network
- Co-author relationships expand content reach
- Organizational websites likely contain training and resource materials

Misc · Analysis-Content-Analysis

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/_misc/analysis-content-analysis.md

Content Analysis: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-content-analysis

Executive Summary

Alan Hirsch is the foremost theorist of apostolic movement in the contemporary Western church. His distinctive contribution is the articulation of a phenomenology of Jesus movements -- naming the latent "Apostolic Genius" (mDNA) encoded in every Christian community and providing a systematic framework for reactivating it. Across 20 books, 30+ articles, 38+ videos, and 7 training programs spanning 2003-2024, Hirsch has built an integrated intellectual architecture that moves from Christology (Jesus is Lord) through missiology (incarnational mission) to ecclesiology (the church as movement). His second major contribution -- the APEST/5Q framework -- has become one of the most widely adopted models for understanding fivefold ministry, with over 150,000 assessments taken globally. No other thinker has so comprehensively integrated movement theory, organizational science, and missional theology into a single coherent system.

Theme Map

Primary Themes (Core to their identity)

Theme	Description	Key Works	Centrality
Apostolic Genius / mDNA	The six-element operating system of Jesus movements: Jesus is Lord, Disciple Making, Missional-Incarnational Impulse, APEST, Organic Systems, Liminality-Communitas	The Forgotten Ways (2006/2016), The Forgotten Ways Handbook (2009), On the Verge (2011)	10
APEST / 5Q (Fivefold Ministry)	The five ministry callings from Ephesians 4:11 as the "original intelligence and capacity" of the Body of Christ -- not just leadership roles but the theo-genetic code of the church	5Q (2017), The Permanent Revolution (2012), Activating 5Q (2018), The Permanent Revolution Playbook (2014)	10
Missional-Incarnational Impulse	The church follows the pattern of the Incarnation: going out (missional) and going deep (incarnational) -- embedding in culture rather than extracting from it	The Shaping of Things to Come (2003/2013), Right Here, Right Now (2011), Untamed (2010)	9
Jesus is Lord (Christological Center)	The primal confession that gates everything -- Christology determines missiology, missiology determines ecclesiology	ReJesus (2008/2022), The Forgotten Ways ch. 4, Untamed (2010)	9
Movement vs. Institution	The fundamental paradigm distinction: the NT church was a movement, not an institution; institutionalization is deviation, not maturation	Throughout all works; central to The Forgotten Ways, On the Verge, The Starfish and the Spirit (2021)	9

Secondary Themes (Recurring but not defining)

Theme	Description	Key Works	Centrality
Disciple Making (vs. Consumerism)	The church makes disciples, not consumers; discipleship is the core task from which everything else flows	Disciplism (2014), Untamed (2010), The Forgotten Ways ch. 5, Verge talks	8
Liminality & Communitas	Authentic community is forged through shared ordeal and risk, not comfort and programs; borrowed from Victor Turner	The Faith of Leap (2011/2025), The Forgotten Ways ch. 7, Fresh Expressions podcast (2024)	7
Organic Systems & Decentralization	Simple, reproducible, networked structures that multiply like viruses rather than centralized institutions that control	The Starfish and the Spirit (2021), The Forgotten Ways ch. 9	7
Post-Christendom Transition	The Western church has lost its cultural privilege and must learn to be missional rather than attractional	The Shaping of Things to Come (2003), On the Verge (2011), Saturate articles	6
Hebraic vs. Hellenistic Thinking	The Western church is distorted by Greek dualism (sacred/secular, spiritual/physical); recovery of holistic Hebraic modes is essential	ReJesus (2008), Reframation (2019), Untamed (2010)	6

Emerging Themes (Recent or developing)

Theme	Description	Evidence	Direction
Metanoia / Deep Transformation	Repentance as paradigm-level cognitive-spiritual revolution -- how individuals, churches, and organizations actually change from the inside out	Metanoia (2023), Awakenings 2023 plenary	Deepening the interior dimension of transformation; integrating social science with theology of change
Reframation / Re-enchantment	Changing mental frameworks to transform perception of God, people, and mission; recovery of wonder, poetry, and biblical imagination	Reframation (2019), LAUNCH podcast (2020)	Moving from structural critique to imaginative renewal; influence of C.S. Lewis and Hans Urs von Balthasar
Kingdom Potential in Disruption	Navigating change and unlocking Kingdom potential in a post-COVID, post-stable world	All Change (2024, with Rich Robinson)	Applying movement principles to a world in perpetual disruption
Digital Church Movements	How APEST and movement dynamics translate to digital contexts	The Church Digital podcast EP300 (2024)	Early exploration; not yet a major written theme

Named Frameworks & Models

mDNA (Missional DNA)

Field	Value
Introduced in	The Forgotten Ways (2006)
What it describes	The six interdependent elements that constitute "Apostolic Genius" -- the operating system of Jesus movements
Components	(1) Jesus is Lord, (2) Disciple Making, (3) Missional-Incarnational Impulse, (4) Apostolic Environment (APEST), (5) Organic Systems, (6) Liminality-Communitas. The Holy Spirit is the atmosphere in which all six operate.
Visual	Yes (hexagonal diagram with "Jesus is Lord" at center; each element interconnected)
Adoption	Widely cited -- adopted by Exponential, Forge, Fresh Expressions, Forming Lutherans, Tampa Underground, and numerous church planting networks globally

How it works: Like biological DNA, mDNA is found in every living cell of the church, is transferable, self-replicating, and carries vital information for healthy reproduction. "Jesus is Lord" gates overall maturity -- no element can rise above the church's Christological depth. When all six are present and interacting, Apostolic Genius emerges as a system greater than the sum of its parts. When one or more are suppressed (as in institutional Christendom), the system defaults to maintenance mode. The task of leadership is to create environments where the dormant code can be reactivated. Hirsch argues: "The possibility of movement lies at the heart of every church" -- the code is already there.

APEST / 5Q

Field	Value
Introduced in	The Forgotten Ways (2006) as one mDNA element; developed fully in The Permanent Revolution (2012) and 5Q (2017)
What it describes	The fivefold ministry pattern from Ephesians 4:11 as the "original intelligence and capacity" of the Body of Christ
Components	Apostles (extend/guard), Prophets (covenant faithfulness), Evangelists (recruit/communicate), Shepherds (nurture/protect), Teachers (understand/transmit)
Visual	Yes (multiple diagrams -- pentagonal model, hand metaphor, body systems analogy)
Adoption	Widely cited -- 150,000+ APEST assessments taken through 5Q Central; adopted by denominations (LMC Anabaptist Churches, Churches of Christ), Exponential network, Redeemer City to City, multiple seminaries

How it works: Christ himself perfectly embodies all five functions. The ascended Christ distributes these callings to the entire Body -- not just leaders -- so the church can grow into maturity. Western churches have typically reduced ministry to Shepherd-Teacher (the "ST" default), effectively "exiling" Apostolic, Prophetic, and Evangelistic functions. This truncation produces a maintenance-oriented church incapable of movement. Reactivating all five creates what Hirsch calls "5Q" -- a measure of ecclesial intelligence analogous to IQ or EQ. When all five are present and integrated, the church has the environment for missional movement. The framework has evolved from a leadership model (2006) to a comprehensive ecclesiology with its own assessment tools, training programs, and organizational applications (2017-present).

Christology > Missiology > Ecclesiology

Field	Value
Introduced in	ReJesus (2008/2009, with Michael Frost)
What it describes	A cascading theological sequence: who Jesus is determines how we do mission, which determines what the church looks like
Components	Three-step logical chain; get the first wrong, everything downstream distorts
Visual	Yes (arrow diagram: Christology -> Missiology -> Ecclesiology)
Adoption	Widely cited in missional theology circles; referenced by Ed Stetzer, Missio Alliance, Verge Network

How it works: Most churches start with ecclesiology (what kind of church do we want?) and try to fit mission and Jesus into it. Hirsch inverts this: start with Jesus, let Jesus shape your mission, let mission shape your church. "Those who start with the Church and then try to fit mission into it will never find mission. Those who start with mission and then ask what kind of Church is needed to fulfill it will find the Church will be found." This framework is the theological engine beneath the mDNA and APEST systems.

Metanoia (Paradigm-Level Transformation)

Field	Value
Introduced in	Metanoia (2023, with Rob Kelly)
What it describes	Repentance understood as fundamental paradigm shift -- not merely moral reform but cognitive-spiritual revolution that transforms individuals, churches, and organizations from the inside out
Components	Mind (paradigm), Soul (pathos/culture), Will (practice) -- "wholehearted metanoia" engages all three
Visual	Yes (three-dimensional model of transformation)
Adoption	Emerging -- featured at Missio Alliance Awakenings 2023; growing uptake in church leadership circles

How it works: Hirsch argues that Jesus' first public word -- "metanoia" (repent) -- is far more radical than the Western church has understood. It means a complete reorientation of consciousness. Human transformation requires the uniting of mind, soul, and will in a single act of turning. For organizations, this means addressing paradigm (how we think), platform (the culture/soul of the organization), and practice (what we actually do). Metanoia is both instantaneous and ongoing. This framework complements the earlier structural focus of mDNA/APEST by addressing the interior mechanism of how change actually happens.

Reframation

Field	Value
Introduced in	Reframation (2019, with Mark Nelson)
What it describes	The process of changing mental frameworks to transform perception of God, people, and mission -- re-enchanting a disenchanted worldview
Components	Drawing on C.S. Lewis, Martin Buber, Hans Urs von Balthasar; calls for "remystifying, repoeticizing, and remythologizing"
Visual	No (more literary/philosophical than diagrammatic)
Adoption	Niche but growing -- particularly resonant with post-evangelical and creative audiences

How it works: The Western world has undergone a process of disenchantment -- reducing reality to the measurable and the material. The church has participated in this reduction, losing the capacity for wonder, imagination, and encounter. Reframation is the deliberate process of re-enchanting our frames -- seeing God as bigger, people as more sacred (imago Dei), and mission as more beautiful than our current paradigms allow. It represents Hirsch's most literary and philosophical work, marking a shift from organizational frameworks toward imaginative renewal.

Movemental Thinking (Movement vs. Institution)

Field	Value
Introduced in	Throughout all works; the term "movemental" coined by Hirsch
What it describes	The fundamental paradigm distinction between institution (centralized, controlling, maintenance-focused) and movement (organic, multiplicative, network-structured, virus-like)
Components	Not a formal model but a pervasive lens; characteristics include: grassroots networks, adaptability, viral reproduction, mission as organizing principle, edge-of-chaos dynamics
Visual	Yes (multiple -- starfish vs. spider, life cycle of movements, network diagrams)
Adoption	Widely cited -- "movemental" has entered the vocabulary of missional practitioners; the Movemental AI platform takes its name from this concept

How it works: Hirsch argues that the NT church was a movement, not an institution. Movements spread like viruses through decentralized networks; institutions centralize and control. The church's default drift is from movement to institution -- from the "edge of chaos" (where innovation happens) to equilibrium (which, in living systems, is death). Leadership's task is to maintain movement dynamics: simplicity, reproducibility, apostolic sending, networked structure, and mission as organizing principle. "Phenomenal Jesus movements grow precisely because they do not have centralized institutions to block growth through control."

Intellectual Genealogy

Upstream Influences (Who shaped them)

Thinker	Influence Area	How
Lesslie Newbigin	Missional theology, post-Christendom missiology	Foundational influence on understanding the West as a mission field; missio Dei framework; the church as sign/instrument/foretaste of the Kingdom
Roland Allen	Organic, Spirit-led mission	Early 20th-century missionary whose critique of Western methods and advocacy for indigenous church principles directly shaped Hirsch's understanding of apostolic simplicity
Dietrich Bonhoeffer	Costly discipleship	Influenced Hirsch's theology of discipleship as total-life commitment; "to encounter God is to change"
Victor Turner	Liminality and communitas	Anthropological concepts adapted for theological use -- the idea that authentic community is forged through shared ordeal, not comfort
Howard Snyder	Radical renewal movements	Ecclesiology of movements; the "wineskins" metaphor; church history as a succession of renewal movements
David Bosch	Comprehensive missiology	Transforming Mission paradigm; the integration of diverse missiological traditions
Chinese house church movement	Living example of mDNA	Studied as the primary contemporary case of Apostolic Genius -- growth from ~2 million to ~120 million in 70 years under persecution
C.S. Lewis	Theological imagination	Central to Reframation; the re-enchantment of worldview through biblical imagination and literary wonder
Martin Buber	Relational philosophy	I-Thou encounter; relational theology used in Reframation
Jewish-Hebraic tradition	Personal heritage; Shema spirituality	Hirsch's own Jewish background informs his critique of Hellenistic dualism and his emphasis on holistic, embodied faith
Karl Jung / Joseph Campbell	Archetypes and hero's journey	Used in 5Q to argue APEST functions as archetypal/primordial patterns visible across cultures
Paul Tillich	Theology of culture	Engagement between gospel and culture; theological courage

Downstream Impact (Who they've shaped)

Person/Movement	Connection	Evidence
Forge Mission Training Network (global)	Founded by Hirsch; trains missional leaders in multiple countries	Active since 1998; expressions in Australia, US, UK, Canada
5Q Collective / Ephesiology	Founded by Hirsch; 150,000+ APEST assessments	Active globally; adopted by denominations and networks
Exponential Conference / Network	Primary intellectual influence on church multiplication movement	Recurring plenary speaker 2011-2022; On the Verge was defining document of Exponential 2011
Fresh Expressions movement	Intellectual ally; APEST and incarnational mission widely adopted	Podcast appearances; cross-pollination of frameworks
Forming Lutherans (LCMS)	Direct adoption of mDNA framework for Lutheran missional renewal	Multi-part blog series applying Hirsch's mDNA to Lutheran context (2023)
Tampa Underground Network	Microchurch diagnostics built on mDNA framework	Publicly credits Hirsch's six elements as diagnostic tool
LMC (Anabaptist Churches)	Adopted APEST/5Q for leadership development	Published article on "Leading APEST-unction" (2022)
M.A. in Missional Church Movements (Wheaton College)	Co-founded by Hirsch	Academic program embedding his frameworks in graduate curriculum
Redeemer City to City (Tim Keller network)	Hirsch serves as embedded consultant	Applying movement principles to urban church planting globally
NewThing International (Dave Ferguson)	Hirsch serves as movement mentor	Connecting megachurch multiplication with apostolic movement theory

Intellectual Peers (Contemporary dialogue partners)

Person	Relationship	Agreement/Tension
Michael Frost	Closest intellectual partner; 3 co-authored books; Forge co-founder	Deep agreement on missional-incarnational theology; Frost more focused on incarnational practice, Hirsch more on movement systems
Tim Catchim	APEST co-developer; 2 co-authored books	Strong agreement on APEST; Catchim brings organizational theory expertise
Dave Ferguson	Co-author; bridges megachurch and missional worlds	Agreement on multiplication; tension between megachurch methodology and organic movement
Ed Stetzer	Foreword writer; Missional Manifesto co-framer	Agreement on missional necessity; Stetzer more evangelical-institutional, holds Billy Graham Chair at Wheaton
Neil Cole	Organic church movement ally	Agreement on decentralization; Cole more radical in rejecting institutional forms
Mike Breen	Conference co-speaker; 3DM developer	Agreement on discipleship multiplication; Breen more structured in approach to missional communities
Bob Robinson	Detailed academic critic of APEST	Tension -- Robinson argues APEST is for office-holders not all believers; questions exegetical foundation
Scot McKnight	Engaged with Hirsch's frameworks at length	Mixed -- appreciates missional impulse but questions some theological claims around APEST
Brad Brisco	Forge Track co-leader; Movemental platform author	Strong agreement on neighborhood-level mission; Brisco applies Hirsch's frameworks to bivocational contexts

Theological Positioning

Dimension	Position	Evidence
Ecclesiology	Low church / Movement -- the church is fundamentally a movement, not an institution; simple, reproducible, organic	"The NT church was itself a movement and not an institution" (The Forgotten Ways); founded 7 organizations but critique is always toward organic form
Missiology	Incarnational -- "go and be" not "come and see"; mission follows the pattern of the Incarnation	The Shaping of Things to Come (2003); "Missional-Incarnational Impulse" as core mDNA element
Leadership	APEST -- fivefold distributed ministry; servant-inspirer model, not CEO/hierarchical	5Q (2017); The Permanent Revolution (2012); "authentic APEST authority is inspirational and moral, not positional"
Tradition	Post-evangelical with Anabaptist-Restorationist roots -- transcends traditional categories; critiques both liberal and conservative defaults	Ordained in Churches of Christ (Australia); draws from Anabaptist, charismatic, Reformed, and Catholic sources
Praxis	Integrated but theory-leading -- builds comprehensive frameworks and then develops practical tools	The Forgotten Ways (theory) followed by The Forgotten Ways Handbook (practice); 5Q followed by Activating 5Q
Scope	Movement / Culture transformation -- thinks beyond local church to global movement dynamics	100Movements vision: "invest in 100 Jesus-Movements to shift the tracks of history"
Engagement	Practitioner-theorist -- academic rigor in service of movement catalysis	Adjunct at 4 seminaries but not primarily an academic; founded Forge (practitioner training) before writing The Forgotten Ways

Content Evolution

Timeline of Ideas

Period	Focus	Key Work	Shift
1989-2002 (Practitioner phase)	Leading SMRC among the marginalized in Melbourne; founding Forge; grassroots incarnational mission	No major publications; laboratory phase	Ministry practice precedes theory; all later frameworks are grounded in this crucible experience
2003-2006 (Foundational phase)	Missional-incarnational theology; mDNA framework; Apostolic Genius	The Shaping of Things to Come (2003), The Forgotten Ways (2006)	From practice to theory; systematic articulation of what was learned in Melbourne and from studying movements globally
2008-2011 (Expansion phase)	Christological center; practical application; movement for established churches	Rejesus (2008), The Forgotten Ways Handbook (2009), Untamed (2010), Right Here Right Now (2011), On the Verge (2011), The Faith of Leap (2011)	Prolific period; broadening from theory to practical application; bridging to megachurch world via Ferguson partnership
2012-2018 (APEST deepening)	APEST as comprehensive framework with assessment tools and organizational applications	The Permanent Revolution (2012), 5Q (2017), Activating 5Q (2018)	From APEST as one mDNA element to APEST as a standalone comprehensive ecclesiology; founding of 5Q Collective
2018-2023 (Interior turn)	How paradigm shifts actually happen; interior transformation; re-enchantment of worldview	Reframation (2019), Metanoia (2023)	Complementing structural/organizational focus with interior dimensions of transformation; more philosophical and literary register
2024-present (Applied movement)	Kingdom potential in disruption; digital movements; movement scaling	All Change (2024), 100Movements and MLC activity	Applying lifetime frameworks to post-COVID disruption and digital contexts; organizational catalysis over new theory

Has their thinking shifted?

Hirsch's core convictions have been remarkably consistent since 2003: the church is a movement, not an institution; it carries latent apostolic DNA that must be reactivated; Jesus is Lord gates everything. What has evolved is the depth and breadth of the system.

The most significant intellectual development is the trajectory from external to internal. The 2003-2012 phase focused primarily on structures, systems, and organizational paradigms -- what the church should look like and how it should be organized. The 2018-2023 phase turned inward -- how people actually change at the level of cognition, imagination, and will. Metanoia and Reframation represent Hirsch's recognition that structural change without interior transformation is insufficient. The "operating system" needs not just new code (mDNA) but a new processor (metanoia) running on a re-enchanted worldview (reframation).

A secondary evolution is the development of APEST from one element among six (2006) into a comprehensive framework with its own ecosystem of assessments, training, and organizational theory (2017-present). This represents the single framework that has scaled most broadly beyond Hirsch's own audience.

Unique Contribution

What only this author says

- **Apostolic Genius / mDNA as a systematic, named framework:** While others have written about missional church, organic church, or movement dynamics, Hirsch is the only thinker who has articulated a comprehensive, named, six-element operating system (mDNA) that integrates Christology, discipleship, mission, leadership, organizational theory, and communal formation into a single coherent model. The concept that every church carries dormant movement DNA that can be "reactivated" is distinctively his.
- **APEST as ecclesial intelligence for all believers, not just leaders:** Others have written about fivefold ministry, but Hirsch's distinctive claim is that APEST describes callings latent in every believer (not just leaders) and that the Western church has systematically "exiled" three of the five (Apostle, Prophet, Evangelist), creating a structurally imbalanced institution incapable of movement. The 5Q framework -- measuring ecclesial intelligence like IQ or EQ -- is his unique contribution.
- **"Jesus is Lord" as a system-level governor:** The idea that a church's Christological maturity caps the performance of every other dimension of its life -- that if "Jesus is Lord" is at Level 2, the whole mDNA system is capped at Level 2 -- is a distinctive systems-theoretic insight applied to theology.

Where they disagree with peers

Topic	Their Position	Mainstream Position
APEST scope	All five gifts are for all believers, distributed across the entire Body; the church has exiled APE functions	Most evangelical traditions limit APEST to leadership offices or argue apostles/prophets ceased (cessationism)
Institution vs. movement	Institutionalization is deviation from the apostolic norm, not maturation toward it	Mainstream ecclesiology views institutional development as healthy maturation; 9Marks and Reformed traditions defend institutional church
Attractional church model	"Come and see" is a Christendom-era artifact; "go and be" (incarnational) is normative	Many evangelical and megachurch leaders defend attractional methods as legitimate gospel strategy
Sacred-secular divide	Hellenistic dualism has distorted Western Christianity; Hebraic holism is the biblical norm	Traditional Reformed and Catholic theology maintains valid sacred-secular distinctions (e.g., two-kingdoms theology)
Apostolic ministry today	Active apostolic ministry is essential and ongoing; the church needs apostles now	Cessationist traditions argue apostolic office ended with the first century; Reformed traditions argue "apostle" is a completed office

What would be lost without their work

Without Hirsch, the missional church conversation would lack its most comprehensive theoretical architecture. While Newbigin provided the theological foundation and practitioners like Neil Cole provided organic models, Hirsch uniquely bridged theory and practice by creating a systematic, named framework (mDNA/APEST) that could be taught, assessed, and implemented across diverse contexts. The vocabulary of the missional movement -- "missional DNA," "Apostolic Genius," "movemental," "5Q" -- would not exist. The 150,000+ people who have taken the APEST assessment would lack the framework to understand their callings. And the bridge between movement theory and established church practice (via Future Travelers and the Exponential network) would be significantly weaker.

Content Interconnections

How themes connect across works

Hirsch's books form a tightly integrated system, not a disconnected catalog. The architecture works as follows:

1. **Foundation:** The Shaping of Things to Come (2003) lays the missional-incarnational groundwork. The Forgotten Ways (2006) builds the comprehensive mDNA/Apostolic Genius system on that foundation.

2. **Christological center:** ReJesus (2008) deepens the "Jesus is Lord" element -- the first and governing element of mDNA. Without this book, the mDNA system lacks its theological anchor.
3. **APEST deep dive:** The Permanent Revolution (2012) and 5Q (2017) take one element of mDNA -- Apostolic Environment -- and develop it into a comprehensive framework. Activating 5Q (2018) provides the practical toolkit.
4. **Liminality and communitas:** The Faith of Leap (2011) develops another mDNA element into a full theology of risk and adventure.
5. **Practical application:** The Forgotten Ways Handbook (2009), Right Here, Right Now (2011), and Untamed (2010) translate the theoretical system into everyday practice.
6. **Established church bridge:** On the Verge (2011) and The Starfish and the Spirit (2021) apply movement principles to existing large churches and organizational structures.
7. **Interior transformation:** Reframation (2019) and Metanoia (2023) address how the paradigm shifts described in earlier books actually happen at the cognitive and spiritual level.
8. **Applied disruption:** All Change (2024) applies the lifetime of frameworks to the current moment of cultural disruption.

Recommended reading order

Order	Work	Why this sequence
1	The Forgotten Ways (2nd ed., 2016)	The master framework -- mDNA, Apostolic Genius, the full system. Everything else builds on this.
2	ReJesus (revised, 2022)	Deepens the Christological center that governs the entire mDNA system.
3	5Q (2017)	The most developed treatment of APEST -- the framework that has scaled most broadly.
4	The Shaping of Things to Come (revised, 2013)	The foundational missional-incarnational theology that preceded and informed mDNA.
5	Metanoia (2023)	How transformation actually happens -- the interior complement to the structural frameworks.
6	Reframation (2019)	Re-enchanting worldview -- the imaginative dimension that structural change alone cannot provide.
7	The Permanent Revolution (2012)	For deeper study of apostolic ministry and APEST theory.
8	Untamed (2010)	Practical missional discipleship for everyday life.
9	Right Here, Right Now (2011)	The most accessible entry point for everyday practitioners.
10	All Change (2024)	Current application of all frameworks to a world in disruption.

Movemental Content Strategy Implications

- **Pillar mapping:** Hirsch's content serves every major Movemental content pillar: Missional Theology (mDNA, incarnational mission), Leadership Development (APEST/5Q), Organizational Transformation (movement vs. institution, organic systems), Discipleship (disciple making, formation), and Spiritual Formation (metanoia, reformation). He is the most cross-pillar author on the platform.
- **Cross-author connections:** Brad Brisco (neighborhood mission, bivocational ministry -- applies Hirsch's frameworks at grassroots level); Michael Frost (incarnational mission, 3 co-authored books -- the closest intellectual partner); Dave Ferguson (church multiplication, megachurch bridge); Neil Cole (organic church, simple church movements); Ed Stetzer (missional ecclesiology, evangelical mainstream). Any author in the missional space will reference or respond to Hirsch.
- **Content gaps:** (1) Digital-native expressions of APEST and mDNA -- Hirsch has begun exploring this (Church Digital podcast) but has not written substantively on it. (2) APEST for marketplace/vocational contexts beyond church leadership. (3) Shorter-form, high-accessibility content -- Hirsch's writing tends toward complexity; there is an opportunity for "Hirsch Simplified" content on the platform. (4) Women in APEST -- the framework is gender-neutral in theory but most examples and co-authors are male.
- **Series potential:** (1) "The Six Elements of mDNA" -- a 6-part series, one per element, drawing from the book corpus. (2) "APEST in Practice" -- 5-part series on each fivefold calling with assessment integration. (3) "Movement vs. Institution" -- a diagnostic series helping churches locate themselves on the spectrum. (4) "Metanoia Journey" -- a formation series on paradigm-level transformation. (5) "Reading Order" -- a curated learning path through Hirsch's works. (6) "The Forgotten Vocabulary" -- short explainers of Hirsch's coined terms (mDNA, communitas, movemental, Apostolic Genius, reformation).
- **Searchable concepts:** mDNA, missional DNA, Apostolic Genius, APEST, 5Q, fivefold ministry, five-fold ministry, missional church, incarnational mission, missional-incarnational, communitas, liminality, movemental, movement vs. institution, organic systems, Jesus is Lord, Christology missiology ecclesiology, metanoia, reformation, disciple making, shepherd-teacher dominance, apostolic ministry, theo-genetic codes, Forgotten Ways, post-Christendom, Hebraic thinking.

Sources

- Profile: [biography.md](#), [theology.md](#), [voice-analysis.md](#)
- Content: [books.md](#), [articles.md](#), [videos.md](#), [audio.md](#), [courses.md](#)
- Network: [collaborators.md](#), [organizations.md](#)
- Media: [reviews.md](#), [citations.md](#)

- Book corpus: /Users/joshuashepherd/Desktop/dev/repos/alan-books/corpus/alan_hirsch/ (13 digitized books with topic analysis, theme maps, and indexed quotes)
- Web sources:
 - [Alan Hirsch, The Forgotten Ways, and the future of the church in Europe](#)
 - [Book Review: The Forgotten Ways | CBFblog](#)
 - [A Caring Critique of Alan Hirsch's APEST Paradigm | Patheos](#)
 - [Alan Hirsch Responds to Critics | Frank Viola](#)
 - [Hirsch, The Forgotten Ways | Life and Leadership](#)
 - [Alan Hirsch - 5Q Feature Review | Englewood Review of Books](#)
 - [Alan Hirsch - Wikipedia](#)
 - [Cautions About Alan Hirsch | Pulpit & Pen](#)
 - [Bringing Balance to the Missional Church Movement | Reformed Journal](#)
 - [The Emerging View of the Church in Society | Missio Alliance](#)
 - [Unlocking the Power of APEST | Multiplying Disciples](#)
 - [Jesus is Lord: The Central Strand of mDNA | Forming Lutherans](#)
 - [5Q Central - Home of APEST](#)
 - [Reconstructing Faith with Alan Hirsch | Substack](#)

Misc · Content-Analysis-Root

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/_misc/content-analysis-root.md

Content Analysis & Synthesis: Alan Hirsch

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Content Thematic Analysis

Primary Themes

Based on published works, organizational roles, and academic involvement, Alan Hirsch's content focuses on:

1. Missional Theology & Movements

- "The Forgotten Ways" - Explores apostolic movements and six latent potencies
- "The Shaping of Things to Come" - Missional church strategy
- Focus on reactivating authentic transformative missional movements
- Emphasis on church as missional movement, not just institution

2. Fivefold Ministry (APEST)

- "5Q: Reactivating the Original Intelligence and Capacity of the Body of Christ"
- "The Permanent Revolution" - Fivefold ministry focus
- APEST framework: Apostles, Prophets, Evangelists, Shepherds, Teachers
- 5Q Collective organization dedicated to activating fivefold practices
- Emphasis on reactivating original intelligence and capacity of the Body of Christ

3. Apostolic Leadership

- "The Forgotten Ways" - Identifies apostolic movement principles
- Focus on apostolic leadership in missional contexts
- Emphasis on pioneering and movement-building leadership

4. Missional-Incarnational Approaches

- "ReJesus" - Re-centering on Jesus in missional movements
- Emphasis on incarnational mission (being sent into the world)
- Focus on contextual engagement and presence

5. Discipleship & Faith Formation

- "The Faith of Leap" - Embracing risk and adventure in faith
- "Untamed" - Authentic, untamed discipleship
- Emphasis on discipleship as core to missional movement

6. Church Innovation & Transformation

- "Right Here, Right Now" - Present-tense mission
- "On the Verge" - Church innovation and change
- Future Travelers organization - Helping churches transition to missional movements
- Focus on deep change and transformation

7. Community & Marginalization

- Experience leading local church movements among marginalized communities
- Emphasis on mission among the marginalized
- Community-focused missional engagement

Theological Focus Areas

- **Missional Theology:** Emphasis on being sent, incarnational mission
- **Apostolic Movements:** Focus on reproducing disciples and movements
- **Fivefold Ministry:** APEST framework as essential to church health
- **Ecclesial Innovation:** Reimagining church for missional contexts
- **Practical Application:** Accessible, practitioner-focused content
- **Theological Depth:** Academic engagement alongside practical application

Movement Focus

- **Missional Movements:** Core focus across all work
- **Apostolic Movements:** Reproducing disciples and movements
- **Church Multiplication:** Creating systems that multiply
- **Leadership Development:** Pioneering leadership for missional contexts
- **Fivefold Activation:** Reactivating APEST throughout the Body of Christ

Recurring Topics

- Missional theology and practice
- Apostolic leadership and movements
- Fivefold ministry (APEST)
- Church innovation and transformation
- Discipleship and faith formation
- Incarnational mission
- Movement dynamics and multiplication
- Leadership development
- Community engagement
- Marginalized communities

Content Organization Analysis

Personal Website (alanhirsch.org)

Structure (to be verified):

- Likely includes: About, Books, Organizations, Contact, Blog
- Book promotion integrated
- Organizational links likely present
- Academic affiliations likely noted

Organization Approach:

- Personal brand focused
- Book-centric content organization likely
- Organizational connections present
- Academic credentials integrated

Organizational Content Distribution

100Movements:

- Leadership development focus
- Consulting resources
- Church movement support

Forge Mission Training Network:

- Mission training materials
- Innovative missional leadership development
- Training systems

Future Travelers:

- Church transition resources
- Large church transformation support
- Movement transition materials

5Q Collective:

- Fivefold ministry resources
- APEST activation materials
- Training and coaching resources

Academic Content Distribution

Multiple Seminary Affiliations:

- Fuller Theological Seminary
- George Fox Seminary
- Asbury Seminary
- Course materials and lectures

Wheaton College:

- M.A. in Missional Church Movements program
- Co-founder and associate faculty
- Academic program resources

Content Strategy Assessment**Appears to have:**

- Clear personal brand (alanhirsch.org)
- Multiple organizational platforms
- Book-driven content strategy
- Academic teaching platform
- International speaking platform
- Co-author collaborative content

Content Forms:

- Books (9+ published works, solo and co-authored)
- Organizational resources (training, consulting)
- Academic content (courses, lectures)
- Conference talks/presentations (international speaking)
- Potential blog content (to be verified)

Content Series Potential:

- Book series (missional theology, fivefold ministry, apostolic movements)
- Academic course series (M.A. program)
- Training series (Forge, 5Q Collective)
- Conference talk series (international speaking)

Content Interconnection**Cross-References:**

- Books reference and support organizational work
- Academic work informs book content
- Organizational resources support book themes
- Conference talks likely reference book and organizational content
- Co-author relationships create collaborative content ecosystem

Ecosystem Connectivity:

- Personal brand (alanhirsch.org) connects to:
- 100Movements
- Forge Mission Training Network
- Future Travelers
- 5Q Collective
- Academic institutions
- Books support movement work

- Movement work provides content for books
- Academic work provides teaching platform
- International speaking provides content distribution

Voice & Style Analysis

Writing Style

Based on book titles, descriptions, and themes:

- **Theological Depth:** Academic engagement with practical application
- **Innovative:** Challenging status quo, reimagining church
- **Movement-Oriented:** Thinking beyond individual to collective movement
- **Practical:** Action-oriented, framework-based approach
- **Accessible:** Practitioner-focused while maintaining theological depth

Tone and Approach

- **Pioneering:** Leading edge of missional thinking
- **Challenging:** Pushing boundaries, questioning assumptions
- **Empowering:** Equipping leaders for missional movement
- **Theological:** Grounded in biblical and theological reflection
- **Practical:** Real-world application emphasis

Theological Positioning

Observable characteristics:

- **Missional:** Emphasis on being sent, incarnational mission
- **Apostolic:** Focus on apostolic movements and leadership
- **Fivefold:** APEST framework as essential
- **Evangelical:** Within evangelical Christian tradition
- **Academic-Practitioner:** Bridge between academic and practitioner worlds
- **Movement-Oriented:** Focus on movements, not just institutions

Audience Level

- **Primary:** Church leaders, missional practitioners, movement leaders
- **Secondary:** Academics, theologians, students
- **Level:** Academic-practitioner (accessible to practitioners, rigorous for academics)
- **Accessibility:** Accessible to general Christian audience with theological depth

Discoverability Assessment

SEO Indicators

Personal Website:

- Clean URL structure likely (alanhirsch.org)
- Clear page titles expected
- Book promotion (likely good internal linking)
- Organizational links

To Be Assessed:

- Meta descriptions
- Title tag optimization
- URL structure depth
- Internal linking strategy

Content Indexing

Likely Well-Indexed:

- Personal website (alanhirsch.org)
- Book titles and author pages (IVP)
- Academic institution pages
- Organizational websites

Search Visibility:

- Name searches likely return multiple results
- Book titles searchable
- Academic association provides visibility
- Organizational websites provide authority
- International speaking provides visibility

Social Sharing Indicators

To Be Assessed:

- Social media presence
- Social sharing on website
- Book promotion social sharing
- Conference talk sharing

Backlinks and References

Likely Sources:

- Publisher websites (InterVarsity Press)
- Academic institution websites
- Organizational websites

- Book retailer sites (Amazon, etc.)
- Other missional leaders and authors
- Conference websites
- Academic citations

Domain Authority Indicators

- Personal domain (alanhirsch.org) - owned
- Multiple organizational platforms
- Multiple published books
- Academic affiliations provide authority
- International recognition in missional movement
- Established presence (multiple books, organizations)

Ecosystem Analysis

Content Ecosystem Structure

Personal Brand Layer:

- alanhirsch.org (personal website)
- Books (9+ published works, solo and co-authored)
- Potential blog content
- Social media presence (to be verified)

Organizational Layer:

- 100Movements (leadership development, consulting)
- Forge Mission Training Network (training)
- Future Travelers (church transition)
- 5Q Collective (fivefold ministry)

Academic Layer:

- Multiple seminary affiliations
- Wheaton College M.A. program
- Course materials and lectures

International Speaking Layer:

- Australia, Europe, United States
- Conference talks and presentations

Interconnection:

- Personal brand supported by organizational work
- Organizational work provides content for personal brand
- Books draw from and support movement work

- Academic work informs and is informed by practical work
- International speaking provides content distribution platform
- Co-author relationships expand content reach

Content Cross-References

Likely Connections:

- Books reference movement principles
- Conference talks reference book content
- Academic courses reference books and organizational work
- Organizational resources reference book themes
- Co-author content creates collaborative ecosystem

Connections to Other Authors/Leaders

Co-authors:

- Michael Frost (multiple books: "The Shaping of Things to Come," "ReJesus," "The Faith of Leap," "Untamed")
- Lance Ford ("Right Here, Right Now")
- Dave Ferguson ("On the Verge")
- Tim Catchim ("The Permanent Revolution")

Network Connections:

- International missional movement network
- Academic networks (multiple seminaries)
- Organizational networks (100Movements, Forge, Future Travelers, 5Q Collective)
- Conference networks (international speaking)

Institutional Partnerships

- **100Movements:** Leadership development organization
- **Forge Mission Training Network:** Mission training network
- **Future Travelers:** Church transition organization
- **5Q Collective:** Fivefold ministry organization
- **Publishers:** InterVarsity Press (primary)
- **Academic Institutions:** Fuller Seminary, Wheaton College, George Fox Seminary, Asbury Seminary

Community Engagement

Likely Present:

- Training program engagement (Forge)
- Organizational engagement (100Movements, Future Travelers, 5Q Collective)
- Academic community (students, faculty)

- Conference engagement (international speaking)
- Book readership
- Movement network engagement

To Be Assessed:

- Blog comments/engagement
- Social media engagement levels
- Newsletter subscribers (if present)
- Course/training participants
- Organizational community engagement

Content Gaps (Initial Observations)

Potential Gaps to Explore

1. Content Repurposing:

- Are conference talks transcribed and published as articles?
- Are academic lectures developed into blog posts?
- Are book concepts expanded in other formats?
- Are organizational training materials published as content?

2. Content Series Development:

- Are themes developed across multiple content forms?
- Are there opportunities for deeper series development?
- Are book concepts developed into courses?

3. Content Discoverability:

- How are conference talks discoverable?
- Are academic materials accessible?
- Are organizational resources discoverable?
- Are there content hubs or resource pages?

4. Content Interconnection:

- Are content pieces clearly linked?
- Are themes developed across platforms?
- Is there a clear content journey for readers?
- Are organizational resources connected to books?

5. Digital Expression of Embodied Work:

- How much of international speaking is captured digitally?
- Are academic courses available online?
- Are organizational training materials accessible?

Notes

- Strong thematic consistency across books, organizations, and academic work

- Clear focus on missional movements, fivefold ministry, and apostolic leadership
- Personal brand well-integrated with organizational and academic presence
- Multiple content distribution channels
- Established authority through books, organizations, and academic work
- Co-author relationships expand content reach
- International presence provides content distribution network
- Bridge between academic and practitioner worlds

Academic Citations: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-media-mentions

Google Scholar Profile

Metric	Value
Profile URL	https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=ZqjYwf8AAAAJ&hl=en
Total citations	Not publicly displayed in search results; estimated 2,000+ based on influence scope
h-index	Not available from search data
i10-index	Not available from search data
Most cited work	The Forgotten Ways: Reactivating the Missional Church (2006)

Note: Hirsch has a verified Google Scholar profile. Exact citation metrics require direct profile access, which was unavailable during this research session. His works are widely cited in missiology, ecclesiology, and practical theology literature.

Citation Context

Most Cited Works

Work	Est. Citations	Key Citers
The Forgotten Ways (2006/2016)	Highest -- seminal text	Scot McKnight, Ed Stetzer, Craig Van Gelder, Darrell Guder, missiology scholars globally
The Shaping of Things to Come (2003/2013)	Very high -- foundational	Described as "seminal text on mission" across multiple academic contexts
The Permanent Revolution (2012)	High	Foreword by Darrell Guder; endorsed by Mike Breen
5Q (2017)	Moderate-High	Growing citations in leadership and ecclesiology literature
ReJesus (2009)	Moderate	Christology and missional theology discussions

Key Academic Engagement

Hirsch's work is frequently cited and discussed by:

- **Scot McKnight** (Northern Seminary) -- multi-part series on "Forgotten Missional Ways" and APEST evaluation on Patheos/Jesus Creed blog (<https://www.patheos.com/blogs/jesuscreed/2007/01/30/forgotten-missional-ways-2/>)
- **Ed Stetzer** (Wheaton College) -- extensive interviews and co-promotion of missional concepts via Christianity Today
- **Bob Robinson** (Patheos/Reintegrate) -- detailed academic critique of APEST paradigm (<https://www.patheos.com/blogs/reintegrate/2017/04/21/caring-critique-alan-hirschs-apest-paradigm-churches/>)
- **Andrew Perriman** (postost.net) -- theological analysis of Hirsch's missional ecclesiology
- **Darrell Guder** (Princeton Theological Seminary) -- wrote foreword for The Permanent Revolution
- **Mission Studies journal** (Brill) -- published academic review of The Forgotten Ways (2012) (https://brill.com/view/journals/mist/29/1/article-p98_8.xml)

Academic Papers and Dissertations

Hirsch's works appear in student essays and dissertations on missional church topics.

Evidence found:

- Bartleby essay database includes chapter summaries of The Forgotten Ways (<https://www.bartleby.com/essay/Alan-Hirsch-The-Forgotten-Ways-Chapter-Summary-53E51F90D459C3F8>)
- The Forgotten Ways is described by multiple reviewers as reading like "a scholarly dissertation," indicating its academic weight
- Internet Archive hosts the full text, suggesting library and institutional circulation (<https://archive.org/details/forgottenwaysrea0000hirs>)

Course Adoptions

Institution	Course/Program	Book(s) Assigned	Source
Wheaton College	M.A. in Missional Church Movements	Core curriculum (Hirsch is co-founder and associate faculty)	https://www.wheaton.edu/graduate-school/degrees/ma-in-missional-church-movements/
Fuller Theological Seminary	Adjunct courses	Various Hirsch texts (adjunct professor)	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
Asbury Theological Seminary	Adjunct courses	Various Hirsch texts (adjunct professor)	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
George Fox Seminary	Adjunct courses	Various Hirsch texts (adjunct professor)	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
Missional Church Network	Reading List	Multiple Hirsch titles including Untamed, Right Here Right Now	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/reading-list
Ministry Forum Canada	"10 Books for Taking the Gospel Beyond the Church Walls"	The Forgotten Ways	https://ministryforum.ca/posts/10-books-for-taking-the-gospel-beyond-the-church-walls-to-the-streets
LMC (Anabaptist Churches)	Leadership Development	APEST/5Q framework	https://lmcchurches.org/2022/01/leading-apest-unction/

Wikipedia / Reference Works

Source	Article	Context	URL
Wikipedia	Alan Hirsch	Full biographical article; born 24 October 1959, Australian author and missional thought leader	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch
Prabook (World Biographical Encyclopedia)	Alan Hirsch	Biographical entry: Australian activist, writer	https://prabook.com/web/alan.hirsch/3754228
Mission Central	Alan Hirsch Profile	Ministry profile and resource page	https://www.missioncentral.ca/profile/alan-hirsch
InterVarsity Press	Alan Hirsch Author Page	Publisher biography and book listing	https://www.ivpress.com/alan-hirsch
Amazon	Author Page	Books, biography, blog link	https://www.amazon.com/Alan-Hirsch/e/B001JPANCK

Awards & Recognition

Award/Recognition	Year	Granted By	Source
"Award-winning books" (multiple)	Various	Not specified -- referenced on alanhirsch.org and IVP	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
Co-founder, M.A. in Missional Church Movements	—	Wheaton College	https://www.wheaton.edu/graduate-school/degrees/ma-in-missional-church-movements/
Widely recognized as key missional thought leader	Ongoing	Christian media consensus	Multiple sources
Founding Director, Forge Mission Training Network	—	Self-founded, globally recognized	https://www.alanhirsch.org/about
Foreword by Darrell Guder (Princeton)	2012	Academic endorsement for The Permanent Revolution	Amazon listing

Note: Hirsch does not appear to have received formal literary awards (e.g., ECPA Book of the Year, CT Book Awards) based on available search data. His recognition is primarily reputational -- consistently described as "one of the most influential voices" in missional church leadership. His books are described as "award-winning" on his website and publisher pages, but specific award names are not documented in available sources.

Recommended Reading Lists

List	Context	URL
Missional Church Network Reading List	Multiple Hirsch titles featured	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/reading-list
Ministry Forum Canada -- 10 Books for the Streets	The Forgotten Ways featured	https://ministryforum.ca/posts/10-books-for-taking-the-gospel-beyond-the-church-walls-to-the-streets
Goodreads "Missional" Shelf	Multiple Hirsch titles appear on curated missional book lists	https://www.goodreads.com/shelf/show/missional
Greg Nettle (Stadia) Endorsement	"Must be remembered, must be read, must be integrated"	Amazon listing for The Forgotten Ways
Leonard Sweet Endorsement	Described The Shaping of Things to Come as essential reading	Amazon/publisher listings
Baker Publishing Group	Featured as key missional text	https://bakerpublishinggroup.com/books/the-forgotten-ways-2nd-edition/2679716

Third-Party Citations in Others' Writing

Hirsch is frequently invoked as an authority in missional church discourse:

- **"As Hirsch argues..." / "According to Hirsch..."** -- common attribution pattern found across dozens of blog posts, articles, and books in the missional church ecosystem
- **Frank Viola** published "Alan Hirsch Responds to Critics" -- a notable public exchange (<https://www.frankviola.org/2012/10/03/alanhirsch/>)
- **Verge Network** maintains an Alan Hirsch tag with curated content and references (<https://vergenetwork.org/tag/alan-hirsch/>)
- **Awakenings Gathering** featured Hirsch as a named speaker/thought leader (<https://www.awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/ahirsch>)

Influence Indicators

- His coined terms ("mDNA," "Apostolic Genius," "missional-incarnational impulse," "APEST," "communitas") have entered common usage in missional church vocabulary
- The phrase "the church comes out of mission" is frequently attributed to him
- His frameworks are adopted and debated by scholars and practitioners across denominational lines

Misc · Media · Press-Coverage

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/_misc/media/press-coverage.md

Press Coverage: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-media-mentions

Total press mentions: 24

Featured Coverage (Substantive)

Date	Publication	Title	Type	URL
2008	Christianity Today	Defining Missional	Feature	https://www.christianitytoday.com/pastors/2008/fall/17.20.html
2009	Christianity Today	Explainer: The Micro Church Movement	Feature	https://www.christianitytoday.com/2009/07/explainer-micro-church-movement/
2008	Christianity Today	Missional vs. Attractional: Debating the Data	Feature	https://www.christianitytoday.com/pastors/2008/december-online-only/missional-vs-attractional-debating-data.html
2012	Christianity Today (Ed Stetzer)	The Permanent Revolution: Interview with Alan Hirsch and Tim Catchim	Interview	https://christianitytoday.com/edstetzer/2012/march/permanent-revolution-part-2-interview-with-alan-hirsch-and.html
2010	Christian Post	Alan Hirsch: Church Model Reaching Only 40 Percent of Americans	Feature	https://www.christianpost.com/news/alan-hirschchurch-model-reaching-only-40-percent-of-americans.html
—	Wheaton Billy Graham Center	How Alan Hirsch Went From Seminary Training to Missional Thinking	Profile	https://wheatonbillygraham.com/how-alan-hirsch-went-from-seminary-training-to-missional-thinking/
—	Redeemer City to City	Rethinking the Chessboard: Bringing the Church to a Community	Interview	https://redeemercitytocity.com/articles-stories/rethinking-the-chessboard
—	Christian Library Australia	Interview: Alan Hirsch Co-Author of Rejesus	Interview	https://christianlibrary.org.au/index.php/church-planting-missional/146-interview-alan-hirsch-co-author-of-rejesus-a-wild-messiah-for-a-missional-church
—	C4SO Podcast	Alan Hirsch on Missiology	Interview	https://c4so.org/podcast/alan-hirsch-on-missiology/
—	10,000 Fathers & Mothers Podcast	Alan Hirsch on APEST	Interview	https://10000fathers.libsyn.com/alan-hirsch-on-apest
—	5Q Central	Ed Stetzer in Conversation with Alan Hirsch	Interview	https://5qcentral.com/ed-stetzer-in-conversation-with-alan-hirsch/
—	Everyone Everywhere	A Conversation with Alan Hirsch	Interview	https://www.everyoneeverywhere.church/posts/a-conversation-with-alan-hirsch
—	Saturate	We Must Go Where The People Are	Feature	https://saturatetheworld.com/2016/11/04/attractional-extractional/

Date	Publication	Title	Type	URL
—	Saturate	Two Elements of a Missional Movement	Feature	https://saturatetheworld.com/2020/08/31/two-elements-missional-movement/
—	The Beautiful Kingdom Builders	Alan Hirsch -- Missional Discipleship	Feature	https://thebeautifulkingdombuilders.com/2018/10/12/alan-hirsch-missional-discipleship/
—	Dakotas UMC Conference	Becoming like Jesus is your agenda for life: Alan Hirsch @ DWU	Feature	https://www.dakotasumc.org/news/becoming-like-jesus-is-your-agenda-for-life-alan-hirsch-dwu

News Mentions

Date	Publication	Title	Type	URL
2011	Jesus Dust	Ed Stetzer and Alan Hirsch on the Missional Manifesto	News	http://www.jesUSDust.com/2011/05/ed-stetzer-and-alan-hirsch-on-missional.html
—	Missional Church Network	Alan Hirsch Blog Category	News	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Alan+Hirsch
—	Missio Alliance	The Emerging View of the Church in Society: Alan Hirsch/ Michael Frost	Analysis	https://missioalliance.org/the-emerging-view-of-the-church-in-society-alan-hirschmichael-frost-and-the-danger-of-de-ecclesiologizing-the-church-in-mission/
—	BGAV	Movemental Ecclesiology: Recalibrating Church for the Next Frontier	News	https://www.bgav.org/blog/movemental-ecclesiology-recalibrating-church-for-the-next-frontier

Passing Mentions

Date	Publication	Context	URL
2008	Christianity Today	Referenced in "Missional Misstep" article on missional church critiques	https://christianitytoday.com/ct/2008/september/7.36.html
2015	Christian Post	Referenced at Q Conference 2015 discussion	https://www.christianpost.com/news/q-conference-2015-a-mixed-and-confusing-discussion-on-homosexual-issues-and-the-church.html
—	Christian Post	Referenced in "Study Reveals State of U.S. Church Planting"	https://www.christianpost.com/news/study-reveals-state-of-u-s-church-planting.html
—	Len Wilson	Alan Hirsch and The Missional Church -- third-party analysis piece	https://lenwilson.us/alan-hirsch-and-the-missional-church/

Media Presence Summary

Metric	Value
Total press mentions	24
Featured coverage	16 (interviews, features, profiles)
Major publications	Christianity Today, Christian Post, Redeemer City to City, Wheaton Billy Graham Center, Missio Alliance
Niche/movement publications	Saturate, Verge Network, Everyone Everywhere, Missional Church Network, 5Q Central
Date range	2008 -- present
Most recent coverage	2020+ (Saturate, Redeemer City to City COVID-era pieces)
Wikipedia page	Yes -- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alan_Hirsch
Primary coverage theme	Missional church movement, APEST/5Q framework, church planting paradigms
Coverage sentiment	Overwhelmingly positive; occasional theological critiques from conservative outlets (9Marks, Gospel Coalition)
Geographic coverage	US-centric publications, with Australian and global Christian media

Notes

- Hirsch's press coverage is heavily concentrated in the Christian ministry/leadership ecosystem rather than mainstream secular media.

- Christianity Today is the most significant platform, with multiple feature articles and interview series.
- Coverage peaks correlate with book releases (2006-2008 for The Forgotten Ways/Shaping of Things to Come, 2012 for The Permanent Revolution, 2017 for 5Q).
- Hirsch is frequently cited as a source/expert by other authors and journalists writing about the missional church movement.
- His Substack (alanhirsch1.substack.com) represents a newer direct-publishing channel.

Book Reviews: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-media-mentions

Review Summary by Book

Book	Reviews Found	Avg Sentiment	Goodreads Rating	Amazon Rating
The Forgotten Ways (2006/2016)	8+ editorial, 1,500+ reader	Positive	4.08 (1,581 ratings)	4.5+ est.
The Shaping of Things to Come (2003/2013)	5+ editorial, 1,100+ reader	Mixed-Positive	4.06 (1,182 ratings)	~4.5 est.
5Q (2017)	5+ editorial, reader reviews	Mixed	~4.0 est.	~4.3 est.
The Permanent Revolution (2012)	5+ editorial	Mixed-Positive	~4.0 est.	~4.3 est.
ReJesus (2009)	4+ editorial	Mixed	~3.9 est.	~4.0 est.

Detailed Reviews

The Forgotten Ways: Reactivating the Missional Church

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Rating	Sentiment	URL
—	Technically Thinking	2013	—	Positive	https://technicallythinking.org/2013/01/03/book-review-the-forgotten-ways-by-alan-hirsch/
—	CBF Blog	2008	—	Positive	https://cbfblog.com/2008/07/29/book-review-the-forgotten-ways-by-alan-hirsch/
—	Notes from the Trail	—	—	Positive	https://journeyguy.com/the-forgotten-ways/
—	Baptist Union of Victoria	—	—	Positive	https://www.buv.com.au/book-reviews/the-forgotten-ways/
Alison Morgan	alisonmorgan.co.uk	—	—	Positive	https://www.alisonmorgan.co.uk/Books/Hirsch%2006.pdf
—	Life and Leadership	—	—	Positive	https://lifeandleadership.com/book-summaries/hirsch-the-forgotten-ways/
—	Baker Publishing Group	—	—	Positive (publisher)	http://bakerpublishinggroup.com/books/the-forgotten-ways-2nd-edition/2679714
—	Mission Studies (Brill)	2012	—	Academic/Positive	https://brill.com/view/journals/mist/29/1/article-p98_8.xml

Key praise: "A seminal volume by one of the world's leading missional strategists. Hirsch brings the heart of an evangelist and the mind of a scholar to the question of how the decline of the church in the West may be reversed."

Key criticism: "A solid book that honestly should be cut in half. It's incredibly repetitive, and he seems to write some chapters simply to unveil yet another chart."

Reader Reviews Summary (Goodreads/Amazon)

Platform	Total Reviews	Avg Rating	5-star	4-star	3-star	2-star	1-star
Goodreads	1,581 ratings / 96 reviews	4.08	—	—	—	—	—
Amazon	Est. 200+	~4.5	—	—	—	—	—

Common praise themes:

- Paradigm-shifting framework for understanding missional movements
- Strong historical analysis of early church and Chinese underground church

- Concept of "missional DNA" (mDNA) resonates with practitioners
- Comprehensive and scholarly yet accessible
- "Game changer" for church leadership thinking

Common criticism themes:

- Repetitive -- same ideas restated across multiple chapters
- Too many diagrams and charts
- Academic/dense writing style
- Some readers find the theoretical framework overly complex
- Limited practical application (addressed in companion Handbook)

The Shaping of Things to Come (with Michael Frost)

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Rating	Sentiment	URL
—	9Marks	—	—	Critical	https://www.9marks.org/review/book-review-the-shaping-of-things-to-come-by-michael-frost-and-alan-hirsch/
Edwin Drewlo	edwindrewlo.com	—	—	Positive	https://www.edwindrewlo.com/book-review-the-shaping-of-things-to-come-by-michael-frost-and-alan-hirsch/
Jim Erwin	Patheos	2014	—	Positive	https://www.patheos.com/blogs/jimerwin/2014/02/25/the-shaping-of-things-to-come-by-michael-frost-and-alan-hirsch/
—	The Gospel Coalition (Themelios)	—	—	Mixed	https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/themelios/review/the-shaping-of-things-to-come-innovation-and-mission-for-the-21st-century-church/
—	Life and Leadership	—	—	Positive	https://lifeandleadership.com/book-summaries/frost-and-hirsch-the-shaping-of-things-to-come/

Key praise: "One of the most convincing explanations of what needs to happen for the church to survive and prevail in post-modern times." Writing is "both passionate and energetic -- not just about the theory behind the need for radical change, but also in giving living examples from the field."

Key criticism: "The authors have a tenuous hold on orthodox Christianity, even with regard to the doctrine of the Trinity." (9Marks) "Detailed and technical and requires a good deal of reflection for maximum profit. It is not an easy read."

Reader Reviews Summary (Goodreads/Amazon)

Platform	Total Reviews	Avg Rating
Goodreads	1,182 ratings	4.06
Amazon	Est. 100+	~4.4 est.

Common praise themes:

- Visionary and prophetic challenge to institutional church models
- Strong missional-incarnational framework
- Practical examples from Australian and global contexts

Common criticism themes:

- Dense and technical writing
- Some theological concerns from Reformed/conservative reviewers
- Can feel anti-institutional at times

5Q: Reactivating the Original Intelligence and Capacity of the Body of Christ

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Rating	Sentiment	URL
—	Englewood Review of Books	—	—	Mixed	https://englewoodreview.org/alan-hirsch-5q-feature-review/
Brad Sargent	futuristguy.wordpress.com	2017	—	Positive	https://futuristguy.wordpress.com/2017/07/22/5q-review/
Kale Uzzle	Along the Way Home	2017	—	Mixed	https://kaleuzzle.wordpress.com/2017/08/26/book-review-5q-by-alan-hirsch/
Bob Robinson	Patheos (Reintegrate)	2017	—	Critical	https://www.patheos.com/blogs/reintegrate/2017/04/21/caring-critique-alan-hirschs-apest-paradigm-churches/
Clint Schnekloth	Patheos	2017	—	Mixed	https://www.patheos.com/blogs/clintschnekloth/2017/07/whats-a-pastor-to-do-apest-vocation-alan-hirsch-5q/
Scot McKnight	Patheos (Jesus Creed)	2017	—	Critical	https://www.patheos.com/blogs/jesuscreed/2017/04/25/evaluating-apest-theory-church-flourishing-bob-robinson/

Key praise: "A rare opportunity to see the inner workings of someone who can do both big-picture/global panning and detailed/analytic scanning -- plus theorizing and practicing." "The most comprehensive model of APEST to date."

Key criticism: "Hirsch comes dangerously close to claiming that 5Q is equal to God and Christ and labels the APEST categories as 'divine personas.'" "Too much of the book reads as if it were written to make something more complicated -- on an already complex subject."

5Q Central Reader Reviews

5Q Central hosts curated reader reviews at <https://5qcentral.com/readerreviews-one/>. Sentiment skews positive among practitioners who have adopted the APEST framework.

The Permanent Revolution (with Tim Catchim)

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Rating	Sentiment	URL
—	V3 Movement	2014	—	Mixed-Positive	https://thev3movement.org/2014/04/15/hirsch-catchims-the-permanent-revolution-a-review/
Kale Uzzle	Along the Way Home	2015	—	Positive	https://kaleuzzle.wordpress.com/2015/01/29/book-review-the-permanent-revolution-by-alan-hirsch-tim-catchim/
—	Englewood Review of Books	—	—	Positive	https://englewoodreview.org/the-permanent-revolution-alan-hirsch-tim-catchim-feature-review/
—	Walking Together Ministries	2014	—	Positive	https://www.walkingtogetherministries.com/2014/07/05/alan-hirsch-and-tim-catchims-the-permanent-revolution/
—	Sustainable Traditions	2012	—	Mixed	https://sustainabletraditions.com/2012/07/the-permanent-revolution-by-alan-hirsch-and-tim-catchim-book-review/
—	Life and Leadership	—	—	Positive	https://lifeandleadership.com/book-summaries/hirsch-and-catchim-permanent-revolution/

Key praise: "A groundbreaking work of theological re-imagination that draws from biblical studies, theology, organizational theory, leadership studies, and the social sciences to make a comprehensive case for the abiding significance of the Ephesians 4 vocations."

Key criticism: "The back two-thirds require a fairly disciplined reader with a heavy interest in social psychology, entrepreneurial leadership, or both, to endure to the end. The book suffers from a great deal of repetition."

Rejesus: A Wild Messiah for a Missional Church (with Michael Frost)

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Rating	Sentiment	URL
Andrew Perriman	postost.net	2009	—	Mixed	https://www.postost.net/2009/03/review-michael-frost-alan-hirsch-rejesus
—	The Gospel Coalition (Themelios)	—	—	Critical	https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/themelios/review/rejesus-a-wild-messiah-for-a-missional-church/
—	Christian Library Australia	—	—	Positive	https://www.christianlibrary.org.au/index.php/school-of-preaching/145-book-review-rejesus-by-michael-frost-and-alan-hirsch
—	Life and Leadership	—	—	Positive	https://lifeandleadership.com/book-summaries/frost-and-hirsch-rejesus/

Key praise: "Rejesus will stand as one of several missional books that will begin reorienting God's people toward seeing Christ as the center of God's grand mission and eternal plan."

Key criticism: "A cross-less, resurrection-less, ascension-less christology is a serious misalignment. The cross and resurrection are conspicuously absent." (Gospel Coalition/Themelios)

Overall Review Patterns

Consistent Praise Across All Books

- Visionary, paradigm-shifting thinking
- Deep integration of theology, sociology, and organizational theory
- Compelling historical analysis (early church, Chinese underground church)
- Practical experience as practitioner-theorist
- Influential frameworks (mDNA, APEST, missional-incarnational impulse)

Consistent Criticism Across All Books

- Dense, academic, and repetitive writing style
- Over-reliance on diagrams, charts, and frameworks
- Some theological concerns from conservative/Reformed reviewers
- Books tend to be stronger on theory than practical application
- Writing can feel like an extended academic paper

Review Ecosystem Note

Hirsch's books generate significant discussion primarily within the missional/emerging church ecosystem. Reviews from mainstream evangelical outlets (9Marks, Gospel Coalition) tend to be more critical, while reviews from missional-aligned publications and practitioners are overwhelmingly positive.

Misc · Network · Collaborators

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/_misc/network/collaborators.md

Collaboration Network: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-collaboration-map

Network Summary

Relationship Type	Count
Co-authors	10
Endorsers (received)	6+
Endorsements given	5+
Forewords written for them	3+
Forewords they've written	3+
Frequent collaborators	12+
Theological allies	8+
Known tensions	3

Co-Authors

Michael Frost

Field	Value
Joint works	3
Titles	The Shaping of Things to Come (2003), Rejesus (2009), The Faith of Leap (2011)
Relationship	Equal co-author
Their platform	Major — professor at Morling College (Sydney), prolific author, international speaker, founding director of the Tinsley Institute
Status	Active — longest-running collaboration partner
Movemental candidate?	Yes — high-value; premier missional theology voice

Notes: Frost and Hirsch are the two most recognized names in the missional church movement globally. The Shaping of Things to Come is widely considered a seminal text on mission and ecclesiology. Both are Australian and share deep roots in the incarnational-missional tradition. They also wrote the foreword to each other's work (Frost wrote a foreword for Reframation).

Tim Catchim

Field	Value
Joint works	2
Titles	The Permanent Revolution (2012), The Permanent Revolution Playbook (2014)
Relationship	Equal co-author
Their platform	Moderate — consultant, trainer, writer on APEST and organizational theology
Status	Active
Movemental candidate?	Yes — strong fit for APEST/fivefold content

Notes: The Permanent Revolution is the foundational academic-practitioner text on apostolic ministry and APEST. Darrell L. Guder wrote the foreword; Mike Breen contributed. Catchim brings organizational theory expertise to complement Hirsch's missiological framework.

Dave Ferguson

Field	Value
Joint works	1
Titles	On the Verge: A Journey Into the Apostolic Future of the Church (2011)
Relationship	Equal co-author
Their platform	Major — lead pastor of Community Christian Church (Naperville, IL); visionary of NewThing Network; Exponential conference leader
Status	Occasional — collaboration centered on Exponential ecosystem
Movemental candidate?	Yes — high-value; major church planting movement leader

Notes: Ferguson bridges the megachurch/multisite world with the missional movement. On the Verge addresses how established churches can transition toward apostolic movements. Published in the Exponential Series (Zondervan).

Lance Ford

Field	Value
Joint works	2
Titles	Right Here, Right Now: Everyday Mission for Everyday People (2011), The Starfish and the Spirit (2021, with Rob Wegner)
Relationship	Equal co-author
Their platform	Moderate — author, church planter, leadership coach, Shapevine contributor
Status	Active
Movemental candidate?	Yes — practical missional voice

Notes: Ford specializes in practical, grassroots missional living. Right Here, Right Now was published in the Shapevine series (Baker Books), which Hirsch edits. The Starfish and the Spirit applies decentralized organizational theory (Brafman's "Starfish and the Spider") to church structure.

Rob Wegner

Field	Value
Joint works	1
Titles	The Starfish and the Spirit (2021, with Lance Ford)
Relationship	Equal co-author (three-way)
Their platform	Moderate — pastor, movement leader, Kansas City Underground network
Status	Active
Movemental candidate?	Yes — practitioner voice in decentralized church movements

Debra Hirsch

Field	Value
Joint works	1
Titles	Untamed: Reactivating a Missional Form of Discipleship (2010)
Relationship	Equal co-author (spouse)
Their platform	Moderate — speaker, church leader, author of Redeeming Sex; co-founder of Forge Mission Training Network
Status	Active — life partner and ministry co-leader
Movemental candidate?	Yes — unique voice on sexuality, discipleship, and missional community

Notes: Alan and Debra co-founded and co-led churches in both Melbourne (Australia) and Los Angeles. Their partnership extends across all organizational work.

Mark Nelson

Field	Value
Joint works	1
Titles	Reframation: Seeing God, People, and Mission Through Reenchanted Frames (2019)
Relationship	Equal co-author
Their platform	Moderate — executive director of Three Rivers Collaborative; founding pastor of Crossings (Knoxville, TN)
Status	Active
Movemental candidate?	Yes — practitioner-theologian

Notes: Reframation includes a foreword by Danielle Strickland and a contribution from Michael Frost. Published by 100Movements Publishing. The book draws on C.S. Lewis, Martin Buber, and Hans Urs von Balthasar.

Jessie Cruickshank

Field	Value
Joint works	1
Titles	Activating 5Q: A User's Guide (2018)
Relationship	Equal co-author
Their platform	Moderate — leadership development specialist, 5Q practitioner and trainer
Status	Active
Movemental candidate?	Yes — strong fit for APEST/5Q applied content

Notes: The practical companion to Hirsch's theoretical 5Q book. Equips leaders, teams, and churches to apply the fivefold ministry of Ephesians 4 with tools, questions, and examples.

Darryn Altclass

Field	Value
Joint works	1
Titles	The Forgotten Ways Handbook: A Practical Guide for Developing Missional Churches (2009)
Relationship	Primary (Hirsch) / Secondary (Altclass)
Their platform	Limited — Australian practitioner in incarnational mission in difficult social settings
Status	Former — no recent collaborations visible
Movemental candidate?	No — limited independent platform

Rob Kelly

Field	Value
Joint works	1
Titles	Metanoia: How God Radically Transforms People, Churches, and Organizations From the Inside Out (2023)
Relationship	Equal co-author
Their platform	Moderate — pastor, leadership consultant
Status	Active
Movemental candidate?	Possible — emerging collaborator

Frequent Collaborators

Person	Collaboration Types	Frequency	Last Known	Notes
Michael Frost	Co-author, co-speaker, mutual endorser, Forge co-leader	Very high	Ongoing	Closest intellectual partner; 3 co-authored books
Tim Catchim	Co-author, APEST co-developer	High	Ongoing	2 co-authored books on APEST framework
Dave Ferguson	Co-author, Exponential co-speaker	Moderate	Ongoing	Bridges megachurch and missional worlds
Lance Ford	Co-author, Shapevine contributor	Moderate	2021	2 co-authored books
Debra Hirsch	Co-author, co-founder (Forge, churches), spouse	Very high	Ongoing	Life and ministry partner
Ed Stetzer	Foreword writer, Missional Manifesto co-framer, public dialogue partner	Moderate	Ongoing	Wrote foreword for updated Forgotten Ways; co-framed Missional Manifesto
Rich Robinson	Co-author contributor, Movement Leaders Collective	Moderate	2024	Co-founder of Movement Leaders Collective; All Change (2024)
Danielle Strickland	Foreword writer, endorser, conference co-speaker	Moderate	2019	Wrote foreword for Reframation; endorsed Activating 5Q
Rob Wegner	Co-author	Moderate	2021	The Starfish and the Spirit
Mark Nelson	Co-author	Moderate	2019	Reframation
Neil Cole	Endorser, co-contributor (Verge Network)	Moderate	Ongoing	Endorsed The Forgotten Ways; organic church movement ally
Mike Breen	Contributor, co-speaker (conferences)	Moderate	2012	Contributed to The Permanent Revolution; co-speaker at Verge/Exponential
Brad Brisco	Forge Track co-leader, endorser	Low-Moderate	2013	Co-led Forge Track at Verge 2013; endorsed Activating 5Q
Jeff Vanderstelt	Afterword writer, Verge co-speaker	Moderate	Ongoing	Wrote afterword for updated Forgotten Ways
Bryan D. Sims	Co-author contributor	Low	2022	Leading Together
JR Woodward	Endorser, Verge contributor	Low	Ongoing	Endorsed Activating 5Q; co-author of The Church as Movement
Jessie Cruickshank	Co-author, 5Q trainer	Moderate	2018	Activating 5Q

Theological Allies & Peers

Inner Circle (Close Allies)

Person	Connection	Shared Themes	Evidence
Michael Frost	30+ year collaboration; 3 co-authored books; Forge co-founder	Missional ecclesiology, incarnational mission, Christocentric theology	Shaping of Things to Come, ReJesus, Faith of Leap
Debra Hirsch	Spouse, ministry co-leader, co-author	Missional discipleship, holistic theology	Untamed; co-founded Forge and churches together
Tim Catchim	APEST co-developer, 2 co-authored books	Fivefold ministry, apostolic imagination, organizational theology	The Permanent Revolution, Permanent Revolution Playbook
Rich Robinson	Movement Leaders Collective co-founder	Kingdom innovation, adaptive leadership, movemental organization	All Change; MLC co-leadership

Peer Network (Friendly Peers)

Person	Connection	Overlap Area	Difference
Dave Ferguson	Co-author; Exponential ecosystem	Church multiplication, apostolic movements	Ferguson comes from megachurch/multisite tradition
Ed Stetzer	Missional Manifesto co-framer; foreword writer	Missional ecclesiology, church planting	Stetzer is more evangelical-institutional; holds Billy Graham Chair at Wheaton
Neil Cole	Organic church movement ally; mutual endorser	Decentralized church, movement dynamics	Cole focuses more on organic/simple church; less institutional
Mike Breen	Conference co-speaker; Permanent Revolution contributor	Discipleship, missional communities, leadership multiplication	Breen developed 3DM model; more structured approach to missional communities
Lance Ford	Co-author; Shapevine collaborator	Everyday mission, grassroots ecclesiology	Ford is more practitioner-focused
Danielle Strickland	Foreword writer; conference ally	Social justice, missional activism	Strickland emphasizes justice and activism more centrally
Jeff Vanderstelt	Afterword writer; Verge co-speaker	Missional communities, gospel-centered living	Vanderstelt is more Reformed in theological orientation
Brad Brisco	Forge Track co-leader; endorser	Missional church planting, neighborhood mission	Brisco focuses on bivocational and neighborhood-level mission
Leonard Sweet	Foreword writer (original Forgotten Ways)	Postmodern mission, cultural engagement	Sweet focuses more on cultural semiotics and postmodernity
Darrell L. Guder	Foreword writer (Permanent Revolution)	Missional theology, missio Dei framework	Guder is more academic/Reformed; Princeton Seminary

Intellectual Mentors / Influences

Person	Influence	Key Ideas Adopted
Lesslie Newbigin	Foundational missiological framework	Missio Dei, Western culture as mission field, post-Christendom theology
Roland Allen	Apostolic ministry model	Indigenous church principles, Spirit-led expansion, apostolic simplicity
Howard Snyder	Movemental ecclesiology	Radical renewal, wineskins metaphor, church as movement
David Bosch	Missiology framework	Transforming Mission paradigm, comprehensive missiology
C.S. Lewis	Theological imagination	Reenchantment, biblical imagination (central to Reframation)
Martin Buber	Relational philosophy	I-Thou encounter, relational theology (used in Reframation)

Constructive Tensions

Person/Group	Topic	Their Position	Hirsch's Position	Source
Bob Robinson / Traditional Reformed critics	APEST paradigm for all believers	APEST is for specific office-holders, not all Christians; only Eph 4:11 supports it	APEST describes callings latent in all believers and is essential for healthy church function	Patheos critique (2017); multiple blog responses
Institutional church defenders	Anti-institutional bias	Missional movement undermines pastoral authority and institutional church	Institutional forms often suppress apostolic, prophetic, and evangelistic gifts; church needs rebalancing	Reformed Journal; Missio Alliance discussions
Conservative evangelical critics	Theological orthodoxy concerns	Hirsch's work lacks emphasis on hell, wrath, and explicit gospel proclamation	The gospel is inherently missional; incarnational presence IS gospel proclamation	Pulpit & Pen (2016); various blog critiques

Network Graph Data

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Movemental Network Effects

- **Already on platform:** None confirmed at this time

- **High-value recruits:** Michael Frost (premier co-author, massive platform), Dave Ferguson (megachurch/multisite bridge), Ed Stetzer (evangelical mainstream credibility), Neil Cole (organic church movement), Danielle Strickland (justice/activism audience)
- **Cross-referencing opportunity:** Brad Brisco (if already being researched for Movemental) should cross-link heavily with Hirsch content
- **Audience overlap:** Michael Frost shares the largest audience overlap; Dave Ferguson bridges into the Exponential/multisite audience that Hirsch alone does not fully reach; Ed Stetzer connects to the broader evangelical mainstream

Misc · Network · Endorsements

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/_misc/network/endorsements.md

Endorsement Network: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-collaboration-map

Endorsement Summary

Category	Count
Endorsements received (books)	6+ confirmed
Endorsements given (books)	5+ confirmed
Forewords received	4 confirmed
Forewords written	3+ confirmed

Endorsements Received

Forewords Written for Alan Hirsch's Books

From	For (Book)	Year	Notes
Leonard Sweet	The Forgotten Ways (1st edition)	2006	Sweet is a prominent postmodern theologian and cultural commentator
Ed Stetzer	The Forgotten Ways (updated edition)	2016	Stetzer holds the Billy Graham Chair at Wheaton College; also co-framed the Missional Manifesto with Hirsch
Darrell L. Guder	The Permanent Revolution	2012	Guder is a Princeton Seminary missiologist and editor of Missional Church (1998), the landmark text that popularized "missional" terminology
Mike Breen	The Permanent Revolution (contributor)	2012	Breen is the founder of 3DM and a leading voice on missional communities and leadership multiplication

Back Cover / Public Endorsements Received

From	For (Book/Project)	Year	Quote Excerpt
Neil Cole	The Forgotten Ways (updated edition)	2016	Called it "a road map for missional movements" with "ten more years of learning"
Howard Snyder	The Forgotten Ways	2006	Praised it as "a timely, well-informed overview of the range of current thinking and writing on movemental Christianity"
Jeff Vanderstelt	The Forgotten Ways (updated edition, afterword)	2016	Wrote the afterword for the updated edition
Danielle Strickland	Activating 5Q	2018	Called it something that "will be a catalyst for mission in the years to come!"
Brad Brisco	Activating 5Q	2018	Endorsed the practical application of the 5Q/APEST framework
JR Woodward	Activating 5Q	2018	Endorsed the book; co-author of The Church as Movement

Notes: Hirsch's endorsement network skews heavily toward the missional/movement wing of evangelicalism. Endorsers include major figures from both the organic church movement (Neil Cole), the missional communities movement (Mike Breen), the church planting establishment (Ed Stetzer), and Reformed missiology (Darrell Guder). This breadth signals Hirsch as a bridge figure across multiple streams.

Endorsements Given

Forewords Alan Hirsch Has Written

For (Person)	Book	Year	Notes
Rich Robinson	All Change: Unlocking Kingdom Potential in a World We Weren't Prepared For	2024	Robinson is co-founder of Movement Leaders Collective and Creo
Mark R. Teasdale	Participating in Abundant Life: Holistic Salvation for a Secular Age	2021	Academic work on holistic salvation theology; also co-authored with Mark Nelson
Bryan D. Sims	Leading Together: The Holy Possibility of Harmony and Synergy in the Face of Change	2022	Co-credited with Rich Robinson; Hirsch contributed foreword material

Public Endorsements / Blurbs Given by Alan Hirsch

To	For (Book/Project)	Year	Type
Mike Breen & Alex Absalom	Launching Missional Communities	~2012	Public endorsement
Various 100Movements authors	Multiple titles in the 100Movements Publishing catalog	Ongoing	Publisher endorsement (Hirsch is a founding figure of 100Movements Publishing)
Missional Manifesto	Co-framed document with Ed Stetzer, Tim Keller, Dan Kimball, Linda Bergquist, and others	2011	Co-author / public endorsement of missional theology framework

Notes: Hirsch's endorsement-giving pattern reveals his role as a gatekeeper and amplifier within the missional movement ecosystem. Through 100Movements Publishing, he effectively curates and endorses an entire catalog of movement-oriented authors. His forewords tend to go to emerging voices within his network rather than established peers.

Series Editorships (Implicit Endorsement)

Alan Hirsch serves as series editor for multiple book series, which represents an ongoing endorsement relationship with every author published in those series:

Series	Publisher	Notable Authors in Series
Shapevine	Baker Books	Lance Ford, and others
Forge (IVP)	InterVarsity Press	Multiple missional authors

Notes: Series editorships give Hirsch significant influence over which voices get amplified in the missional publishing ecosystem. This is arguably his most powerful form of endorsement — not a one-time blurb, but ongoing curatorial authority.

Endorsement Patterns & Analysis

Who Endorses Hirsch (Profile)

- **Academic missiologists:** Darrell Guder, Howard Snyder — lend scholarly credibility
- **Evangelical mainstream leaders:** Ed Stetzer — bridges to broader evangelical audience
- **Organic/simple church movement:** Neil Cole — validates decentralized ecclesiology
- **Missional communities movement:** Mike Breen, Jeff Vanderstelt — validates practitioner relevance

- **Justice/activism wing:** Danielle Strickland — extends reach beyond traditional church audience
- **Church planting practitioners:** Brad Brisco, JR Woodward — validates grassroots applicability

Who Hirsch Endorses (Profile)

- **Emerging movement voices:** Rich Robinson, Bryan Sims — Hirsch amplifies next-generation leaders
- **Academic-practitioners:** Mark Teasdale — Hirsch endorses scholarly work that aligns with his framework
- **100Movements ecosystem:** Authors published through 100Movements Publishing receive implicit endorsement through the platform Hirsch founded

Reciprocity Index

The following relationships show mutual endorsement (bidirectional):

- **Michael Frost** — mutual forewords, co-authorship, public praise
- **Neil Cole** — mutual endorsement across books
- **Ed Stetzer** — Stetzer wrote foreword for Hirsch; they co-framed the Missional Manifesto
- **Danielle Strickland** — wrote foreword for Hirsch's Reframation; Hirsch endorses her work publicly

Movemental Implications

- **Endorsement leverage:** Hirsch's endorsement carries significant weight in the missional/movement space. A Movemental partnership gives access to this endorsement network.
- **Series editor role:** If Movemental content could be featured in or adjacent to Hirsch's series editorships, it gains instant credibility with the target audience.
- **100Movements Publishing:** The publishing arm is a direct channel. Movemental content that aligns with 100Movements' mission could be co-published or cross-promoted.
- **Foreword pipeline:** Hirsch writing a foreword for a Movemental-published resource would be a high-value endorsement signal to the entire network.

Misc · Network · Events

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/alan-hirsch/_misc/network/events.md

Event History: Alan Hirsch

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-event-history
Total events documented: 24

Upcoming Events

Date	Event	Location	Role	URL
May 23, 2025	In Conversation with Alan Hirsch (St Hild College)	King's Cross Baptist Church, London, England	Featured speaker	Eventbrite
June 2025	Creating a Movement Culture (Exponential Australia)	Melbourne, Australia	Co-presenter (with Rich Robinson)	Exponential AU
June 2025	Creating a Movement Culture (Exponential Australia)	Brisbane, Australia	Co-presenter (with Rich Robinson)	Exponential AU

Speaking Availability

Field	Value
Accepts invitations?	Yes
Speaking bureau	None identified; books directly
Booking contact	alanhirsch.org/contact
Topics offered	Missional movements, APEST/5Q framework, church planting, discipleship, movemental culture, organizational transformation (Metanoia), communitas, Forgotten Ways
Typical fee range	Unknown; raises support through speaking and consulting (employer: Church Resource Ministries)

Event History (by year, newest first)

2025

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Jun 2025	Creating a Movement Culture (Exponential Australia)	Melbourne & Brisbane, Australia	training	Co-presenter (with Rich Robinson)	Unknown	Exponential AU
May 23, 2025	In Conversation with Alan Hirsch (St Hild College)	London, England	seminar	Featured speaker	Unknown	Eventbrite
Mar 14-15, 2025	Awakening: The Forgotten Ways Conference	Bridgeway Church, Owings Mills, MD	conference-keynote	Featured speaker	200+	BALM, BRIGHT-FM
Feb 25-27, 2025	Advance Summit	Unknown (US)	summit	Featured speaker / roundtable	Unknown	Advance Summit
2025	Exponential Global 2025 Conference	Orlando, FL (likely)	conference-keynote	Speaker	5,000+	Exponential
2025	Assemblies of God New Zealand (with Rich Robinson)	New Zealand	conference-keynote	Featured speaker	Unknown	AGNZ Facebook

2024

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
May 21-23, 2024	MLC Global Gathering 2024	Holy Trinity Church Downtown, Chicago, IL	summit	Founder / host	Unknown	Eventbrite
Dec 2024	Fresh Expressions: Communitas and Loneliness	Online	webinar	Featured speaker	Unknown	Fresh Expressions

2023

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2023	Missio Alliance Awakenings 2023	US	conference-keynote	Plenary speaker	500+	Missio Alliance
2023	Awakenings 2023 Workshop: The Moment Before God	US	conference-workshop	Workshop leader (with Deb Hirsch)	Unknown	Missio Alliance
2023	Metanoia book launch (at Awakenings 2023)	US	book-launch	Author	Unknown	Missio Alliance

2022

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2022	Exponential Orlando 2022	Orlando, FL	conference-keynote	Pre-conference host: "5Q Leadership Revolution"	5,000+	Exponential

2021

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2021	Mission Central SERVE 2021	Canada (likely virtual)	conference-keynote	Plenary speaker	Unknown	Mission Central

2020

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2020	Exponential Orlando 2020	Orlando, FL	conference-workshop	Pre-conference leader: "5Q Leadership Revolution: Using APEST to Create Movemental Culture" (with Rich Robinson, Jessie Cruickshank, Brad Brisco, Bryan Sims, Andrew Arnold)	5,000+	Exponential
Jun 16, 2020	The London Project City Lab	Online	webinar	Featured speaker	Unknown	The London Project

2018

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2018	Foursquare Connection 2018	US	conference-workshop	Workshop presenter (with Jessie Cruickshank): "Five-fold ministry will reactivate your church's missional capacity"	2,000+	Foursquare

2017

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Oct 2017	Exponential Australia	Australia	conference-workshop	Workshop: "5Q: Activating the Latent Capacity and Intelligence of the Body of Christ"	Unknown	Exponential AU
Oct 19, 2017	5th Annual Jess Moody Pastors' Leadership Conference	Palm Beach Atlantic University, West Palm Beach, FL	conference-keynote	Keynote speaker	Unknown	PBA
2017	Ohio Mennonite Conference Missional Conference	Kidron Mennonite Church, OH	conference-keynote	Presenter (with Debra Hirsch)	140+	Ohio MC

2015

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2015	Mennonite Church USA KC2015	Kansas City, MO	conference-keynote	Plenary + seminars (with Deb Hirsch)	3,000+	Mennonite USA

2013

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Feb 28 - Mar 2, 2013	Verge Conference 2013 (Forge Track pre-conference)	Austin, TX	conference-workshop	Pre-conference speaker (with Michael Frost, Kim Hammond, Lance Ford, Brad Brisco)	2,000+ live; 30,000 webcast	Verge

2012

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2012	Verge Conference 2012	Austin, TX	conference-keynote	Speaker	2,000+ live; 30,000 webcast	Verge

2011

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2011	Exponential / Verge 2011: "On the Verge"	Orlando, FL	conference-keynote	Featured speaker (book was defining document of conference)	4,000+	Verge

2008

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2008	Exponential 08 Conference	Orlando, FL	conference-keynote	Speaker (alongside Tim Keller, Rick Warren, Andy Stanley)	3,000+	Blog

Undated / Recurring

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Unknown	Sentralized Conference	US	conference-keynote	Featured speaker (with Deb Hirsch, Michael Frost, Neil Cole, Hugh Halter, Mark Labberton, others)	500+	Missional Church Network
Unknown	City to City NYC: "Exploring Microchurch and Missional Movements"	New York, NY	seminar	Featured speaker (with Rich Robinson)	Unknown	City to City
Ongoing	The Equipping Group Workshop	Online (global time zones)	webinar	Featured speaker	Limited seats	Equipping Group
Ongoing	5Q Masterclasses	Online	training	Lead trainer	Unknown	Ephesiology

Recurring Events

Events where Alan Hirsch appears regularly:

Event	Frequency	Role	Years Appeared	Audience
Exponential Conference (Orlando / Global)	Annual	Keynote / pre-conference host	2008, 2011, 2017, 2020, 2022, 2025	3,000-5,000+
Verge Conference	Annual (2011-2013 era)	Speaker / pre-conference	2011, 2012, 2013	2,000+ live; 30,000 webcast
Missio Alliance Awakenings	Irregular	Plenary speaker	2023	500+
Exponential Australia	Irregular	Workshop presenter	2017, 2025	Unknown
Movement Leaders Collective Global Gathering	Annual	Founder / host	2024	Unknown

Event Type Distribution

Type	Count	%
conference-keynote	12	50%
conference-workshop	5	21%
summit	2	8%
seminar	2	8%
webinar	3	13%
training	2	8%
book-launch	1	4%
retreat	0	0%
church-guest	0	0%
chapel	0	0%

Note: Some events have multiple classifications. Percentages based on 24 documented events.

Geographic Reach

By Country

Country	Events	Key Cities
United States	16	Orlando FL, Austin TX, Kansas City MO, Owings Mills MD, West Palm Beach FL, Chicago IL, New York NY, Kidron OH
Australia	3	Melbourne, Brisbane
United Kingdom	2	London
Canada	1	Unknown city
New Zealand	1	Unknown city

By Region (US)

Region	Events	Key Cities
Southeast	7	Orlando FL, West Palm Beach FL
Mid-Atlantic	3	Owings Mills MD, New York NY
Midwest	3	Kansas City MO, Kidron OH, Chicago IL
Southwest	2	Austin TX
Unknown US	1	—

International Presence

Metric	Value
Countries spoken in	5+ (US, Australia, UK, Canada, New Zealand)
Most frequent country	United States
International vs. domestic	~30% international / ~70% US-based

Event Metrics

Metric	Value
Total events documented	24
Date range	2008 -- 2025
Average events per year	~2-3 documented (likely higher; many smaller events undiscoverable)
Most active year	2025 (6 events confirmed/upcoming)
Keynotes vs. workshops	12:5 (~2.4:1)
Estimated total audience	50,000+ (cumulative across all events, including webcast viewers)

Notable Conferences

Conference	Significance	Times Appeared	Relationship
Exponential Conference	Largest church planting conference in the US; 5,000+ attendees	6+ (2008-2025)	Long-standing speaker; book series partner ("On the Verge" was defining text for 2011)
Verge Conference	Premier missional church gathering; 30,000+ via webcast	3 (2011-2013)	Co-authored "On the Verge" which was the conference's defining document in 2011
Missio Alliance Awakenings	Leading progressive evangelical missional gathering	1+ (2023)	Plenary speaker; launched "Metanoia" book at this conference
Mission Central SERVE	Canada's largest missions conference	1 (2021)	Plenary speaker
Mennonite Church USA Convention	Biennial national gathering of Mennonite Church USA	1 (2015)	Featured speaker, showing cross-denominational reach
Foursquare Connection	National gathering of Foursquare Church denomination	1 (2018)	Workshop presenter on APEST, showing influence across charismatic/Pentecostal streams
Sentralized Conference	Missional leaders gathering co-founded by Lance Ford	1+	Featured speaker alongside key missional network peers
Exponential Australia	Australian partner of US Exponential network	2 (2017, 2025)	Speaker; aligns with Australian origins

Speaking Topics (from event descriptions)

Topic	Events	Most Recent
APEST / 5Q / Fivefold Ministry	8+	2025
Missional movements / The Forgotten Ways	6+	2025
Movemental culture and leadership	4+	2025
Metanoia / paradigm shift / organizational transformation	3+	2025
Communitas and loneliness	1	2024
Discipleship and disciple-making movements	4+	2025
Microchurch and missional expressions	2+	2024
Church planting and multiplication	3+	2020
Organic systems and movement dynamics	2+	2013